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(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD	
	ANCHOR INVESTOR BIDDING DATE: MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026
	BID/ISSUE OPENS ON: WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026
	BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON[(1)]: FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

Continued on next page...

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. **The Company has not undertaken pre-IPO placement from the DRHP till date.**
2. **The Promoter or the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of equity shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the DRHP till date.**
3. **The aggregate pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and the top 10 Shareholders is set out below:**

S. No.	Name of the shareholder	Pre-Issue: No. of Equity Shares of face value ₹10 each	Pre-Issue Shareholding (in %)*	Post-Issue as at allotment at lower end ₹1,065: No. of Equity Shares^	Post-Issue Shareholding (in %)^*	Post-Issue as at allotment at upper end ₹1,119: Number of Equity Shares^	Post-Issue Shareholding (in %)^*
Promoter							
1	Reliance Industries Limited	5,937,841,645	66.35%	5,937,841,645	64.41%	5,937,841,645	64.41%
	Additional top 10 Shareholders						
1	Jaadhu Holdings, LLC (an affiliate of Meta Platforms, Inc. (formerly known as Facebook, Inc.))	892,275,913	9.97%	892,275,913	9.68%	892,275,913	9.68%
2	Google International LLC	690,854,775	7.72%	690,854,775	7.49%	690,854,775	7.49%
3	The Public Investment Fund (a sovereign wealth fund of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
4	Omicron Asia Holdings II Pte. Ltd. (an affiliate of funds, vehicles and/or entities managed and/or advised by Kohlberg Kravis Roberts & Co. L.P., an indirect subsidiary of KKR & Co. Inc.)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
5	VEPF VII AIV I Ltd. (an affiliate of funds, vehicles and/or entities managed and/or advised by Vista Equity Partners Management, LLC)	206,931,899	2.31%	206,931,899	2.24%	206,931,899	2.24%
6	SLP Redwood Holdings Pte. Ltd. (an affiliate of Silver Lake)	168,489,206	1.88%	168,489,206	1.83%	168,489,206	1.83%
7	MIC Redwood 1 RSC Limited (an indirectly wholly owned subsidiary of Mubadala Investment Company PJSC)	165,545,519	1.85%	165,545,519	1.80%	165,545,519	1.80%
8	General Atlantic Singapore JP Pte. Ltd.	120,120,900	1.34%	120,120,900	1.30%	120,120,900	1.30%
9	Platinum Jasmine A 2018 Trust (acting through its trustee, Platinum Owl C 2018 RSC Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Abu Dhabi Investment Authority)	103,465,950	1.16%	103,465,950	1.12%	103,465,950	1.12%
10	India Markets Pte. Ltd. (an entity managed/advised by TPG Capital (S) Pte. Ltd.)	82,772,760	0.92%	82,772,760	0.90%	82,772,760	0.90%
11	Other public shareholders	167,148,465	1.87%	437,148,465	4.74%	437,148,465	4.74%
	TOTAL	**8,949,310,830**	**100.00%**	**9,219,310,830**	**100.00%**	**9,219,310,830**	**100.00%**

Note: The Promoter Group do not hold any Equity Shares in the Company

^Assuming full subscription in the Issue. The post-Issue shareholding details as at Allotment will be based on the actual subscription and will be updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the Basis of Allotment. Also, this table assumes there is no transfer of Equity Shares by these shareholders between the date of the advertisement and Allotment (if any such transfers occur prior to the date of Prospectus, it will be updated in the shareholding pattern in the Prospectus).

** Assuming exercise of all vested options*

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band in this advertisement. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

The Issue Price will be determined by the Company in consultation with the BRLMs, on the basis of assessment of market demand for the Equity Shares offered through the Book Building Process and on the basis of quantitative and qualitative factors as described below. The face value of the Equity Shares is ₹ 10 each and the Issue Price is 106.50 times the face value of the Equity Shares at the lower end of the Price Band and 111.90 times the face value of the Equity Shares at the higher end of the Price Band. Investors should refer to *"Risk Factors"*, *"Our Business"*, *"Restated Consolidated Financial Information"* and *"Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations"* on pages 30, 196, 320 and 436, of the RHP respectively, to have an informed view before making an investment decision.

Qualitative Factors

Some of the qualitative factors and our strengths which form the basis of computing the Issue Price are on page 126 of the RHP

Quantitative Factors

Some of the quantitative factors which may form the basis for computing the Issue Price are as follows:

A. Basic and Diluted Earnings Per Equity Share ("EPS"):

Year/Period ended	Basic EPS (in ₹)	Diluted EPS (in ₹)	Weight
March 31, 2026	33.63	33.59	3
March 31, 2025	29.21	29.17	2
March 31, 2024	23.96	23.93	1
Weighted Average	**30.55**	**30.51**	
Three months ended June 30, 2026*	8.69	8.68	-
Three months ended June 30, 2025*	7.96	7.95	-

**Not annualised*

Notes:

(1) Basic earnings per share is calculated by dividing the Profit for the year / period as per Restated Consolidated Statement of Profit and Loss attributable to equity shareholders by the weighted average number of Equity Shares.

(2) Diluted earnings per share is calculated by dividing the Profit for the year / period as per Restated Consolidated Statement of Profit and Loss attributable to equity shareholders by the weighted average number of Equity Shares outstanding plus the weighted average number of potential equity shares on account of employee stock option plan.

B. Price/Earning ("P/E") ratio in relation to the Price Band of ₹ 1,065 to ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share:

Particulars	P/E at the Floor Price (no. of times)	P/E at the Cap Price (no. of times)
Based on basic EPS for Fiscal 2026	31.67	33.27
Based on diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026	31.71	33.31

C. Industry Peer P/E ratio

Particulars	P/E ratio^
Highest	40.71
Lowest[1&2]	3.99
Average	22.35

^ P/E ratio of peer companies has been considered above for determining the highest, lowest and average Industry P/E. The P/E ratio of the peer companies has been computed based on the closing market price of the equity shares of respective peer companies on NSE as on October 13, 2026, divided by diluted EPS for fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

Note 1: Refers to the P/E ratio of Vodafone Idea Limited. The profit after tax of Vodafone Idea Limited for the year ended March 31, 2026, of ₹ 345,520 million includes exceptional items aggregating to ₹ 586,070 million. The profit after tax and the exceptional items for the year ended March 31, 2026, were ₹ 34,552 crore and ₹ 58,607 crore respectively (these have been multiplied by 10 to reflect the same in ₹ million)

Note 2: If we exclude such exceptional item then the P/E ratio for Vodafone Idea Limited would not be comparable and the average P/E ratio for the industry would be the same as the Highest P/E ratio.

D. Return on Average Net Worth ("RoNW"):

Financial Year/Period Ended	RoNW (%)	Weight
March 31, 2026	9.42	3
March 31, 2025	8.97	2
March 31, 2024	8.02	1
Weighted Average	**9.04**	
Three months ended June 30, 2026*	2.30	-
Three months ended June 30, 2025*	2.31	-

**Not annualised*

Notes:

(1) Return on Average Net Worth is calculated as Net Profit for the year / period attributable to the owners of the Company based on the Restated Consolidated Financial Information divided by the average Net Worth for the year / period.

(2) Net Worth refers to the aggregate value of the paid-up share capital and all reserves created out of the profits and securities premium account and debit or credit balance of profit and loss account, after deducting the aggregate value of the accumulated losses, deferred expenditure and miscellaneous expenditure not written off, as per the audited balance sheet, but does not include reserves created out of revaluation of assets, write-back of depreciation and amalgamation. Net Worth has been calculated as the aggregate of equity share capital and other equity excluding other comprehensive income.

(3) Average Net Worth is computed as average of Net Worth as at the beginning and end of the year/period.

(4) For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

E. Net Asset Value ("NAV") per Equity Share:

NAV per Equity Share	(in ₹)
As on March 31, 2026	373.66
As on June 30, 2026	382.34
After the Issue	
- At the Floor Price	402.33
- At the Cap Price	403.91
Issue Price*	[●]

** To be determined on conclusion of the Book Building Process*

Notes:

(1) Net Worth has been calculated as the aggregate of equity share capital and other equity excluding other comprehensive income.Net Worth refers to the aggregate value of the paid-up share capital and all reserves created out of the profits and securities premium account and debit or credit balance of profit and loss account, after deducting the aggregate value of the accumulated losses, deferred expenditure and miscellaneous expenditure not written off, as per the audited balance sheet, but does not include reserves created out of revaluation of assets, write-back of depreciation and amalgamation.

(2) Net Asset Value per Equity Share is calculated by dividing Net Worth as of the end of year/period by the number of Equity Shares outstanding at the end of the year/period.

(3) For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

F. Comparison with accounting ratios:

We are a technology platform company offering digital connectivity and digital services to our customers. Digital connectivity is the key enabler for providing our digital services solutions. We have considered only scaled digital connectivity providers listed in India namely Bharti Airtel Limited and Vodafone Idea Limited as the peer set and have not considered other listed digital connectivity service providers for the purpose of comparing financials and operating data. Following is the comparison of our key accounting ratios with such listed companies:

Particulars	Face value (₹)	Revenue from operations for Fiscal 2026 (in ₹ million)	EPS (Basic) (₹)	EPS (Diluted) (₹)	P/E	Return on Average Net Worth (%) (₹)	NAV per Equity Share (₹)
The Company*	10	1,468,853	33.63	33.59	[●]#	9.42%^	373.66^
Peer Companies							
Bharti Airtel Limited	5	2,109,728[1]	45.96[3]	44.37[3]	40.71 [4]	20.32%[5]	244.60[6]
Vodafone Idea Limited	10	448,730[2]	3.21[3]	3.21[3]	3.99 [4]	NM$	(3.30)[7]

Source: All the financial information for listed peer companies mentioned above is on a consolidated basis and is sourced from the annual report or audited financial statements or audited financial results or quarterly IR pack or quarterly reports of the respective company for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, submitted to the Stock Exchanges.

** Financial information of the Company has been derived from the Restated Consolidated Financial Information.*

 # To be included in the Prospectus based on the Issue Price.

$ Since the Average net-worth of Vodafone Idea Limited is negative, return on average net-worth is not meaningful (NM).

^For further details, see "Management's Discussion and Analysis of Financial Condition and Results of Operations – Non-GAAP Measures – Return on Average Net Worth and Net Asset Value Per Equity Share" on page 451 of the RHP.

Notes for peer Companies

[1] Revenue from operations for Bharti Airtel Limited is on consolidated basis (including the Africa Business) as reported in the consolidated audited results for the year ended March 31, 2026. Revenue from operations for India (excluding passive infrastructure) for Fiscal 2026 was ₹ 1,403,734 million as reported in the quarterly IR pack for the quarter and the year ended March 31, 2026.

[2] The revenue from operations of Vodafone Idea Limited for the year ended March 31, 2026, as per the audited consolidated financial results was ₹ 44,873 crore which has been multiplied by 10 to reflect the same in ₹ million.

[3] Basic and diluted EPS refers to the basic and diluted EPS sourced from the audited consolidated financial results of the peer companies respectively for the Fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

[4] P/E ratio of peer companies has been computed based on the closing market price of the equity shares of respective peer companies on NSE as on October 13, 2026, divided by diluted EPS for fiscal ended March 31, 2026.

[5] Return on average net worth (%) for Bharti Airtel Limited is computed as net income (after exceptional items) attributable to the owners for the year ended March 31, 2026, divided by average of consolidated total equity attributable to the owners as on March 31, 2026, and March 31, 2025.

[6] Net asset value per equity share for Bharti Airtel Limited is the book value per equity share as disclosed in the quarterly IR pack for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026.

[7] Net asset value per equity share for Vodafone Idea Limited has been computed as total equity as of March 31, 2026, as per the audited consolidated financial results divided by the number of equity shares outstanding as of March 31, 2026.

Continued on next page...

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G. Weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA"), floor price and cap price

(a) Price per share of the Company (as adjusted for corporate actions, including split, bonus issuances) based on primary issuances of Equity Shares or convertible securities (excluding issuance of Equity Shares pursuant to a bonus issue or employee stock option scheme, if any) during the 18 months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, where such issuance is equal to or more than 5% of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-Issue capital before such transaction(s) and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested) in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days ("Primary Issuances")

Not applicable

(b) Price per share of the Company (as adjusted for corporate actions, including bonus issuances) based on secondary sale or acquisition of equity shares or convertible securities (excluding gifts) involving the Promoter, members of the Promoter Group, and/ or any Shareholders with rights to nominate directors during the 18 months preceding the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus, where the acquisition or sale is equal to or more than 5% of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of the Company (calculated based on the pre-Issue capital before such transaction(s) and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested), in a single transaction or multiple transactions combined together over a span of rolling 30 days ("Secondary Transactions")

Not applicable

(c) Since there are no such transactions to report under (a) and (b), therefore the following are the details of the price per share of the Company basis the last five primary or secondary transactions (secondary transactions where the Promoter, Promoter Group, and/ or Shareholders with the rights to nominate directors on the Board, are a party to the transaction), not older than three years prior to the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus irrespective of the size of transactions:

Not applicable

(d) Weighted average cost of acquisition, floor price and cap price

Past transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (₹)	Floor Price ₹ 1,065 (in times)	Cap Price ₹ 1,119 (in times)
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Primary Issuances	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Weighted average cost of acquisition of Secondary Transactions	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
Since there were no Primary Issuance or Secondary Transactions of equity shares of the Company as mentioned above, the information of price per share of the Company based on the last five secondary transactions where the Promoter, Promoter Group, and/ or Shareholders with the rights to nominate directors on the Board, are a party to the transaction, during the last three years preceding to the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus irrespective of the size of the transaction:			
- Based on primary issuances	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable
- Based on secondary transactions	Not Applicable	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

H. Justification for Basis for Issue Price

Detailed explanation for Issue Price / Cap Price along with our Company's KPIs and financial ratios for the Fiscals and periods presented in the Restated Consolidated Financial Information and in view of the external factors which may have influenced the pricing of the Issue, if any:

- **Technology company with inherent engineering and full-stack proprietary capabilities:** We are the only digital connectivity provider globally with an end-to-end 5G SA technology stack deployed at nationwide scale - including a 4G+5G combination core, 5G devices and OSS and BSS operating systems, helping India become only the fifth country globally to possess such indigenous 5G capability, as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the only Indian company to be among the top 20 companies globally in the WIPO PCT rankings in 2025
- **Transforming digital connectivity and digital services in India:** We were the first to roll out 4G VoLTE connectivity at scale in India and the first company to achieve 100 million 4G customers in less than 180 days from commercial launch of our services, as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the first operator in India to launch a standalone 5G network, as per the Analysys Mason Report and have also enabled large scale, rapid 5G adoption in India. As of June 30, 2026, RJIL had 533.3 million customers, including 284.9 million 5G customers. As of June 30, 2026, 28.6 million customers subscribe to our JioFiber or JioAirFiber services, making us the largest fixed broadband service provider in India, as per the Analysys Mason Report
- **We have a culture of innovation which drives our execution engine excellence:** We have introduced several innovations such as JioGridX, which records 82 parameters at a given location across speed, coverage and user traffic and enables automated and real-time improvement actions for seamless work orders, created a Digital twin which helps in planning network rollouts and remotely guide field engineers for first time right installations and Jio Brain AI enabling autonomous decision making and real-time network optimisation.
- **The nation scale, digital gateway to India:** Consumers use the MyJio App to discover and access a large library of digital services. MyJio App had 227.6 million and 215.9 million average Monthly Active Users in the three months ended June 30, 2026, and Fiscal 2026 respectively. - As of June 30, 2026, over 1,000 digital TV channels and 15 OTT services are being offered with our JioFiber and JioAirFiber packages. -We also use physical touchpoints, such as 1,059 Jio Centres and 6,322 Jio Points as of June 30, 2026, supported by the feet-on-street network which includes a mix of employees and contractors to distribute our digital services.
- **Future ready network infrastructure:** As of June 30, 2026, we have access to a pan-India network of 360,537 Network Towers, majority of which are fiberized. We hold 26,800.8 MHz spectrum, with average remaining life of approximately15.8 years as of June 30, 2026. We have access to over 1.0 million route kilometres (or 30.0+ million fiber pair kilometres of which more than 60% is intracity) of fibre network as per the Analysys Mason Report. We are the only operator in India to have spectrum in low-band, mid-band and millimetre wave (700 MHz, 3300 MHz and 26GHz) spectrum for 5G, as per the Analysys Mason Report
- **Proven track record of scale, growth and profitability with a strong balance sheet:** In the three months ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscal 2026, we generated total revenue from operations of ₹ 391,729 million and ₹ 1,468,853 million, EBITDA of ₹ 208,645 million and ₹ 762,554 million, and EBITDA margin of 53.26% and 51.91% respectively. We have achieved this scale in just 10 years since the launch of digital connectivity services by RJIL in 2016. We have a strong balance sheet which is reflected in our improving leverage position – our Net Leverage reduced from 0.88x in Fiscal 2024 to 0.36x in Fiscal 2026

ASBA* Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

* Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("ASBA") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.

UPI UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (iii) Eligible Shareholders in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion; (iv) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section **"Issue Procedure"** on page 534 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (**"AIBI"**) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited, Axis Bank Limited and State Bank of India have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Issue related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 5,00,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1.0 million provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus shall be delivered to the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

Continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
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E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
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Maharashtra, India
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E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
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Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
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SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

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Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

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E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP shall be available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Offer, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number (operational from October 16, 2026 (excluding all public holidays) between 9 am and 6 pm) to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue from October 16, 2026, by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 14, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

This announcement is not an offer of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares offered in the Issue have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) in the United States solely to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from, or not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act, or (ii) outside the United States in "offshore transactions," as defined in, and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where such offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of Equity Shares in the United States.

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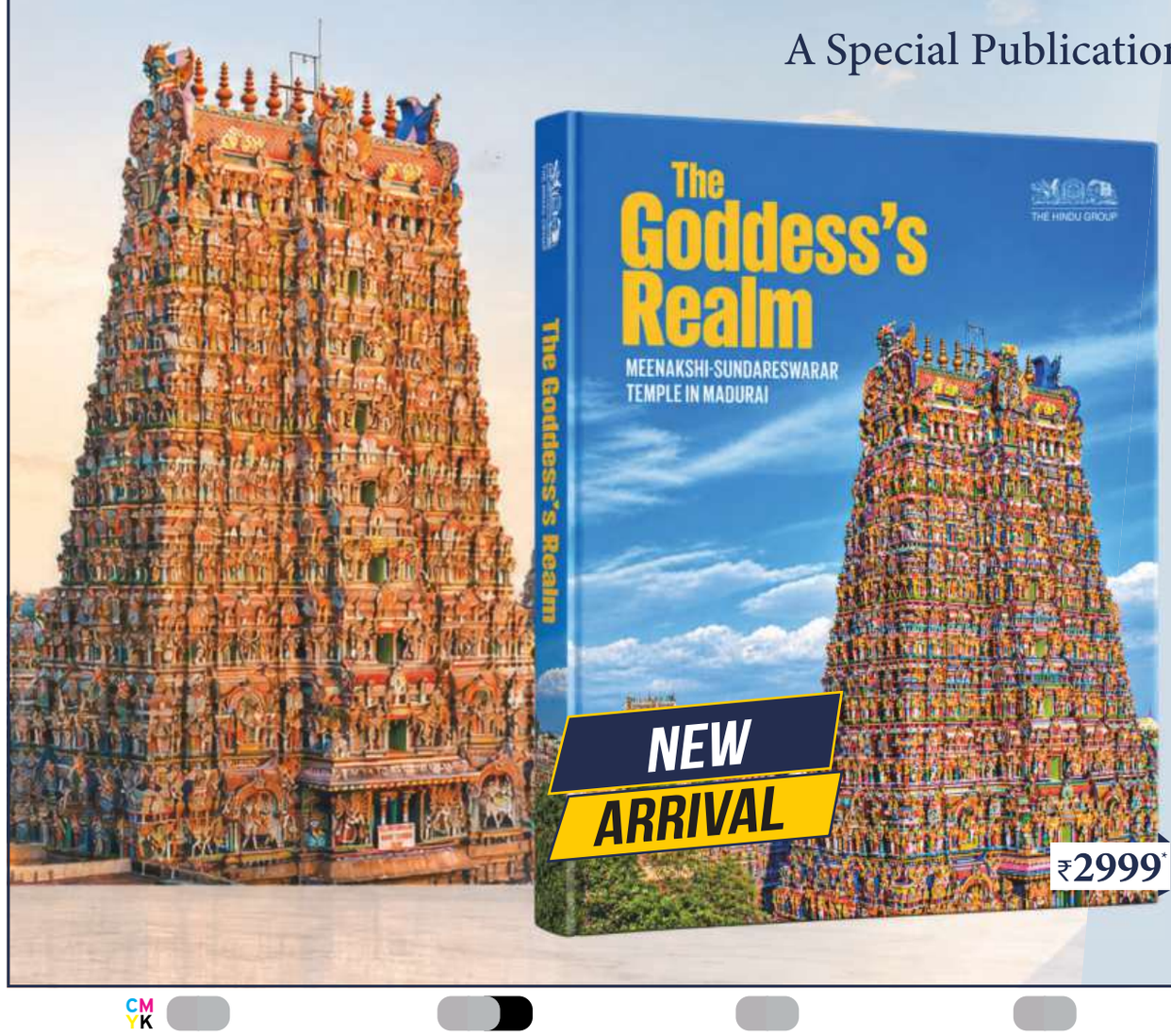

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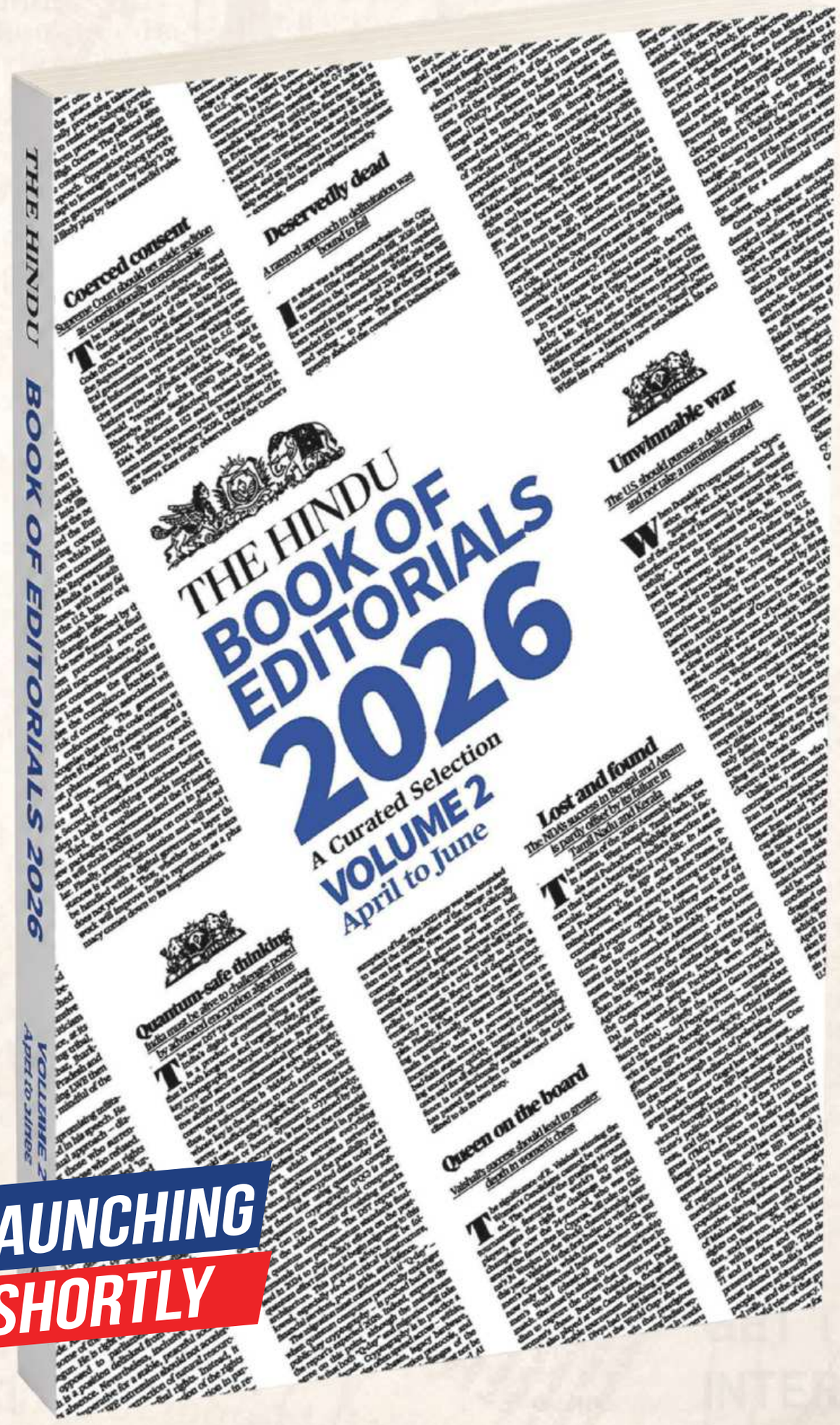

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IN BRIEF

Capsized boat was overloaded, had hole, say police

RAGHOPUR (VAISHALI)
The boat, which capsized in the Ganga in Vaishali district of Bihar on Tuesday, killing 13 minors, was dilapidated with a hole in the deck and was overloaded, police said on Wednesday. » Page 10

Death penalty for wife in 'blue drum' murder case

NEW DELHI
A Meerut court on Wednesday sentenced Muskan Rastogi and her partner Sahil Shukla to death for murdering her husband, Saurabh Rajput, whose dismembered remains were found in a cement-filled plastic drum in March 2025. » Page 3

Many youth held as SIR protests rock capital for fifth straight day

Youth and student groups march through Delhi amid a large contingent of security forces demanding scrapping of SIR, resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, and reinstatement of Jantar Mantar as protest site; protesters allege being beaten up

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Protesters climbed over barricades, slogans pierced through the din of police announcements, and detention buses filled up on Wednesday as hundreds of people took to the streets of central Delhi against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The fifth consecutive day of demonstrations saw separate marches by members of the Youth Congress and those of the Students' Federation of India and the Democratic Youth Federation of India.

The Left groups protested on Firoz Shah Road before a large contingent of police personnel and security forces moved in to control the crowd.

Pushing forward: Members of Left outfits protesting in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

"*Vote chor, gaddi chhod* (vote thief, vacate your seat)," the protesters shouted while placards carried messages such as "We are Indians, not terrorists" and "Protest, not silence, is the lifeblood of democracy". The protesters targeted Mr. Kumar and opposed the removal of Jantar Mantar's status as a designated protest site.

The situation escalated as police personnel began detaining protesters who sat on the road, with several being bundled into detention vehicles. Some protesters alleged being beaten up. The number of people detained was not made available at the time of going to press.

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CJP leaders sent to jail for going to Jantar Mantar

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were remanded to five days in judicial custody on Wednesday for allegedly entering Jantar Mantar area, which has been denotified as a designated protest site. The police have registered two FIRs over allegations of trespass and other charges.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 11

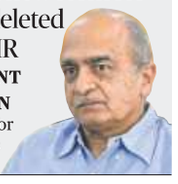
SC agrees to 'take care' of Delhi voters whose names were removed

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to intervene for Delhi's voters whose names were deleted from the electoral roll pursuant to the special intensive revision (SIR), and are now effectively being asked by the Election Commission of India (ECI) to misrepresent themselves as fresh applicants.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was informed by advocates Prashant Bhushan and Neha Rathi, appearing for petitioners Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, that voters seeking to restore their names in the roll are being compelled by the ECI to file a declaration that they had never voted before or face imprisonment. "We are thinking of passing an order which will take care of this issue," the CJI remarked.

> The EC should either allow them [voters seeking re-inclusion] to file Form 8 or create a new form for voters deleted in the SIR
>
> **PRASHANT BHUSHAN**
> Advocate for petitioners



"The ECI should either allow them to file Form 8 [for shifted voters] or create a new form for voters deleted in the SIR," Mr. Bhushan submitted. He said the Delhi SIR case was listed on October 30, but that would be too late as the last date for filing claims and objections was the same day. The Chief Justice advanced the date of hearing to October 28.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Protesting students 'voice of India', do not stand in their way, Rahul tells Modi, Shah

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday asked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah not to stand in the way of protesting students, describing them as the "voice of India".

The Congress leader made the remarks after he met students, including activists of the party's students' wing, the National Students' Union of India, who were injured during protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities in the special intensive revision of electoral rolls.

Rahul Gandhi speaking to the media in Delhi on Wednesday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Mr. Gandhi asked the students to introduce themselves, narrate their ordeal after Delhi Police personnel picked them up from the protesting sites, and then urged them to form a human chain.

"Amit Shah*ji*, look at this properly. Here there is no Hindu, no Muslim, no caste, no gender. There is one voice, one protest – it is the voice of Hindustan," he said. "The Prime Minister*ji* is standing in front of this voice. I give you a suggestion – do not stand in front of this voice. No one can stand in front of this voice," he added.

Mr. Gandhi also described the students as *shers* and *shernis* (lions and lionesses) and assured them that the Congress would stand by them.

RAISING THEIR VOICE
» PAGE 2

Tradition on stage

Cultural commune: Artistes performing a traditional dance during the 'Vijayawada Utsav-2.0' on Wednesday. The 10-day festival celebrates the cultural heritage of Vijayawada and Andhra Pradesh through traditional performances, folk arts, and cultural programmes. G.N. RAO

Wholesale inflation rises to 49-month high of 11.4%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Wholesale price inflation rose to 11.4% in September, a record-breaking high during the two-and-a-half years for which there is data for the new series of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI), and a 49-month-high as per the much longer old series.

Inflation in the food articles component of the WPI came in at 8.1% in September, up sharply from 5.7% in the previous month. The non-food primary articles segment also saw elevated inflation levels of 10.3%.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 13

Centre seeks public input on demographic changes

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The demography panel set up by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has launched a portal to allow government bodies, members of the public, NGOs, and even "international organisations" to submit their input on "frequent demographic changes in the country", preferably post-2011.

The portal stated that while these changes are most visibly concentrated in border districts, their impact has extended to affect urban centres, industrial corridors, tribal regions, and other socially and economically sensitive areas, severely impacting public service delivery, local governance, resource distribution, and social cohesion. It said these changes are "not attributable to normal fertility or mortality trends but are emerging due to external abnormal factors, including illegal immigration, irregular population mobility, and administrative laxity."

The demography panel portal says impact of changes has extended from border districts to urban centres. FILE PHOTO

The Ministry said that the inputs will help the panel to analyse and identify the causes of demographic changes and to recommend a well-organised and permanent operational system for the "legal, fair, and time-bound identification, detention, and deportation of illegal immigrants residing in the country".

The portal mandatorily seeks the mobile phone number, address, and e-mail ID of the respondents, and seeks their consent for the processing of their personal data and analysis of the information provided.

The portal – https://demography.mha.gov.in – says that the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC), chaired by former Supreme Court judge Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar, was constituted on May 26 to study the "nature, causes and consequences of demographic changes being observed in various parts of the country".

Three categories

The respondents have been divided into three categories: Union government Ministries, departments, and organisations; State governments and Union Territory administrations; civil society groups, NGOs, academic institutions, industry and business associations, international organisations, and think tanks; and individual citizens, public representatives, students, and others.

There are eight questions under the individual citizen/public representative/student/others category. One of the questions asks the respondent to "describe the major demographic changes" observed or studied over the past 15 years in the geographical areas the respondent is familiar with, such as villages, towns, cities, districts, States/UTs, regions, or "across India."

The survey seeks views on the principal drivers behind these changes and invites respondents to identify challenges arising from demographic trends.

India's exports to China grow 40%, deficit crosses $100 bn

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

India's exports to China grew 40% in the first three quarters of 2026 to around $20 billion, although the trade deficit with the neighbouring country has continued to widen, already crossing $100 billion this year, according to data released on Wednesday by China's General Administration of Customs.

India's two-way trade with China between January and September this year was up 25.4% to $144.45 billion, while India's imports from China continued to rise, up 23.3% to $125.19 billion.

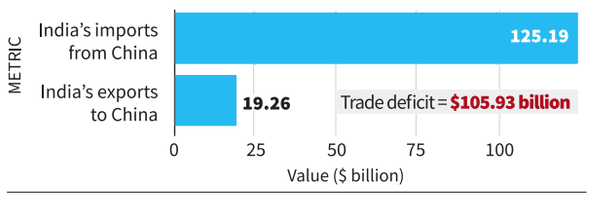
Indian exports to China registered a robust 40.7% growth, albeit from a much smaller base, to $19.26 billion after the first three quarters, already reaching last year's total. The trade deficit stood at $105.93 billion and is on track to surpass last year's record figure of $116.12 billion.

Indian officials say that while there is no expectation for trade to be perfectly balanced, the broader concern is the heavily lopsided trade relationship, a lack of market access for Indian firms, and the nature of India's imports.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Widening gap

India's two-way trade with China rose **25.4% year-on-year to $144.45 billion in Jan.-Sept. 2026.** While India's exports grew 40.7% to $19.26 billion, **imports rose 23.3% to $125.19 billion**, pushing the trade deficit to $105.93 billion



RAISING THEIR VOICE

At a press conference on Wednesday, protesters recounted incidents of 'police brutality' during demonstrations in the Capital over the past week. Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi urged the protesters to preserve video recordings of police brutality, and promised them that those responsible will be 'punished'. **Ashna Butani** and **Shrimansi Kaushik** report

ATHIRA VIJAYAN

A Delhi University student from Kerala who is currently associated with the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), Ms. Athira questioned the police for detaining her at Connaught Place without a woman police officer present. She was then taken to the basement of a police station, where she alleged that she was grabbed, punched on the lip, and kicked in her private parts. "When I asked them to stop, they started kicking me," she said. Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said at the press conference that she had also lost hearing in one ear.

RITU BARALA

Associated with the NSUI, Ms. Barala said when protesters tried to get off a bus, police personnel scratched and slapped her, held her by the throat, and kicked her in her private parts. "We were detained in three buses. When I tried to get off the bus, an officer, Chanchal Yadav, slapped me and scratched me. When I tried to get up, she used force. She held me by the throat, and my ear eventually became blue," she said. Ms. Barala said she had hit the police officer back in response to the assault. Clips purportedly showing the incident went viral on social media.

ARJUN UNNIKRISHNAN

Originally from Kerala, Mr. Arjun, a researcher and law graduate who has been living in Delhi for the past three years, said he was detained on October 11. He said protesters were taken to a heavily barricaded spot near the LIC building in Connaught Place. "Additional DCP Ashok Bishnoi assured us that we would not be beaten up, but a minute later, a jail van arrived. Just as we entered the van, four police commandos were standing in a queue to beat us up. I was punched and fell to the floor. They kicked me on my chest, back, and private parts," he said.

RAMIT

A content creator who had a flute with him, Mr. Ramit played a tune of '*Vaishnava Jana*' during the press conference. "The answer to violence is love," he said. He alleged that he was brutally detained on October 11 despite Supreme Court orders against detaining peaceful protesters. "I was detained after Bajrang Dal and RSS (Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh) goons told the police to detain me. They had lathis and stones in their hands when they told the police to detain us. The police then detained us, snatched our phones, and formatted them," Mr. Ramit said.

SAMARTH, DHARMENDRA

Both students, they were detained by the Delhi police on October 5 and taken to the Parliament Street police station, where they alleged that they were beaten up. "There were at least 15–20 policemen, some in civilian clothes.They beat us brutally. Then they took us out through the back gate, made us sit in a police vehicle, and beat us all the way to Delhi Cantonment. There was a constable named Ankit Kasana who beat us up as well," Mr. Samarth said. "They registered an FIR against me and charged me with assaulting women and vandalising buses I wasn't even on. They told us they were unable to eat or sleep because of us. 'We have been asked to work double shifts because of you,' they said. They were taking out their frustration on us by kicking and punching us," Mr. Dharmendra said.

FIR against scribe over 'casteist slur' against ACP

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Delhi police have registered an FIR against an independent journalist and others on a complaint by Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat, who alleged that he was subjected to casteist remarks, public humiliation, and defamation during a protest near Jantar Mantar this month, officials said on Wednesday.

The FIR was registered under relevant provisions of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and Sections 221, 356(2) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita based on the complaint by Mr. Bhagat. Earlier, the independent journalist accused the ACP of sexual assault, which the Crime Branch is investigating.

'*Lehra do Tiranga*': Dipke calls for stir at C.P. tomorrow over arrest of CJP leaders

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijit Dipke has called for a nationwide '*Lehra do Tiranga*' demonstration on Friday, urging citizens to gather with the national flag at Central Park in central Delhi's Connaught Place (C.P.).

"We will tell them that waving the Tiranga is not a crime," Mr. Dipke posted on X, urging supporters in Delhi to gather at the park at 5 p.m.

Those who cannot travel to the Capital should organise 'Tiranga marches' in their cities, he added.

The protest call follows the remand of CJP co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka to five days' judicial custody. Both leaders were arrested for allegedly trespassing into Jantar Mantar, violating bond conditions, and obstructing police personnel on duty. They were sent to Tihar Jail on Wednesday following the remand order. The Delhi police said on October 12 that Jantar Mantar has been denotified as a protest site.

Police detaining students staging a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar near Jantar Mantar on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The arrests have drawn criticism from several Opposition leaders, including Rahul Gandhi of the Congress, Nationalist Congress Party (SP) MP Supriya Sule, Mamata All India Trinamool Congress leaders Mamata Banerjee and Mahua Moitra, and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam president M.K. Stalin.

Civil society groups, farm unions announce united platform against SIR

Named 'People against SIR', platform calls for nationwide protest on October 23 demanding the resignation of the CEC; more than 100 outfits have agreed to join the agitation, its members say

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Several civil society groups, farmers' unions, workers' organisations, and women's and youth groups on Wednesday formed a national platform, 'People against SIR', and announced a nationwide march on October 23 demanding the scrapping of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls as part of a broader campaign against the exercise.

The announcement followed an emergency consultation meeting held in Delhi on Wednesday. It was attended by representatives of more than 200 organisations, said Dr. Sunilam of the Kisan Sangarsh Samiti. Activist Tara Rao, actor Prakash Raj, and representatives of farmers' and youth organisations addressed a press conference after the meeting.

Ms. Rao said the platform would coordinate the efforts of participating organisations and expand the movement from national-level mobilisation to villages and local communities. "People have been on the streets. Now, we are going to set up our fight with a broader presence going forward," she said, adding that the organisations would work at every level "to demonstrate why the SIR exercise was wrong".

The platform, she said, was seeking the complete withdrawal of the SIR. Its demands included the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and changes to the process through which Election Commissioners are appointed.

Actor Prakash Raj addressing a press conference in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

'Fight for the country'

Mr. Raj alleged that the Union government's position regarding the protest showed that it was "protecting the CEC".

"Our Home Minister (Amit Shah) should be ashamed. People of this country, civil society, are asking questions to the Election Commission of India. Why is the government interfering?" he said. "This is the fight for the country. SIR will be scrapped, should be scrapped," he added.

Major participation

All India Kisan Sabha leader Rajan Kshirsagar said more than 100 farmers', workers', and youth organisations have agreed to join the nationwide agitation on October 23.

P. Krishna Prasad of the Akhil Bharatiya Kisan Sabha also said more than 200 people participated in the emergency meeting. "The platform will remain active until the SIR exercise is withdrawn and the CEC resigns. We will call meetings in every State, then at the block and booth levels," Mr. Prasad said, adding that the October 23 march would also be held in Delhi.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

ANNIVERSARY

JANANAM 02.03.1946 — MUKTHI 15.10.2000

Sri. R.RAGHURAMAN

In Fond Memory of our Former Joint Managing Director

Sri Lakshmi Saraswathi Textiles (Arni) Ltd.,

B.R. SLKPT

26th ANNIVERSARY
IN TREASURED MEMORY OF

SRI. R. RAGHURAMAN
(former Proprietor)
S.L.K.P.Transports,
Gudiyattam
Fondly remembered by
Staff & Family Members

12th ANNIVERSARY

29.04.1935 - 15.10.2014
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Rtd. CWS/S.Rly
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By Ramya & Prasanna
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प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापन सं० – PR 389807 Health Med Edu Family Welfare (26–27) D के अंतर्गत दिनांक – 21.09.2026 को रिम्स के प्रशासनिक भवन में आयोजित Walk In Interview को अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है

PR 391734 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare (26-27) D"

निदेशक, चिकित्सा शिक्षा
झारखंड
राँची

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HPPWD Division Hamirpur Distt. Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the item rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed in the table.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Time Limit
1.	Construction of (New Block for CBT) Examination Hall Rajya Chayan Aayog Hamirpur in the Premises of HPRCA District Hamirpur. (SH:- Part-I -Civil work- C/o Building portion including work stations, Water Supply and Sanitary Installation, Rain Water Harvesting Tank, Septic Tank, Site Development including boundary wall, gate) Part-II- Electrical work:- (SH:-SITC of E.I., LAN system, Access Control System, CCTV Surveillance System, Fire Alarm System, Fire Fighting & Sprinkler System, Power Backup & Elevator system therein.).	26,31,23,835/-	36,31,500/-	Nine Month

Deadline for submission of Bid : 15-10-2026
Starting date for downloading Bid : 08-10-2026

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer,
Hamirpur Division,
HPPWD, Hamirpur. Pin Code 177001
Telephone No. 01972-222510
e-mail: ee-ham-hp@nic.in
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

HP / 4113/26-27 HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer Ghumarwin Division HP-PWD, Ghumarwin on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the **Percentage Rate bids**, in electronic tendering system, from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table. The rates quoted by the bidder shall be **exclusive of GST**, as the estimated cost of the work has been prepared excluding GST. The bidder shall, therefore, quote his rates **without including GST.**

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Starting Date for downloading Bid.	Earnest Money	Deadline for submission of Bid.	Time Period
1.	Restoration of rain damages on Rohal khad lehri sarail Domehar Ghandalwin road km 0/00 to 13/00 (SH: C/o R/wall,B/wall, Providing and laying 30mm BC,Cement concrete pavement at varous RDs under PDNA 2022	Rs. 10623506/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 212500/-	22/10/2026	One Month
2.	C/o road Sushnal to Bepar km 0/00 to 0/810(SH: C/o of edge wall at RD 0/075 to 0/085 and construction of cement concrete pavement at RD 0/082 to 0/339 under MMSY work	Rs. 847401/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 20000/-	22/10/2026	One Month
3.	C/o Retaining wall to protect the Public Path near the House of Jagar Nath in village Cher GP Dadhol (SH: C/o R/wall and cement concrete pavement at varous reaches under MPLADS	Rs. 169465/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 3800/-	22/10/2026	One Month
4.	Construction of Ambulance road to Harizan Basti Bepar km 0/00 to 0/810 (SH: Providing and laying stone soling CC 1:1.5:3 from km 0/326 to 0/555 and Edge wall at km 0/380 to 0/387 under PMKKy Deposit	Rs. 773317/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 17000/-	22/10/2026	One Month
5.	C/o link road Upper Bhager Fatoh to Sarti Kallari km 0/00 to 1/500 (SH: C/o RCC slab culvert 15.00 mtr span at RD 0/235 under DMFT.	Rs. 6970914/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 140000/-	22/10/2026	One Month
6.	C/o Link road to lower patta from Bhadrog (SH: Metalling and Tarring at RD 0/3655 to 0/565 and Retaining wall at RD 0/076 to 0/084 under SDRF/NDRF.	Rs. 847064/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 20000/-	22/10/2026	One Month
7.	C/o Link road to SC Basti towards House of Manohar Singh,Desh Raj etc, village Gallian GP Karloti (SH: Providing and laying cement concrete pavement at varous damaged reaches under BASP	Rs. 169484/-	15/10/2026	Rs. 3800/-	22/10/2026	One Month

The Technical Bid of the above tenders will be open on dated 23/10/2026 at 11:00AM(if holiday on that day then next working day).The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in.

Executive Engineer,
Ghumarwin, Division.
HP.PWD. Ghumarwin.
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

HP / 4112/26-27 **HIM LOK SAMPARK.**

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Court issues fresh summons to Dhruv Rathee in 2018 defamation case

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court has issued a fresh summons to YouTuber Dhruv Rathee in a 2018 defamation case, noting that he has been living in Austria for the last seven years and has come to India for the ongoing protests in the national capital.

Judicial Magistrate Rahul Jain was hearing a plea filed by BJP IT Cell member Vikas Pandey seeking fresh summons to Mr. Rathee.

Mr. Pandey had filed the defamation suit after Mr. Rathee allegedly uploaded a video on his YouTube channel against him.

In its order dated October 12, the court directed that fresh summons be issued to Mr. Rathee at his address in Haryana's Gurugram.

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Letter No 947 — **Date Extension Notice-07** — Dated 14.10.2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances, due dates in respect of online Bid Identification No. T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27 are revised as follows:
Last Date /Time of Receipt of bid on the portal :28-10-2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.
Last Date /Time of submission of bid in Office : 30-10-2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of the bid on website : 30-10-2026 from 13:00 Hrs.
All other details and terms & conditions shall remain same. Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancelation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal **http://uktenders.gov.in.**

Executive Engineer (Solar)
"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

‘Blue drum’ murder case: court sentences victim’s wife, her ‘partner’ to death

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Saurabh Rajput’s mother and brother (second from left) in Meerut on Wednesday. ANI

A Meerut court on Wednesday sentenced Muskan Rastogi and her partner Sahil Shukla to death for murdering her husband Saurabh Rajput whose dismembered remains were found in a cement-filled plastic drum in March 2025.

Saurabh, a merchant navy officer, was killed on March 3 last year, and the body was discovered two weeks later.

District and Sessions Judge Arvind Kumar Mishra pronounced the sentence after convicting the duo of murder and destruction of evidence.

The case, which drew widespread attention because of the brutality of the crime, saw more than 100 hearings and the examination of 22 prosecution witnesses. Prosecution lawyer K.K. Chaubey told reporters that the judge referred to the Mahabharata while explaining the punishment, observing that “justice required punishment proportionate to the gravity of the offence”.

“Apart from the death sentence, the court also imposed fines totalling ₹70,000 on each convict for murder and the offence related to the disappearance of evidence,” Mr. Chaubey said.

Delhi CM listens to students’ concerns

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta conducted a surprise inspection of Mukherjee Nagar, an educational hub, on Tuesday night and interacted with students on issues, including women’s safety, access to free libraries, paying guest (PG) accommodation rents and basic amenities.

Ms. Gupta directed officials to improve cleanliness, ensure drinking water availability, upgrade street lighting and CCTV systems, and convert closed toilets into pink toilets, the official statement said on Wednesday.

She also asked officials to identify suitable spaces that could be developed into free libraries.

Timings
DELHI

THURSDAY, OCT. 15	
RISE 06:22	SET 17:52
RISE 10:41	SET 20:49
FRIDAY, OCT. 16	
RISE 06:22	SET 17:51
RISE 11:35	SET 21:41
SATURDAY, OCT. 17	
RISE 06:23	SET 17:50
RISE 12:23	SET 22:35

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	32	21
Safdarjang	32	21
Palam	31	21

Delhi Palam Today
34°C The weather will be warm. Night will be pleasant. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
30°C Fall in temperature. Day will be slight warm. Night will be pleasant. Spell of moderate rain and thundershower with gusty winds to occur.

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IIT Bombay student death: 30 detained during protest

Yohaan Ashish Varghese
MUMBAI

Around 25 to 30 protesters were detained outside the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay campus in Powai on Wednesday after several student organisations and activists staged a demonstration demanding justice for Sahil Wakode, who allegedly died by suicide last month. The protesters alleged that police personnel used force while detaining them, leaving some injured.

DCP (West Zone III) Datta Nalawade said the protesters had requested a meeting with IIT Bombay Director Shireesh Kedare, following which six representatives were taken to meet him.

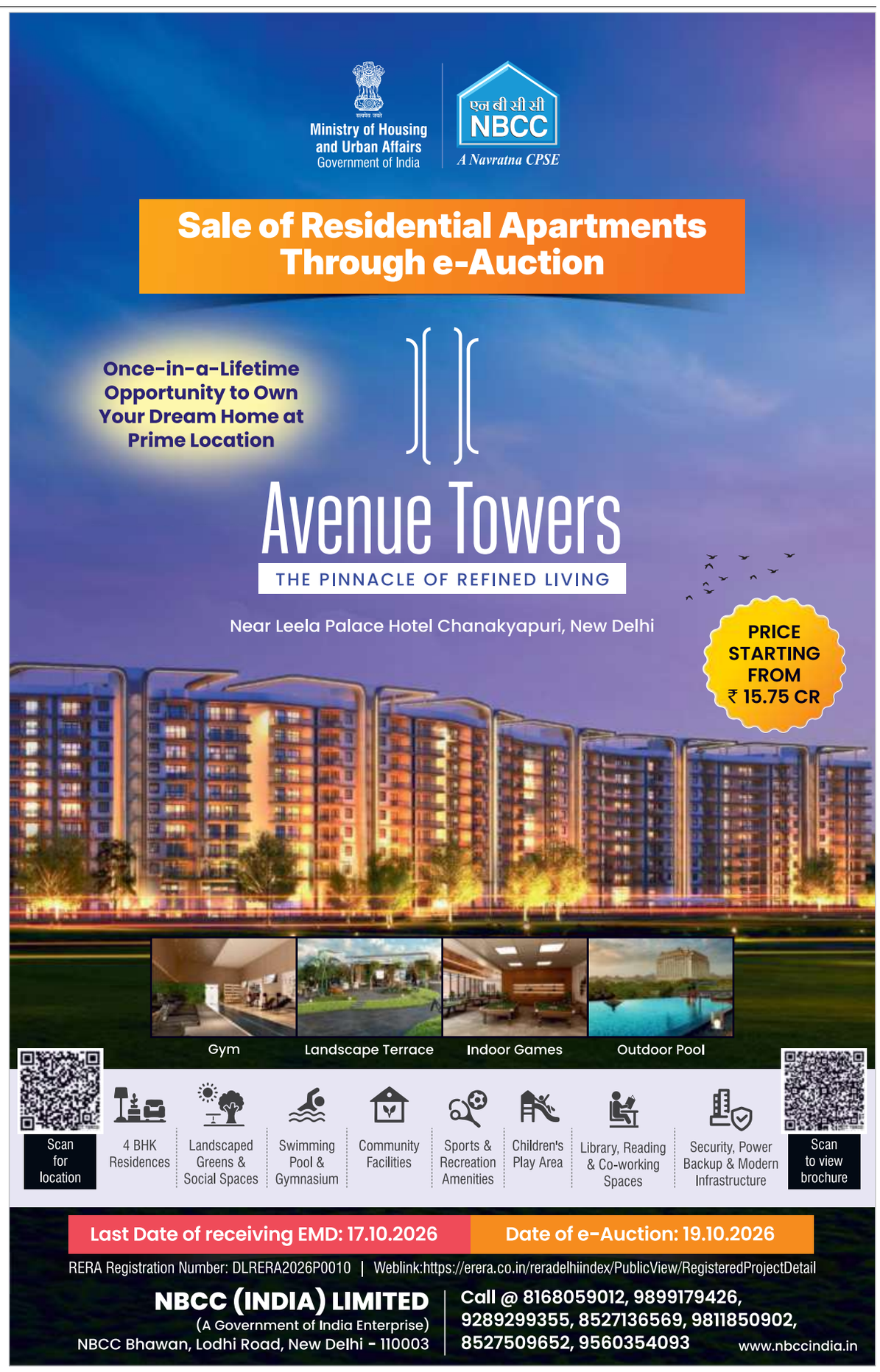
The remaining protesters were released shortly after they left for the meeting, he said.

Tejas Anoop, student representative of “*Aamchi Padhai, Aamchi Ladai*”, alleged that the police personnel forcibly detained demonstrators who had gathered outside Gate No. 2 of the campus at 12.30 p.m.

“They were forcefully trying to detain us. My waist is bruised. I asked for some medical assistance, but I didn’t receive any,” Mr. Anoop said.

A delegation, comprising Rahul Sonpimple, Deepali Salve, Tejas Anoop, Sambhaji Bhagat, Nitin More and Sunil Nirbhavane, subsequently met Mr. Kedare and submitted a letter raising concerns over the institute’s handling of Sahil Wakode’s death and the subsequent investigation.

(Those in distress can contact Tele MANAS at 14416 to seek help)



INBRIEF

Ankita Bhandari murder: Rahul, Priyanka meet protesting parents

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and his sister, Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, on Wednesday met the parents of late Ankita Bhandari, who were staging a sit-in protest near India Gate against the appointment of Dushyant Kumar Gautam as Governor of Sikkim. Ms. Bhandari, a receptionist at Vanantra Resort in Uttarakhand's Pauri district, was killed in 2022 by her employer, Pulkit Arya, the son of a BJP leader, and two of his aides. The investigation found that she was murdered after refusal to provide "special services" to a VIP. Her parents have alleged that Mr. Gautam was the VIP in question.

HC directs holding of rural polls in U.P. within 3 months

The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday directed the State Election Commission (SEC) to hold polls to panchayati raj institutions in Uttar Pradesh within three months. The order was passed by a Bench comprising Justices Ajit Kumar and Garima Prashad. The petitioner had moved the court seeking a direction to the SEC to place on record a detailed time-bound schedule for completion of the entire panchayat election process well before the expiry of district panchayats' tenure. The Congress and the Samajwadi Party lauded the HC directive and accused the BJP government of delaying the polls due to its 'fear of defeat'. PTI

Main accused in Punjab anti-drug activist murder held, shop burnt

Medical store owner arrested from Salasar in Rajasthan; local authorities demolish portion of his house in Veer Nagar, citing 'unauthorised construction'; bulldozer action also initiated at the store before angry protesters vandalise it and set it ablaze

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Authorities demolishing a portion of the house belonging to Ashwani Kumar, the main accused in the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota; (right) the accused's medical store engulfed in flames after protesters set it on fire in Mansa district on Wednesday. PTI & ANI

A day after anti-drug crusader Parvinder Singh Jhota was shot dead in Punjab's Mansa district, police arrested the main accused, Ashwani Kumar, from Salasar in Rajasthan on Wednesday.

An uneasy calm prevailed in the town, where an agitated crowd protested against the killing by raising slogans against the accused and setting his medical store and its furniture on fire.

A portion of the accused's house in Mansa's Veer Nagar was demolished by an excavator, with local authorities claiming that it was an "unauthorised construction". The bulldozer action was also initiated at Mr. Kumar's store located a few metres from the house. Protesters later vandalised the store and set it ablaze.

Jhota's murder in broad daylight at Mr. Kumar's medical store on Tuesday – when he confronted the latter for allegedly selling illegal addictive substances to a man – had sparked public outrage. A former boxer, Jhota had been running a campaign against drug abuse through the 'Nasha Roko, Rozgaar Do' drive. Heavy and elaborate security arrangements were put in place in the town to ensure peace as a group of people staged a protest in Mansa.

Following the murder, a joint action committee comprising various organisations gave a call for a Statewide shutdown in Punjab on October 15.

CBI probe sought

The protesters have demanded a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation and the post-mortem to be conducted at the Post-Graduate Institute of Medical Education and Research in Chandigarh.

Jhota's family has refused to cremate the body until the demands are met.

Deputy Inspector General of Police, Bathinda Range, Harjit Singh said an FIR has been registered against two persons.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said everyone responsible for the crime would face strict action. Urging people to maintain peace and communal harmony, Mr. Mann said, "Punjab has earned its peace through immense effort and sacrifice. We must protect this atmosphere of brotherhood and harmony at all costs. The government will take firm action against those responsible for the murder while ensuring that peace and law and order are maintained in the State."

He added that if the investigation reveals the involvement of any other individual or organisation in the murder, they will also not be spared.

Three rebel SP MLAs join BJP at U.P. event

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Three rebel MLAs from the Samajwadi Party (SP), formally joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday in Amethi. The induction formalises a split which started in February 2024 during the Rajya Sabha poll, when some MLAs cross-voted in favour of the BJP candidate. The rebel MLAs – Abhay Singh, Rakesh Pratap Singh, and Vinod Chaturvedi – joined the BJP at a function attended by senior BJP leaders, including Smriti Irani and U.P. BJP chief Pankaj Chaudhary.

Rakesh Pratap Singh is MLA from Gauriganj Assembly seat under Amethi district, while Abhay Singh is MLA from Goshainganj Assembly seat under Ayodhya district, and Vinod Chaturvedi is MLA from Kalpi under Jalaun district.

Reacting to the development, SP chief Akhilesh Yadav said such "people come and go".

He also claimed that people in Uttar Pradesh are distressed by the BJP government's misrule and that the ruling party's defeat in next year's Assembly election is certain.

BJD takes exception to Odisha Governor-designate's 'will work to strengthen BJP' statement

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Odisha Governor-designate Braj Mohan Ram. FILE PHOTO

The Biju Janata Dal (BJD) on Wednesday strongly objected to a comment by Odisha Governor-designate Braj Mohan Ram, who was quoted as saying that he would work towards strengthening the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) after assuming office.

"We are shocked to hear his response to a news agency, in which he reiterates that he would work toward strengthening the BJP party organisation," said Lenin Mohanty, BJD spokesperson, in a statement.

Mr. Mohanty said, "We condemn, the statement which negates the fact that Governor is above party politics."

68-year-old Mr. Ram was first elected to Bihar Legislative Assembly in 1991 and elected to the Lok Sabha in 1996 and 1998. After bifurcation of Bihar, he represented the Palamu Lok Sabha seat in Jharkhand.

Mr. Ram was not the first person from Jharkhand to become Governor of Odisha. Earlier, Raghubar Das, the former Jharkhand Chief Minister, had also held a gubernatorial role in the State. During his tenure, Mr. Das faced similar criticism from the BJD for his frequent visits to different districts. The BJD had then termed him an "agent" of the BJP in the State ahead of the 2024 Assembly poll.

Patnaik flays State govt.

Meanwhile, BJD chief Naveen Patnaik accused the State government of incompetence, alleging that people across sections were suffering and the future of Gen Z was bleak. Addressing a gathering during the BJD's Jan Sampark Padayatra here on Wednesday, he said the ruling party was focused on its own growth rather than the development of the State.

(With inputs from PTI)

HC seeks clarity on govt. accommodation for Azad and Raina

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

The High Court of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh on Wednesday sought clarity on the policy governing government accommodation for political leaders after it was informed that former J&K Chief Minister Ghulam Nabi Azad and senior Bharatiya Janata Party leader Ravinder Raina can retain their official residences till March next year following recommendations by a committee.

Hearing a public interest litigation filed by Professor S.K. Bhalla on October 12, a Division Bench of Chief Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati and Justice Rajesh Sekhri questioned the administration over the policy under which the two political leaders have been permitted to continue occupying government accommodation.

The court's observations followed the submission of Additional Advocate General (AAG) Monika Kohli that the retention of the residential accommodations were placed before a designated committee in its meeting held on August 14, 2026. The competent authority "allowed the retention of the residential accommodation until March 2027 or until the next review", the AAG informed the court.

"This court ... has posed a question as to what is the policy in the UT of Jammu and Kashmir, which governs the retention of government accommodation... And from where the designated committee derives its power to consider whether such government accommodation has to be retained by the political persons," the Bench asked.

The court posted the matter for November 12.

Maharashtra declares 40 more talukas drought-hit; farmers to get ₹5,000 aid before Deepavali

Snehal Mutha
MUMBAI

An empty water vessel sits on drought-hit farmland in Beed district. FILE PHOTO

The Maharashtra government on Wednesday declared 40 more talukas in the State drought-hit and decided to deposit an advance relief amount of ₹5,000 in the bank accounts of farmers ahead of Deepavali.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said, "More 40 regions are added, the drought measures will be implemented in all announced drought regions."

He also warned cooperative societies, district banks, nationalised banks and microfinance companies against pressuring farmers to recover loans.

The government had earlier declared 265 talukas drought-hit. With 40 more talukas added to the list, the total has risen to 305. Trigger 1 and Trigger 2 have been applied in these talukas, making them eligible for assistance under the Centre's National Disaster Response Fund (NDRF) guidelines. The measures include a complete waiver of examination fees for students in drought-hit talukas, without any eligibility criteria.

"The government will purchase the fodder cultivated by farmers at a guaranteed price to make fodder available for animals," Mr. Fadnavis said, outlining the fodder policy.

Minister of State for Relief and Rehabilitation Makrand Jadhav Patil said the government had decided to implement 12 measures to provide relief to farmers. These include exemption from land revenue, restructuring of crop loans, a stay on the recovery of agriculture-related loans, exemption from current electricity bills for agricultural pumps, and a waiver of examination fees for school and college students.

Water supply curbs

Meanwhile, the Pune Municipal Corporation has decided to suspend water supply across the city every Thursday from October 15. It will also prohibit the use of drinking water for construction and initiate closure of car washing centres.

Kolkata roads get a splash of colour ahead of Durga Puja; rainbow-coloured flyover triggers row after bikers skid

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

A view of the western flank of Gariahat Flyover, with its asphalt road painted yellow, orange, green and pink ahead of Durga Puja. ANI

Monotonous asphalt roads and busy flyovers in Kolkata are getting a colourful makeover with traditional 'alpona' motifs as part of a beautification drive ahead of Durga Puja. The Gariahat Bridge has turned into a rainbow of pink, orange, green, and yellow, while a large alpona design in contrasting red and white has appeared at the Park Circus seven-point crossing.

The initiative is part of a beautification drive by the new Bharatiya Janata Party government to give the city a makeover ahead of the festival.

Inspecting the work at Gariahat Bridge, West Bengal Urban Development Minister Agnimitra Paul described the initiative as a symbol of brotherhood, love and public trust.

While making an alpona – the traditional art of drawing designs on floors and other surfaces using liquid rice flour – at the busy Park Circus crossing, Ms. Paul said, "At Park Circus, where anti-India slogans were raised, fires were set, and police personnel and vehicles were attacked, large alpona designs are now being drawn. My brothers from minority communities have joined Hindu artists in creating these motifs."

She highlighted the participation of artists from minority communities alongside Hindu artists in creating the designs, particularly at Park Circus – a collaboration she described as a demonstration of communal harmony.

Ms. Paul said similar beautification work would also be done on Red Road, while the ghats along the Hooghly were being decorated ahead of the festival. She presented the collaboration as a gesture of intercommunity trust and invoked Prime Minister Narendra Modi's slogan, "Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, Sabka Prayas".

The BJP government is making an all-out effort to make its first Durga Puja in office a grand celebration. On October 10, during Mahalaya (the end of Pitru Paksha and the beginning of Devi Paksha), it also organised a mega event at the iconic Eden Gardens, featuring fireworks and drone shows.

Safety concerns

Meanwhile, videos of motorbikes skidding on a newly painted road in Kolkata went viral on Wednesday, raising safety concerns among riders and environmentalists ahead of the festival.

Ms.Paul said the roads had been painted in rainbow colours, "keeping safety guidelines in mind".

These paints will wear off in a few months, she said.

Environmentalist Somendra Mohan Ghosh said any move to beautify the city was welcome, but such paints should not be allowed on motorable roads.

(With inputs from PTI)

Weeks after probe report held him 'responsible' for Indore water tragedy, IAS officer made Collector

The Hindu Bureau
BHOPAL

Rohit Sisonia was among the officials suspended by M.P. CM after the incident

Just weeks after a judicial commission probe report on the Indore water contamination deaths was submitted to the Madhya Pradesh High Court, IAS officer Rohit Sisonia, then the Additional Commissioner (water supply) of Indore Municipal Corporation, who was one of the two officials held "primarily responsible" for the tragedy has been appointed Collector of Raisen district in a bureaucratic shuffle by the government.

The appointment has been criticised by the Opposition Congress with State unit president Jitu Patwari raising questions over the transparency of transfer and postings in the State. "Instead of accountability, favouritism is being prioritised in important postings," he wrote on X.

Mr. Sisonia, an IAS officer of the 2017 batch, was currently posted as Deputy Secretary in the Farmers Welfare and Agriculture Development Department. He has been made Raisen Collector in the reshuffle announced late on October 13 in which 23 IAS officers have been transferred.

After the tragedy in Indore's Bhagirathpura had come to light in December, 2025, Mr. Sisonia was among the officials who were suspended for negligence by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on January 2, 2026.

'Various lapses'

The one-member judicial panel of retired High Court judge, Justice Sushil Kumar Gupta, held Mr. Sisonia and the then executive engineer (water supply) Sanjeev Shrivastava "primary responsible" for for various lapses in inspections, carrying out repair works and several delays in projects to replace the water pipeline which further led to the tragedy.

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Electric mobility – the way ahead

Taranjit Singh Sandhu
Lieutenant-Governor of Delhi

The transition towards electric mobility is often discussed as a shift from one type of vehicle to another. In reality, it is a much broader transformation. E-mobility is the way forward for the nation's strategic, growth, and ecological trajectory and Delhi as the national capital will have to take the lead on this road ahead.

It concerns how we produce and consume energy, how our cities are planned, the technologies we develop, the industries we build and, ultimately, the quality of life we provide to our citizens.

India's mobility requirements are expanding rapidly. At the same time, we have to address energy security, air quality, urban congestion and climate change. This makes the transition, towards cleaner mobility, both an environmental necessity and an economic opportunity.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has observed that "clean mobility, powered by clean energy, is our most powerful weapon in our fight against climate change".

Electric mobility, therefore, cannot be considered in isolation. An electric vehicle is part of a larger ecosystem, involving batteries, charging infrastructure, electricity generation, storage, manufacturing, recycling, and digital systems.

For India, the objective must be to develop this ecosystem in a manner that is economically viable, technologically capable, and accessible to citizens.

There has already been significant progress in this direction. Government initiatives such as the FAME programme and the PM E-DRIVE scheme have supported the expansion of electric mobility. PM E-DRIVE with an outlay of ₹10,900 crore supports electric vehicles, charging infrastructure, and related testing infrastructure.

> E-mobility is the way forward for the nation's strategic, growth, and ecological trajectory and Delhi as the national capital will have to take the lead

But policy support is only one part of the transition. We must also develop the capabilities required to sustain electric mobility at scale. Battery technology, alternative materials, energy storage, and recycling will be particularly important.

A strong domestic EV ecosystem can create opportunities across engineering, electronics, software, battery manufacturing, component production, logistics, and related specialised services.

There is also a clear connection between electric mobility and India's broader industrial ambitions. The automobile sector can be an important platform for investment, technology partnerships, and participation in global value chains.

India has already begun moving in this direction with Made-in-India electric vehicles entering international markets.

Immediate significance

For Delhi, the transition has an even more immediate significance. As one of the world's major metropolitan regions, Delhi faces the interconnected challenges of mobility, air quality, congestion, and urban expansion. Cleaner public transport and personal vehicles can, therefore, contribute not only to reducing emissions but also to improving the everyday experience of citizens.

Delhi has already seen growing adoption of electric buses and other forms of cleaner mobility. The next step is to build an integrated system in which public transport, last-mile connectivity, charging infrastructure, and intelligent traffic management work together. This is particularly important for a city, where millions of people depend on public and shared transport every day.

The transition also presents an opportunity to strengthen Delhi's position as a centre for innovation and sustainable urban solutions.

Our universities, research institutions, entrepreneurs, and technology companies can contribute to developing solutions suited to the specific needs of Indian cities.

At the same time, electric mobility must remain accessible. The success of the transition cannot be measured only by the number of electric vehicles on our roads. It must also be measured by whether citizens have reliable public transport, convenient charging facilities, and cleaner and more efficient ways of moving around the city.

Delhi, with more registered vehicles than the other three metropolitans put together, provides an important platform for bringing these perspectives together. The next stage of India's electric mobility journey will require collaboration between government, industry, academia, and financial institutions. We need innovation that can be deployed at scale, investment that builds long-term capabilities, and infrastructure integrated with wider urban and energy systems.

Above all, we need a mobility transition centred on the citizen.

Electric mobility is ultimately not only about the vehicle. It is about cleaner air, efficient movement, technological capability, economic opportunity, and a more sustainable urban future.

I hope the efforts being undertaken in Delhi contribute to this larger conversation and importantly to practical solutions that can move from discussion to implementation.

Delhi govt. approves new industrial policy; focus on clean tech

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi CM Rekha Gupta

The Delhi government has approved a new industrial policy that outlines a ten-year road map for developing a clean, knowledge-based industrial economy in the Capital, with a focus on high-value, non-polluting sectors, according to a statement from the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) said on Wednesday.

Under The Industrial Policy, 2026, special incentives will be given for 10 priority sectors, including Information Technology (IT), global capability centres, data centres, healthcare, research and modern manufacturing, as per the CMO.

"Women-led micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) will receive additional support for business modernisation and expansion. Employers hiring women will receive higher incentives for each woman recruited. These provisions aim to expand business and employment opportunities for women entrepreneurs and employees," read the statement.

The policy also provides for an expenditure of ₹1,000 crore on the Mukhyamantri Udyamshree Yojana over five years, from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31, with the objective of promoting new industries and generating greater job opportunities.

CM Rekha Gupta said the policy focuses on making better use of the Capital's economic potential by encouraging advanced technology, research, specialised services and high-value-added firms.

INBRIEF

Aravana production resumes at Sabarimala after a month

The production of *Aravana* (rice-jaggery offering) resumed at Sabarimala on Wednesday morning after a month-long shutdown of the production plant for renovation and capacity expansion. The Travancore Devaswom Board, which manages the Ayyappa temple in Pathanamthitta district of Keralam, said the unit will initially produce around 1.5 lakh tins a day, with output expected to rise to 3.5 lakh tins daily after October 20. The shortage of *Aravana* during last month's puja had triggered widespread protests among devotees.

A.P. SEC announces poll schedule for local bodies

Andhra Pradesh State Election Commissioner Anil Chandra Punetha on Wednesday announced the election schedule for Municipal Corporations and Municipalities, Mandal and Zilla Parishad Territorial Constituencies, and Gram Panchayats. With this, the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) came into force, prohibiting the government from launching new welfare schemes and development projects. The election process is scheduled to be completed by December 2, 2026, Mr. Punetha said at a press conference on Wednesday.

Private bus operators to begin hunger strike from October 27

Office-bearers of the Kerala State Private Bus Operators Federation will launch an indefinite hunger strike in front of the Secretariat from October 27, demanding measures to protect the private bus sector, which they claim has been adversely affected by the State government's Priyadarshini free-travel scheme. The decision to hold the hunger strike was announced following a march to the Secretariat, organised here on Wednesday, raising various demands. Hundreds of bus owners, including women, participated in the march, which began at the Martyrs' Column.

Prashanth to carry golden howdah at Jamboo Savari

The 54-year-old tusker, Prashanth, has been selected as the lead elephant for this year's Jamboo Savari, succeeding veteran Abhimanyu, who has retired from active Dasara duties at the age of 60 after carrying the golden howdah for six consecutive years. Prashanth will carry the 750-kg howdah during the Vijayadashami procession on October 21, leading the Dasara elephant squad before thousands of spectators. His selection was announced at a press meet at Mysuru Palace on Wednesday in the presence of Minister in-charge of Mysuru district Yathindra Siddaramaiah.

ED attaches assets of dairy firms in TTD ghee case

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

The Enforcement Directorate (ED), Hyderabad Zonal Office, has provisionally attached assets worth ₹129.85 crore belonging to dairy companies, their promoters and related entities in connection with the alleged supply of adulterated ghee to the Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams (TTD).

The assets belong to Bhole Baba Organic Dairy-milk Private Limited; Sri Vyshnavi Dairy Specialities Private Limited, their promoters Vipin Jain and Pomil Jain and their family members; Sukriti Foods Private Limited, its promoter Kailash Chand Mangla and his family members, besides other related entities and individuals.

Three from Keralam killed in building fire in Germany

The victims were identified as Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district, Sivin Johny from Ernakulam, and Nova Sabu from Idukki; investigators suspect arson; a Romanian national has been arrested

The Hindu Bureau
KOLLAM/IDUKKI

Tragic loss: Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district and Nova Sabu from Idukki. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Three people hailing from Keralam have lost their lives in a devastating apartment building fire in Bochum, Germany. The victims were identified as Anjali Sheela Joy from Kollam district, Sivin Johny from Ernakulam district, and Nova Sabu from Idukki district.

In the wake of the tragedy, Tourism Minister P.C. Vishnunath said the government had initiated necessary action to bring the bodies back to Keralam. He said that authorities are actively coordinating with NORKA and the Indian Embassy in this regard. He also spoke to Ms. Joy's family. Ms. Joy had gone abroad for higher education. Ms. Sabu was from Santhigram near Kattappana in Idukki. A fitness trainer, she had moved to Germany six months ago for a job. Mr. Johny had gone to Germany only about a fortnight ago for higher studies.

Police have arrested a 41-year-old resident of the building on suspicion of murder. He is a Romanian national, German news channel *n-tv* reported, citing the German Press Agency *Deutsche Presse-Agentur (DPA)*. A Bochum police spokesperson told *WDR* that there were initial grounds for suspicion of murder against the man, who had been questioned by officers from the homicide squad.

Police and prosecutors announced the arrest on Wednesday.

Investigators have ruled out a technical defect as the cause of the fire and suspect arson, but whether the fire was deliberately set or started accidentally remains under investigation. The fire broke out in a multi-family residential building in Bochum's Hofstede district.

(With inputs from PTI)

LDF, UDF trade barbs over power situation

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam Assembly on Wednesday witnessed heated exchanges between the United Democratic Front (UDF) government and the Opposition Left Democratic Front (LDF) over power cuts during the monsoon and a scrapped long-term power purchase deal.

Blaming the power crisis on the "inefficiency" of the UDF government, the Opposition staged a walkout after its demand that the House adjourn the day's business and discuss the issue was rejected.

Moving the adjournment motion, G.R. Anil of the Communist Party of India alleged that the crisis was artificially created with the knowledge of the government to pave the way for power sector corporates to enter the State's power sector.

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said the Kerala State Electricity Board (KSEB), which manages power generation, transmission and distribution within Keralam, would be maintained in the public sector. He said KSEB would be transformed into the "best institution" and that his government intended to float a power policy aimed at addressing the long-term needs of the State.

The Opposition accused the government of viewing the power situation lightly and failing to take adequate precautions despite indications of a potential crisis in May and June.

Migrant workers in Bengaluru caught in SIR maze

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

In Bengaluru's Varthur-Balagere, at least five settlements sit alongside gated apartments and tech parks, where migrant workers from West Bengal have been living in makeshift tents for ₹3,000 to ₹4,000 a month. Women work in these apartments as cooks or helpers, while the men work as cleaners, scrap collectors or delivery partners for instant food and service apps.

"We are four siblings, but we were issued an SIR notice saying more than six progeny are linked to the same person [father]. What followed were multiple loans, totalling more than a lakh, that I took to make repeated trips to my native village, running from pillar to post, but the name, they [officials] say, is 'under adjudication'," said Rafiul Mohammed.

"Our neighbours say we (his family) will be sent to Bangladesh because we could not prove ourselves. But we did whatever we were asked."

Some said that even after submitting documents, their names were deleted from the rolls. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Like Mr. Mohammed, more than 3,500 people, according to the Karnataka Bengali Kalyan Samiti, formed by and for West Bengal-based workers in Bengaluru, are "under adjudication for logical discrepancy", even as the enrolment drive has started across States by the Election Commission of India, where deleted and left-out voters can reapply via Form-6 to seek inclusion.

'Family size' an issue

In West Bengal, more than 20 lakh names will not be part of this enrolment drive as these cases are currently pending before the appellate tribunals.

Many of these workers told *The Hindu* that they feel they were targeted because of their "family size".

Others described how the process had left them in cycles of debt, as they had to repeatedly travel to West Bengal to establish their identities.

Some of them said that even after submitting documents, their names were deleted from the electoral rolls, leaving them uncertain about the voter-linked welfare benefits their families received back home.

'CBI probe not needed in sting operation case'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Home Minister Priyank Kharge on Wednesday ruled out a CBI probe into the alleged sting operation, asserting that the Karnataka Police were capable of investigating the matter.

He claimed that the CBI was still to complete two or three cases entrusted to it.

Czech Deputy PM inaugurates aerospace facility

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka CM D.K. Shivakumar with Czech Republic Deputy PM Karel Havlíček at Vidhana Soudha in Bengaluru. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Czech Republic Deputy Prime Minister Karel Havlíček, on a visit to Bengaluru on Wednesday, inaugurated a new production line of Gopalan Aerospace India Private Limited (GAIPL) at its Hoskote facility.

Five MoUs signed

Five Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) were also signed between the company and its Czech partners in five areas of potential collaboration, which include fire-extinguishing solutions, Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs) like fixed-wing drones, quadcopters and related systems, thermo reflective coating technology, unmanned traffic management systems and jet-powered UAVs.

Industrial cooperation

The company said that the agreements establish a basis for exploring complementary technologies, industrial cooperation and potential manufacturing opportunities across aerospace, defence and advanced engineering.

GAIPL said that it has invested approximately $40 million in its 10.5-acre Hoskote facility, which houses more than 1,50,000 sq. ft. of manufacturing infrastructure.

Its capabilities span precision CNC machining, sheet metal fabrication, aerostructures, and complex assemblies, supported by Build-to-Print and Build-to-Spec solutions.

Illogical reasons

Delhi's 'logical discrepancy' flags suggest a design that targets Muslims

That the ECI's SIR of electoral rolls has been flawed by design and tuned to exclude genuine electors rather than ensure their full enrolment is now well established. *The Hindu*'s investigation of Delhi's draft rolls and the names that the ECI flagged as "logical discrepancies" shows that the process is not only exclusionary but also insidious. The arbitrary nature of these "discrepancies", especially those relating to family size, suggests that they were chosen to target communities with higher, though declining, fertility rates, for exclusion. Muslims make up 13.6% of Delhi's draft rolls – in line with the 2011 Census – but accounted for 20.3% of those flagged for "logical discrepancies". This number goes up to 30% for those flagged under the five reasons linked to family size. None of these criteria bears on the eligibility of an elector, who should be an Indian citizen, at least 18, ordinarily resident in the constituency and should not be disqualified under the law. Following *Lal Babu Hussein* (1995), a name on an earlier electoral roll has probative value as evidence of citizenship and cannot be struck off without inquiry. The children an elector has, a parent's age at the elector's birth or name spelling are unconnected; neither the ECI's Manual on Electoral Rolls (2023) nor its SIR of 2002-03 provided for such checks.

When the ECI began the SIR in Bihar, the enrolment and claims and objections phases had their infirmities but there was no direct or indirect discrimination by religion. *The Hindu* estimated that 18.4% of those deleted from Bihar's pre-SIR rolls were Muslims, in line with their population share (17.7%, 2011 Census). But in the SIR's Phase 2 in West Bengal, the ECI introduced the "logical discrepancies" check midway. Electors already on draft rolls were flagged on unexplained criteria with ECINET software rather than the statutory Electoral Registration Officers deciding on who got flagged. The impact was severe – 27 lakh electors were deleted following adjudication by judicial officers, after being flagged overwhelmingly for "logical discrepancies"; 22 lakh appealed but just 1,607 electors were reinstated in time for the vote. By September, nearly 93% of the 1.26 lakh appeals that were decided had restored electors to the rolls – an indication of large-scale disenfranchisement before the vote. A sample-based analysis of those excluded after adjudication estimated a much higher share of Muslims than their population share. The same process has now been carried over to Phase 3, including Delhi, where *The Hindu*'s investigation shows a clear skew against Muslim electors. The Supreme Court must now halt the SIR, as a process built on arbitrary criteria with no basis in electoral law, and which discriminates against specific communities, should not be allowed to firm up electoral rolls.

Drugs and bullets

Punjab is seeing a rise in narcotrafficking and targeted killings

A chemist has been charged with killing anti-drug-trafficking activist Parvinder Singh Jhota after his allegedly illegal drug business came under threat. Separately, social media influencer Mad Sandhu was allegedly the victim of a premeditated, transnational syndicate hit that used interstate escape routes. Both events in Punjab involved digital platforms and both events expose a dire gap in public safety. While Mr. Jhota's alleged murderer was a local chemist, the macro-level drug trade in Punjab is intertwined with gangster networks, with the cross-border drug smuggling known to be a key source of illicit funds. Together with a string of targeted killings of police personnel and local politicians, the incidents depict a Punjab caught between local drug trafficking and citizens resorting to vigilantism and crime syndicates carrying out assassinations with disquieting ease. Some events have also raised suspicions of cross-border support and a demand to involve enforcement agencies. The AIIMS Magnitude of Substance Use in India survey estimated that in 2017-18 – the latest year for which it is available – 1.28% of Punjab's population aged 10-75 years had an opioid dependence, versus 0.26% nationally. NCRB data also recorded 106 drug overdose deaths in 2024 versus 89 in 2023, in Punjab, likely an undercount since attribution depends on medical certification and excludes long-term complications and unhygienic habits associated with drug use.

Punjab's geopolitical location renders it an important entry point and market, with the security apparatus hampered by smugglers using multiple transport modes. The Global Initiative Against Transnational Organized Crime reported in June that India's pharmaceutical and chemicals industries also provide bad actors with ample opportunities to divert controlled substances or precursors for illicit use. The State's 'Yugh Nashian Virudh' campaign of 2025 has also claimed 68,850 arrests of alleged traffickers and the attachment or confiscation of assets valued ₹319 crore. However, cases registered differ from convictions and asset attachment differs from forfeiture. Mr. Jhota's hostile tactics also enjoyed public support, and authorities need to examine why the people are overlooking formal reporting channels. Under its narcotics policy, the State has to reduce the availability of harmful drugs, disrupt wholesale supply chains, identify corrupt facilitators, and expand access to rehabilitative care. Paralleling investigations into the coordination of targeted killings, an anti-trafficking strategy must also probe the financing and logistics of networks, to dismantle institutional collusion, and better protect threatened individuals.

A split verdict, faltering remedies and people's power

Kaleeswaram Raj

A lawyer who argued in support of the Petitioners in Anoop Baranwal (2023) and Dr. Jaya Thakur (2026)

Jaya Thakur underscores the limits of judicial intervention and the enduring power of people's movements to defend the Constitution

In *Dr. Jaya Thakur vs Union of India*, a two-judge Bench of the Supreme Court of India was faced with a challenge to the 2023 law governing the appointment of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs). On September 23, 2026, the Court delivered a split verdict. Justice Dipankar Datta held that, since a Constitution Bench in *Anoop Baranwal* (2023) had settled the constitutional position on the mechanism for selecting the CEC and the ECs, the challenge to the 2023 Act needed to be examined in light of the principles laid down in that judgment. The *Baranwal* approach is simple and straightforward: a committee with executive predominance cannot be entrusted with selecting impartial umpires such as the CEC and the ECs. A three-member committee comprising the Prime Minister and another Union Minister clearly demonstrates such executive predominance.

Therefore, the law governing the selection and appointment of the CEC and the ECs must consciously avoid these vices. Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, however, held that, given the importance of the issues involved, the case should be referred to a larger Constitution Bench. After delivering separate and divergent opinions, the judges also passed a common order expressing their desire for an expeditious hearing of the case by a Constitution Bench.

There will be a further delay

The net result of the present order is that a decision on the validity of the legislation governing the appointment of the CEC and the ECs will take further time. A statute that is, on the face of it, illegitimate and unconstitutional will have an extended lifespan solely because of the reference ordered on the basis of Justice Satish Chandra Sharma's opinion. This law, as it is now evident, envisages a Prime Minister's Committee to select the CEC and the ECs, with the Prime Minister and the Cabinet Minister chosen by him forming two-thirds of the Committee, making the Opposition leader's presence merely ornamental.

Had this Bench struck down the controversial law on its own, it would have radically altered India's electoral and judicial history, particularly at a time when people at large are sceptical of electoral institutions and the electoral process. That did not happen. The legitimacy of the 2023 law and the decisions of the Commission are now being questioned by Opposition parties and others, including the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). Protests are mounting across the country, with many people calling for the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner, Gyanesh Kumar.

The impact

This demand has a strong moral basis. However, replacing an individual alone cannot provide a permanent solution to systemic flaws. The Court has failed to take up the issue in time, and the present order referring the matter to a larger Bench in Dr. Jaya Thakur will, in effect, amount to an institutional confession of this failure. The statute that overturns the *Baranwal* principle and grants the CEC and the ECs lifelong immunity for their acts and words while in the office, needs to be repealed. A fresh law that incorporates the principle of a neutral body selecting the CEC and the ECs, thereby ensuring neutral umpires in the Commission, should be put in place. It is equally important to revisit the controversial revision of electoral rolls and undo its consequences.

The order in Dr. Jaya Thakur contains certain political and moral lessons. Although it does not decide the challenge, some of Justice Datta's observations are significant. The judge quoted Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's speech of October 28, 1951: "We also find that the Government servants are influencing the elections in favour of the party which is feeding them and their dependents. No less a personality than Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee, at the inaugural session of the Bhartiya Jan Sangh at Delhi recently, openly charged the Government servants of helping the Congress and thereby nullifying the elections from being free and fair. ..... If Parliamentary Democracy fails in this country and it is bound to fail for the reasons mentioned by me, the only result will be rebellion, anarchy and Communism".

History magnifies and inverts reality, inviting the ruling dispensation, which claims the legacy of Shyama Prasad Mukherjee, to confront its own mirror image. Today, amid institutional capture and what is described as centrally orchestrated mass disenfranchisement, Dr. Ambedkar's warning is all the more relevant.

The split judgment has become controversial for another reason as well. The fact that Justice Satish Chandra Sharma's son has served as an empanelled standing counsel for the Election Commission before the Madhya Pradesh High Court raises the possibility of a conflict of interest.

The judge's failure to disclose this association at any point has invited speculation about the impartiality of the adjudicative process. This shatters the moral and even legal foundation of Justice Sharma's order referring the matter to a Constitution Bench, thereby further delaying a decision on the case. Recently, petitions have been filed in the Court for recalling and nullifying Justice Sharma's order. In *Rupa Ashok Hurra vs Ashok Hurra* (2002), a Constitution Bench had indicated that failure on the part of a judge to disclose his connection with the subject-matter or the parties would vitiate the judgment, warranting a revisit.

The Bangalore Principles of Judicial Conduct state that "a judge shall avoid impropriety and the appearance of impropriety in all of the judge's activities". They also stipulate that "a judge shall not participate in the determination of a case in which any member of the judge's family represents a litigant or is associated in any manner with the case". The Restatement of Values of Judicial Life, adopted by the Court in May 1997, contains similar prohibitions.

Beyond the courts

Now, back to the 2023 law. As the country's history has shown, political struggles can have a larger dimension than judicial proceedings. As regarding the draconian laws, the Terrorist and Disruptive Activities (Prevention) Act (TADA) was allowed to lapse and the Prevention of Terrorism Act (POTA) was repealed by the Centre, even though they had earlier received the Court's endorsement.

The National Emergency (1975-77) was upheld by the Court in judgments, including the infamous ADM Jabalpur case (1976), which upheld the suspension of fundamental rights. Ultimately, the people voted Mrs. Gandhi's regime out of power in the subsequent election. Likewise, the controversial farm laws were repealed by Parliament in 2021 following massive protests.

In short, a political and moral reading of the split verdict in *Dr. Jaya Thakur* takes us beyond the Court to recognise the Constitution's potential for survival through peaceful people's movements.

India's China+1 lessons lie within its own States

P.S. Srinivas

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Anisha Sircar

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Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are leading examples of how industrial ecosystems attract global manufacturers

"Don't look at India – look at what's happening with specific States," a veteran investor told these writers in one of 50 interviews with senior industry executives, policymakers and experts for a 2026 study at the East Asian Institute on how global firms are reworking their China+1 plans.

However, the national conversation tends to run the other way. Every few months, someone advises India to study Vietnam's industrial parks, Mexico's nearshoring or Poland's supply chains. Meanwhile, two instructive case studies sit right at home – in Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. Global firms do not choose "India" as a homogenous monolithic edifice. They choose a State, and with it, the land, power supply, approvals, workers and suppliers.

Two States, their approaches

At Sriperumbudur, near Chennai, Foxconn employs tens of thousands of people assembling iPhones. Tata Electronics has expanded at Hosur. In January 2026, the Centre approved projects in Tamil Nadu under its Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), including mobile-phone enclosure units by Yuzhan Technology, a Foxconn-linked firm, and Tata Electronics. These are commitments rather than finished factories, but they reflect the advantages of an industrial ecosystem that has taken decades to build.

None of this began with China+1. Tamil Nadu invested in technical education, built an automobile and components industry around Chennai, and developed the suppliers, skills and administrative experience that new manufacturers look for. Several investors told us that policy continuity is essential and that commitments must be honoured regardless of political turnover. That is now being tested following the change of government in Tamil Nadu in May 2026. One academic respondent argued that Tamil Nadu would have done well irrespective of China. Its industrial base took four or five decades to build; no announcement of an industrial park or round of subsidies can conjure that up. Karnataka followed a different path. Bengaluru began with software and engineering talent, and not Chennai's automobile base. Foxconn's 300-acre campus at Devanahalli, where women reportedly form about 80% of the workforce, aims to create around 50,000 jobs. Tata Electronics took over Wistron's iPhone plant at Narsapura, in a deal agreed in late 2023, and has grown rapidly since.

Tamil Nadu faces limits in land, power and labour, and relies on migrant workers from the northern and central States. It is now seeking to move beyond labour-intensive assembly towards more capital-intensive manufacturing and innovation-led exports.

National policy, State-level delivery

National incentives are integral, too. One manufacturer explained the combined effect of tariffs and production-linked incentives (PLI): "If the duty is 20 per cent and I get a PLI of 6 per cent, competitors cannot compete with me. This is working right here." The PLI scheme for large-scale electronics manufacturing ended on March 31, 2026, and the Cabinet approved a successor on July 15. In January, the Centre cleared 22 proposals under the ECMS, worth ₹41,863 crore and expected to create 33,791 direct jobs across eight States. The Centre describes this spread as "geographically balanced industrial growth". In March, the Cabinet approved easing Press Note 3, which introduced curbs in 2020 on investment from countries sharing a land border with India. These measures help attract investment, but whether that investment takes root depends on what individual States can offer. The factory still has to come up somewhere.

Still, Tamil Nadu ranks only fifth in the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade's (DPIIT) data on foreign direct investment (FDI) equity inflows for October 2019 to March 2026, accounting for about 6%. This is behind Maharashtra (31%), Karnataka (21%), Gujarat (15%) and Delhi (13%).

However, DPIIT records FDI against the State in which the receiving company has its head office, rather than where the money is spent. So, the figures tell us little about where factories are being built.

Assembly is only the first step. One electronics executive told us that "very few components are manufactured in India" and that there is still a "huge reliance on China for major parts and supply chains". Backward linkages remain thin. Another respondent said his firm had set a billion-dollar target for sourcing in India but, after two or three years, had managed to source "about 600 million out of that". Such ecosystems cannot be built in a hurry: "Value addition is a process which takes time – it is a four-to-five-year process."

Electronics exports touched about $48 billion in 2025-26, while imports stood at about $116 billion. Although export growth is impressive, the trade gap suggests that India still has considerable ground to cover in component manufacturing. One executive described the exports as "assembled products with 20 per cent inputs in India".

India's industrial divide

Concentration also carries risks. One respondent said growth is "largely happening in the southern and western parts, not in the most populous States such as Bihar, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand".

Spreading subsidies thinly will not, by itself, replicate Tamil Nadu's supplier networks or Karnataka's technical labour pool. The key questions are what these States did to prepare land, train workers, clear approvals, nurture suppliers and retain investors, and which of these measures can be replicated, and what rests on decades of accumulated capacity.

India's China+1 debate keeps looking abroad for a model, even as some of the most instructive factories have been coming up all along on the outskirts of Chennai and Bengaluru.

This article draws on 50 interviews for the EAI Special Report, "India, China, and the 'China+1' Strategies of Global Firms" (September 2026), and on P.S. Srinivas, Frank N. Pieke and Alfred Schipke, "India, China and the China+1 Strategy", Global Policy (2026)

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Grand goals, ground reality

On completing 25 years in power, the Prime Minister has set ambitious goals: making India one of the world's three largest economies, venturing into space, achieving Atmanirbhar Bharat, turning India into a global manufacturing hub and hosting the Olympics. The new slogan is "We can do it". We certainly can. But these goals do little to address the immediate concerns of ordinary citizens. While economic growth has created billionaires and numerous multimillionaires, it has failed to ease the common man's daily struggles. With space opening up to private players, public resources could further enrich them, while the common man will have to be content watching rockets being launched. Atmanirbhar Bharat remains an aspiration, with India still dependent on China for critical imports. The ambition to become a global manufacturing hub is welcome, but industrial growth has yet to generate adequate employment or move decisively beyond assembly to domestic production. Hosting the Olympics, too, seems misplaced when millions struggle to access basic necessities. A leader's greatness should be measured not merely by years in office or grand ambitions, but by how many people are freed from material hardship.

A.G. Rajmohan,
Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh

Protest grounds

It is a calculated move to say citizens may protest anywhere, as long as nobody in power will hear them. Jantar Mantar mattered because it sat near Parliament, and its replacements are four, 13 and 15 kilometres away (October 13). Distance alone might be defended, but the details are worse. Ramlila Maidan, the nearest, reportedly has just three dates, all in the last week of December, with an initial booking cost of over ₹1.21 lakh. Jantar Mantar had no comparable fee. A right to protest that must be booked months ahead and paid for in lakhs is a right for the well-funded, not the aggrieved. Students, farmers and workers protest because they have little, and they cannot buy their way to a hearing. Call it an order on venues if you like. In effect, it prices dissent out of the capital, then points to the fine print to say nothing was banned.

Yashvi Patel,
Anand, Gujarat

The gaps in health care

Modern medicine increasingly suffers from a "tunnel vision" approach. The result is fragmented care, where prescriptions are issued in isolation. Equally troubling is the growing reliance on lab reports, with doctors rarely examining patients. Strengthening primary health care, expanding geriatric medicine and fostering communication among specialists can restore trust and safety.

H.N. Ramakrishna,
Bengaluru

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Satyagraha for Constitution-as-commons

Kalpana Kannabiran

Advanced Fellow, Vienna Centre for Advanced Studies, University of Vienna. Views expressed are personal

The events unfolding on the streets of India signal the emergence of a new language of citizenship and a new language of the Constitution. This has been in the making over the past decade and a half. It has taken its time as fashioning a new language and grammar of justice is a process that has to distil public anger against the criminal dispossession by this government. The public face of criminal dispossession brazenly glares down at us: from dwellings and homes, savings, education, and now voting rights.

This is the time when it all comes together – through the fearless confrontation of young protesters with a disproportionately weaponised police; when only those political leaders, who are out on the streets engaging with the armed state in the same manner in which these (extra)ordinary protestors are, retain public credibility and legitimacy; when lawyers preparing to defend resisters (and themselves) know that they will be huddled into vans and booked for practising their profession. This is the time when self-styled monarchs who took possession of their seats of power, grabbed through a daylight robbery of votes, can no longer sit on them, but instead hide behind them, cowering in fear.

This is also the time when judges repeat endless platitudes about how the only protests deserving of judicial attention are 'lawful protests', and assert meekly (within the enclosure of the court) that they are bound by 'judicial discipline' in considering the lawful right to bail for prisoners such as Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam. They make this assertion without stopping to reflect on the unlawful mayhem let loose by the 'rulers' against whom 'lawful protest' is an oxymoron. How does one 'lawfully' challenge the government's politics of maiming, when what has been maimed is the law and courts? To protest is unlawful under authoritarianism; it is lawful in a constitutional democracy. The ruling *diktat* has labelled the common citizen as an *andolanjeevi* – a new extra-statutory category of criminal – who stands accused of the crime of being a citizen who knows their rights. That judges and courts fail to redefine the fundamental meaning of 'judicial discipline' and 'lawful public action' at a time when the Constitution is under siege is tragic.

> The resisters out on the streets today are those who hold Gandhi's talisman and Ambedkar's Preamble in their fight to restore to the people of this country control over their lives

Duty to the nation

This is the country where satyagraha was born and takes new forms at different times. We have now reached a turning point as a country. This fire in our belly must be quelled; not through the use of pellet guns, lathis, and courtly intimidations, but through peaceful protest. It is our birthright.

The Constitution is our commons. It provides the normative ethical framework for citizenship and shared humanity. It speaks to a just future that guarantees dignity, self-respect, autonomy and solidarity while being mindful of discrimination and structural violence, that must be eliminated. Dignity and shared humanity lie at its core – a guarantee of citizenship as birthright. This idea of the 'Constitution-as-commons' helps in bridging different pathways to imagine an idea of justice. In elaborating on this, we need to bring together popular imaginations of justice that we see opening out before us, predicated on the constitutional convivialities made possible by this popular uprising and its precursors.

Courts and judges need to understand this 'constitutional jurisprudence from the streets' and its interpretive methods through a welcoming acknowledgement of the pedagogic import of this collective constitutionalism. This shift in the country has been nothing short of a glimpse at a utopia; therefore, it is important, theoretically and politically, to trace the contours of this possibility – not just for India, but through the Indian experience for a more holistic, pluriversal understanding, without losing sight of the fact that justice is always spatially rooted. That space is now no longer the reductionist enclosure of the court, nor even the fortified monument that is Parliament, but the 'outside'. The streets, under the open skies, is where the Constitution resides today.

Conviviality and the cultural politics of care, as the conscientious resisters demonstrate to us today, can only be located in the context of civic resistance against state violence in India. This politics of care, of which protest and resistance is part, challenges crimes by the state. The resisters out on the streets today are those who hold Gandhi's talisman and Ambedkar's Preamble in their fight to restore to the people of this country control over their lives.

The myth of 'unskilled' labour

Vasudevan Mukunth

According to the Safe in India Foundation, unskilled workers earning under ₹8,000 a month in the automotive sector lost 2.27 fingers per accident on average in 2024 versus 1.54 fingers for skilled workers earning more than ₹20,000. Earlier this year, thousands of industrial workers protested their stagnant wages across Noida and New Delhi. The Uttar Pradesh government responded by giving 'unskilled' workers an interim hike of ₹13,690 a month and 'skilled' workers ₹16,868, despite both groups facing the same inflation.

Based on assessing migrant labourers in Keralam's construction and hospitality sectors, the International Institute of Migration and Development, Thiruvananthapuram, has estimated that 'unskilled' workers experienced 40% more wage theft than skilled workers. Factories often use the label 'unskilled' to justify withholding annual increments, health benefits, and safety training. The Safe in India Foundation report attributed the higher severe injury rate among 'unskilled' workers to employers often tasking such workers with operating dangerous power press machines without adequate training or safety measures. Contractors likewise deny construction workers personal protective equipment and often deny the final month's pay knowing labourers lack legal recourse, and exclude sanitation workers from safety protocols in hazardous occupations.

In fact, the 'unskilled' status is one the state sustains rather than what naturally arises in society. Across sectors, supposedly 'unskilled' workers are expected to have skills such as handling construction materials, coordinating physical work, identifying defects or irregularities in finished products, using hand and power tools effectively, aligning and placing materials accurately, maintaining tolerances during repetitive production, troubleshooting routine production issues, responding appropriately to process issues, carefully handling human waste, working safely in confined spaces, and recognising hazardous gases and other dangerous conditions, among many others.

> The 'unskilled' status is one the state sustains rather than what naturally arises in society

Stratified labour market

'Skill' in India has become an occupational as well as a social category: workers may acquire a considerable amount of embodied knowledge through experience yet remain 'unskilled' in the eyes of institutions because they lack the formal credentials used to recognise, and pay for, skill. India's labour market also remains stratified along caste, class, gender, and, increasingly, migration lines, influencing which forms of labour are considered 'skilled', and so remunerative. The informalisation of jobs – such as municipal corporations hiring contractors to hire sanitation workers on contracts – has also weakened the relationship between competence and occupational status. Ultimately, economic production is sustained on the engagement of millions of workers whose job security it fails to improve.

The Code on Wages requires governments to account for a worker's skill level when fixing minimum wages, together with geographical area, whether the work is arduous or hazardous, and so on. The wage schedules of the Union government then assign floors for workers performing otherwise comparable work. In agriculture, thus, the daily rates in September were ₹528 for unskilled work, ₹578 for semi-skilled work, ₹627 for skilled work, and ₹694 for highly skilled work (in urban centres with the highest costs of living).

Per the government, 'unskilled' agricultural work encompasses weeding and manually watering crops and requires 'only' physical effort and no training or judgment. 'Highly skilled' work, however, demands advanced technical expertise, like calibrating a combine harvester or managing pest outbreaks. But weeding and irrigation also involve learned techniques such as identifying weeds, assessing soil conditions, using tools without damaging plants, and planning work according to weather conditions.

Yet the way India classifies skills, compounded by its preference for institutional recognition, disproportionately concentrates 'unskilled' workers in informal jobs. And the classification is self-reinforcing: lower wages reduce workers' ability to obtain institutional qualifications or avoid precarious employment while precarious employment makes employers less inclined to invest in their workers' training and safety.

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What 107 innings reveal about the Smriti-Shafali opening pair

In their last 15 innings, Shafali's strike rate exceeded 170 and Mandhana's 150, career highs over any 15-innings stretch

DATA POINT

Kapil Gupta

India's new T20I captain Smriti Mandhana and vice-captain Shafali Verma have added 4,080 runs together as openers, 50% more than any other pair in women's T20Is.

On October 6, Smriti was named India's white-ball captain and Shafali her deputy in T20 Internationals (T20Is). India's two leaders are also its openers.

When India meets Zimbabwe in Raipur from October 16, they will face the first ball together. Their partnership is already the most productive in the format. Ball-by-ball data for every women's T20I till October 7 show that in 107 innings since 2019, the two have added 4,080 runs for the first wicket, averaging 39.2 runs per dismissal at 8.34 runs an over.

Australia's Alyssa Healy and Beth Mooney are second with 2,715 runs in 84 innings; the UAE's Esha Oza and Theertha Satish third with 2,588.

The Indian pair also has 32 stands of 50 or more, 12 more than any other pair, and a shared-record six century stands.

The lead is recent: the Indian line steepens from 2025, just as the Australian one stops **(Chart 1)**.

Quick and reliable

Chart 2 compares the 31 opening pairs with at least 20 innings together. A typical pair averages 26 runs per dismissal at under seven an over.

Among the 10 pairs with 1,000-plus runs, none scores faster. England's Danni Wyatt and Sophia Dunkley come closest (8.23 an over) but average 28; South Africa's Laura Wolvaardt and Tazmin Brits average 44.4 but score at 6.85. Only Oman's pair, over just 20 innings, is ahead on both counts. The pairing has changed Smriti too: with Mithali Raj, she opened at 7.07 an over; with Shafali, 8.34.

A pair can average more by surviving longer or by scoring faster. The Indian pair lasts 28 balls per wicket against 25 for other established pairs, but scores over one and a half runs an over faster **(Table 1)**. Of their 11 extra runs per wicket, about seven come from speed and four from staying in longer.

The gap is sharpest in the powerplay: 8.4 an over against 5.8 for other openers, about 15 extra runs in six overs, with boundaries off 22.7% of balls, twice the rate of others. Survival barely differs: 26% of their stands last six overs, against 23%. Bowlers dismiss them as often as any good pair; they just cannot stop the runs first.

After a dip in 2023, when they scored at 7.04 an over, the pair has averaged 48 runs an innings at 9.27 an over since January 2025, against 34 at 7.91 before **(Chart 3)**. Their 973 runs in 2026 are the most in any year.

India won 60 of the 100 completed matches in which this pair opened, but their results varied sharply with the size of the opening stand. When the pair added fewer than 20 runs, India won 51% of matches; for stands of 20-49, the figure was 50%. But once they crossed 50, India won 24 of 29 matches (83%). Until the stand reaches 50, India's win rate barely shifts; beyond it, their chances improve sharply.

Added responsibilities

The appointment puts India's most crucial phase in the hands of its leaders, but carries a risk. In 18% of their innings together, both fell for under 15, leaving India without its captain and vice-captain early. Yet in 65% of innings, at least one scored 30 or more.

Both are currently scoring faster than ever. In their last 15 innings, Shafali's strike rate exceeded 170 and Mandhana's 150, career highs over any 15-innings stretch. The Zimbabwe series will show whether leadership changes their tempo.

Partnership goals

The data for the charts were sourced from Cricsheet (cricsheet.org) ball-by-ball records of women's T20 Internationals till October 7. Run rates use legal deliveries. Win figures exclude ties and no-results

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CHART 1: Cumulative opening partnership runs over time for the six most prolific pairs in women's T20Is. Each step represents a partnership

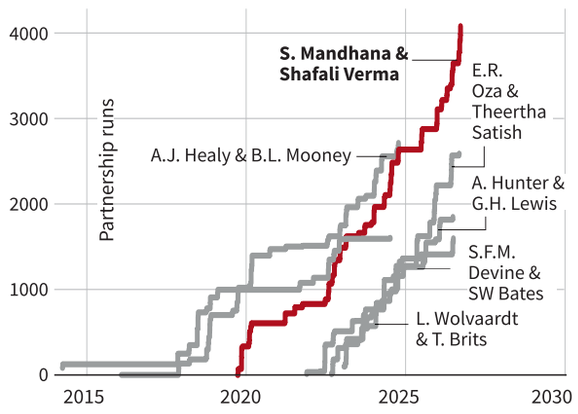

CHART 3: Opening-partnership runs by calendar year, alongside the scoring rate and number of innings. Blue bars represent 2025 and 2026 (through October 7)

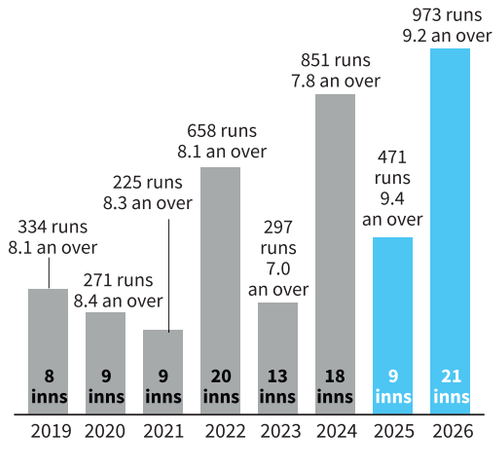

CHART 2: Runs per dismissal versus runs per over. Each circle represents an opening pair with at least 20 innings together. Circle size indicates total runs, while the axes show average runs per dismissal and runs per over. Dashed lines mark the typical pair

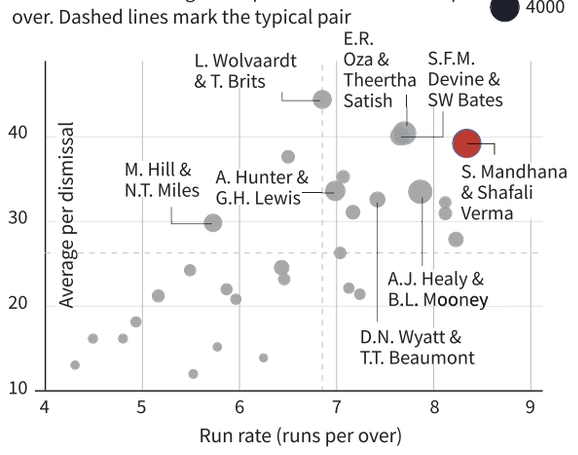

TABLE 1: Comparison of the Smriti-Shafali partnership with other established opening pairs, covering balls faced per wicket, scoring rate and runs per dismissal

Measure	Smriti-Shafali	Other openers
Whole partnership		
Balls faced per wicket	28.2	25.2
Runs per over	8.34	6.79
Runs per dismissal	39.2	28.5
Powerplay (first six overs)		
Powerplay runs per over	8.4	5.8
Powerplay balls hit for four or six	22.7%	11.3%
Powerplay dot balls	46.5%	56.7%
Stands still unbroken after six overs	26%	23%

Note: Powerplay figures count only balls bowled while the opening stand was intact. "Other openers" refers to the other 30 pairs with at least 20 innings together for whole-partnership figures, and all other opening pairs for powerplay figures

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 15, 1976

'Nobody for President' campaign in U.S.

San Francisco, October 14: The 1976 U.S. Presidential campaign is not all Jimmy Carter, Gerry Ford, television debates and fundraising dinners. There's another candidate nobody has yet seen, not even his supporters.

Confetti and tickertape rain down on an open car as it arrives with nobody in the back seat. Nobody is the evening's speaker. Nobody is introduced.

When the cheering dies away, a set of chattering clockwork teeth is placed on the speaker's lectern and clatters on for three minutes.

This is the "Nobody for President" campaign now going into its final weeks with a coast-to-coast tour starting here and ending up in New York on election day, November 2.

Who is behind it? "Nobody" answers campaign organiser Huge Romney, a former poet who calls himself Wavy Gravy.

"We think the office (of President) is ridiculous", he explained in an interview. "I think nobody should have that much power and I want nobody to run my life."

Mr. Gravy claims that Democratic candidate Jimmy Carter may be a tacit supporter of the "Nobody for President" movement.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 15, 1926

Imperial Indian mail

As there was no issue dated October 15, 1926, from the issue dated October 14, 1926

The following is from "The Statesman" of the 13th: A new era as regards comfortable and expedient long-distance railway travelling in India will commence next month, when the East Indian Railway Overland mail train will be replaced by a magnificent train, the Imperial Indian Mail, which, with its handsome colour design of Royal blue and gold, will undoubtedly attract admiring attention throughout its journey from Calcutta to Bombay and vice versa.

Two trains, embodying the latest ideas in luxury travel, are being constructed – one by the East Indian Railway in their Carriage and Wagon Workshops at Lillooah, and the other by the Great Indian Peninsula Railway at Matunga.

'The Statesman' understands that the first train will be sent to Bombay in time to convey to Calcutta.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of households in Rajasthan awaiting tap connections

44 in lakh. Former Rajasthan CM Ashok Gehlot accused the BJP government of failing to implement Jal Jeevan Mission effectively, claiming that 44 lakh households were still awaiting tap water connections. He said work on 90% of drinking water projects had come to a standstill. PTI

India's trade deficit with China from January to Sept.

105.93 in $ billion. India's trade deficit with China crossed $100 billion in the first nine months of this year, even as Indian exports grew by 40%, sustaining their upward momentum amid a continued surge in Chinese exports. PTI

Railway employees for whom bonuses were approved by Cabinet

11 in lakh. Payment of productivity-linked bonus (PLB) to eligible railway employees is made each year before the Durga Puja/Dusshera holidays. "This year also, PLB amount equivalent to 78 days' wages is being paid to about 11.40 lakh non-gazetted Railway employees," the government said. PTI

Amount mobilised by the World Bank for job creation in India

36 in $ billion. The World Bank Group said it has helped mobilise $36 billion over the last four years for development across sectors and to support efforts to boost investment and create jobs. Of this, $9.6 billion was channelled towards micro, small and medium enterprises. PTI

Share of people who lived with mental health struggles

53 in per cent. More than 50% of people waited over a year to seek professional mental health care, while 56.2% reported thoughts of self-harm before accessing care, according to mental healthcare provider Amaya's 'Mental Health Report 2026'. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why is Spain facing a housing crisis?

How are tourism and investment funds worsening the crisis? Why is Spain struggling to provide affordable housing? How has the housing crisis affected Sánchez's government? What measures has the government proposed to tackle the crisis? What is at stake in Spain's snap election?

EXPLAINER

Sonikka Loganathan

The story so far:
Last month, 87-year-old María del Carmen Abascal was evicted from her home of over seven decades. Her father first rented Abascal's apartment in Madrid's upscale Retiro neighbourhood in 1956. She stayed there under rent control after her parents died. The building changed ownership in 2018, and Abascal was offered the option to buy the unit. Since she couldn't afford it, investment fund Urbagestión bought the unit and raised the rent from 500 euros to 2,650 euros. The fund then lowered the rent to 1,650 euros, but Abascal, who was living on pension funds, still could not afford it.

Voicing concerns: People take part in a protest demanding action to alleviate Spain's housing crisis in Barcelona on October 9. REUTERS

How severe is Spain's housing crisis?
Her eviction sparked tens of thousands of people to protest nationwide over a housing crisis that is crippling the European nation. Hundreds of people set up tents in Madrid's Puerta del Sol plaza, with some camping out there for over a week. They are demanding stronger protections for tenants, lower rents and a ban on investment funds buying property. Protesters say the problem is one of supply and demand – there simply are not enough affordable homes. Rental costs have risen by an average of 84% over the last 10 years, according to property outlet Idealista. The southern city of Malaga has seen an increase of 113%, while Marbella's increase was just under 150%. Average incomes in recent years have failed to keep up with rising costs. According to the National Statistics Institute, the average gross monthly salary in Spain is around 2,460 euros. According to Idealista, in September, a 50-square-metre apartment in Madrid cost about 1,170 euros a month – about half the average income.

The Bank of Spain's latest reports also estimate that the country has a housing shortfall of about 750,000 homes. The bank's deputy governor, Soledad Núñez, said the housing deficit could increase by another 300,000 homes between 2026 and 2028, crossing the one-million mark.

Why is this happening?
Three key issues are worsening the crisis. First, household construction has not been able to keep up with Spain's demographic boom. About 1.2 million new households came about between 2021 and 2025, driven by an increase in migration. But that same period saw fewer than half a million new homes being constructed. The 2009 Eurozone crisis, which followed the 2008 Global Financial Crisis, caused Spain's construction industry to shrink. The COVID-19 pandemic pushed up material costs, and political differences continued to restrict construction initiatives.

Tourism is worsening the problem, as more houses are being used as short-term rentals. Madrid's tenants' union, Sindicato de Inquilinas de Madrid, estimates that over 4 million homes and 400,000 vacation rentals are currently empty.

Spain's Ministry for Consumer Rights ordered the short-term rental platform Airbnb to remove about 66,000 unlicensed listings, but locals say it isn't enough. Limited public housing is also worsening the situation, forcing many young adults to leave their parents' homes only after turning 30 – far older than in other European countries. Spain ranks towards the bottom among countries in the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development in terms of government-owned rental properties, which account for less than 2% of the total housing stock. Madrid has only around 10,000 public housing units for its 3.5 million residents.

Investment funds are further exploiting the problem by buying whatever homes and units are available and hiking rents dramatically. Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez's government calls them "vulture funds".

How has the crisis shaken Sánchez's government?
As protests continue to swell, Sánchez presented two emergency measures to tackle the housing crisis, largely aimed at providing tenants with more protections. On October 1, Spain's Congress rejected both proposed decrees, prompting further protests. The defeat showed that Sánchez's socialist government does not have congressional backing. Following the blow, Sánchez called for a snap general election on November 29. The next general election was meant to be held before the end of next summer. Sánchez is hoping to capitalise on public anger over the housing crisis to win votes and maintain his position. His Spanish Socialist Workers' Party is up against the far-right Vox party, the conservative People's Party and the pro-independence Catalan party Junts. If Vox wins, it would be the first time a far-right party has governed Spain since the death of dictator Francisco Franco in 1975.

THE GIST

- Rents in Spain have risen by an average of 84% over the past decade, while the country faces a housing shortfall of about 7,50,000 homes
- A shortage of new homes, the growth of short-term tourist rentals, limited public housing and investment funds driving up rents have worsened the crisis
- After Congress rejected his proposed housing measures, Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez called a snap general election for November 29, hoping to capitalise on public anger over housing

How has the SC strengthened arrest safeguards?

What makes written grounds of arrest mandatory, and what happens if they are not provided?

R.K.Vij

The story so far:
The Supreme Court recently, in *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol v. State of Punjab* (September 2026), held that the investigating agency would require permission of the magistrate to re-arrest the accused after his previous arrest was held illegal for the non-supply of the grounds of arrest in writing. It also recommended departmental action for the negligent investigating officer (IO) and change of the IO in the case.

What governs the communication of grounds of arrest?
The genesis of informing the grounds of arrest to a person flows from the Constitutional safeguard provided in Article 21 that no person shall be deprived of his life and personal liberty except according to procedure established by law. Article 22(2) says that every person who is arrested and detained in custody shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of 24 hours of such arrest, excluding the time necessary for the journey from the place of arrest to the court of the magistrate, and no such person shall be detained in custody beyond the said period without the authority of a magistrate.

The Constitutional safeguard is incorporated in Section 50 of the CrPC (now Section 47 of BNSS). Section 47 of BNSS casts a duty on the police officer to communicate the grounds of arrest to an accused person arrested without a warrant. However, neither Article 22(2) of the Constitution nor Section 47 of BNSS specifies the mode of communicating the grounds of arrest to an accused person.

How has the law evolved?
In *Pankaj Bansal v. Union of India & Ors.* (2023), the Supreme Court while dealing with a case of Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 (PMLA) held that there was no valid reason as to why a written copy of the grounds of arrest could not be provided to the arrestee as a standard procedure without any exception. The court cited two reasons for it. First, in case the grounds of arrest are orally read out to an accused person, those orally stated facts could be disputed in a given case. Second, the accused person may seek legal counsel to avail bail. The court therefore held that furnishing a copy of written grounds of arrest to an accused was mandatory without exception.

This principle was reiterated by the court in *Prabir Purkayastha v. State (NCT of Delhi)* (May 2024) while dealing with a case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967. It held that communicating the grounds of arrest was not merely a procedural formality but a vital safeguard with the ultimate objective of enabling the arrested person to effectively consult legal aid and be prepared to raise objections in the remand hearing and apply for his/her bail. Also, any breach of Article 22(2) would vitiate the lawfulness of arrest and subsequent remand, and entitle the person to be set at liberty.

However, in *Vihaan Kumar v. State of Haryana and Another* (2025), the court observed that although the ideal mode of communication of grounds of arrest is to provide such grounds in writing, there is no such statutory requirement to do so.

What did the court rule in the Rajesh Mihir Shah case?
The Supreme Court in *Rajesh Mihir Shah v. State of Maharashtra and Another* (2025) held that the constitutional mandate of informing the arrestee of the grounds of arrest is mandatory in all offences under all statutes, including offences under the IPC (now BNS). Second, the grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing to the arrestee in the language he/she understands. Third, in cases where the arresting officer is unable to communicate the grounds of arrest in writing on or soon after arrest, it needs to be done orally. The said grounds of arrest are to be communicated in writing within a reasonable time and in any case at least two hours prior to production of the arrestee for remand proceedings before the magistrate. Fourth, in case of non-compliance, the arrest and subsequent remand would be rendered illegal.

What are the consequences?
The court in the *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol* (supra) case said that if the IO still needs to re-arrest an accused for custodial interrogation during investigation, the IO has to file an application before the concerned magistrate for custody, stating the reasons.

The IO would also need to explain the reasons for non-supply of the grounds of arrest to the accused. However, the application could be filed only after furnishing the grounds of arrest to the accused. Also, the application must have the endorsement of the immediate superior authority. It is only after the receipt of such application that the magistrate shall decide the same expeditiously.

Second, the investigation of the case shall be handed over to another officer by the superior authority, and he shall also direct departmental enquiry for the serious lapse of not providing the grounds of arrest in writing to the accused.

Additionally, the High Court may direct payment of compensation as part of the public law remedy for the violation of Article 22(2) of the Constitution, with liberty to the accused to avail his remedy under the private civil law.

(R.K. Vij is a former IPS officer)

THE GIST

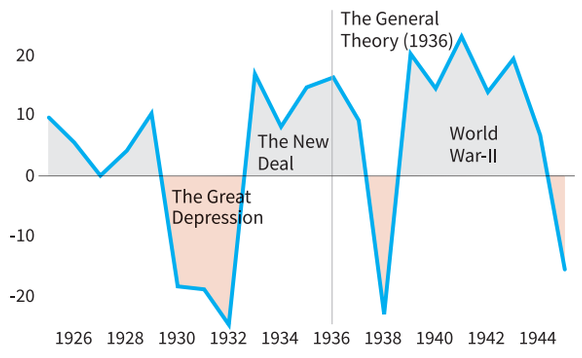
- The Supreme Court ruled that grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing, in a language the accused understands, at least two hours before remand proceedings
- If this safeguard is violated, re-arrest requires the magistrate's permission. The court also called for a change of investigating officer and a departmental inquiry into the lapse

KEYWORD

Economics of growth

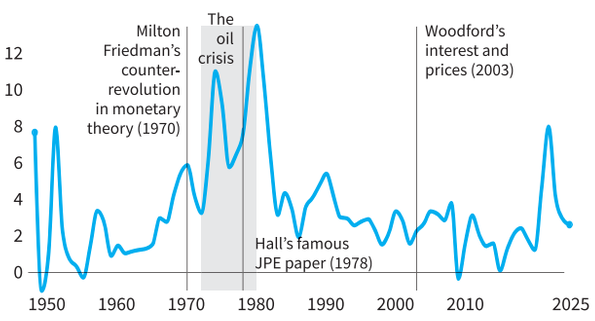
From business cycles to long-run growth, Keynes-Kalecki and orthodox economists differ on the role of demand

Chart 1 (a): The Great Depression and the rise of Keynes-Kalecki
(CAGR of U.S. industrial production, 1925–1945)



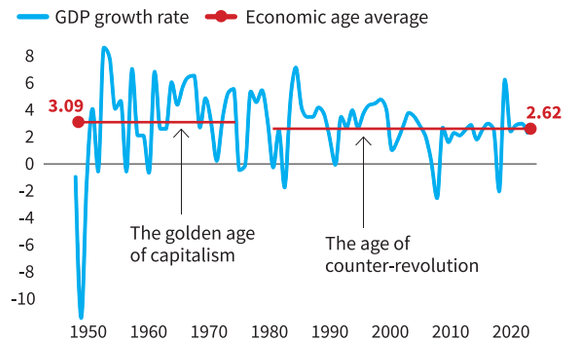
Source: Industrial Production – Total Index (IPB50001SQ), Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System (U.S.) via FRED

Chart 1 (b): Inflation and a monetarist counter-revolution in the U.S.
(1948-2025, CPI annual per cent change from year ago)



Source: Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: all items in the U.S. city average, index 1982-1984=100, seasonally adjusted

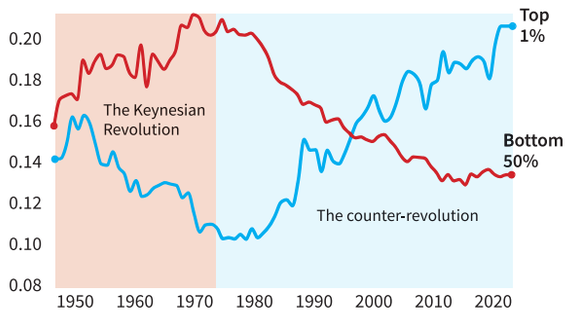
Chart 2: Long-run trend and business cycles in the U.S.
(Annual growth rates of real GDP, 1945-2025, in %)



The red lines: CAGR = geometric average, i.e., the constant annual rate that compounds to the same cumulative real GDP change over the phase: 1945-1973 (3.09%) and 1980-2025 (2.62%).

Source: Authors' calculations. Federal Reserve Economic Data, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis

Chart 3: Economic ideas are not class agnostic
(Ratio of class-wise pre-tax income to total income)

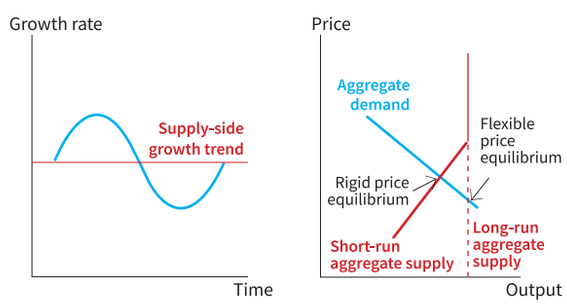


Source: World Inequality Database

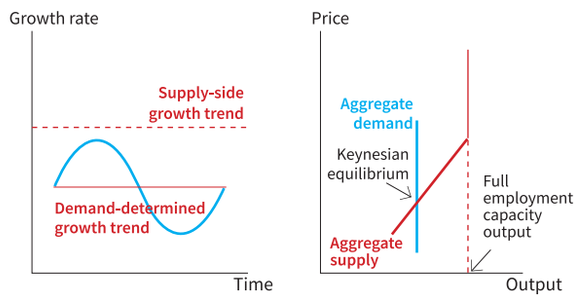
Robert E. Hall

Michael Woodford

Graph 1: Schematic representation of the orthodox framework



Graph 2: Schematic representation of the Keynes-Kalecki framework



Why the debate between Keynesian and orthodox economics matters

Keynes-Kalecki framework holds that demand, particularly private investment, shapes short-term fluctuations and long-term growth, unlike orthodox supply-led approaches; the shift towards inflation targeting coincided with falling wage shares and a greater burden on workers

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

GETTY IMAGES

Economists are products of their times. While KK wrote against the backdrop of the Great Depression, the deepest economic crisis faced by capitalism, this year's Nobel laureates wrote in the aftermath of unprecedented inflation of the 1970s

Professors Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford have been awarded the Nobel Prize in Economics this year "for microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation". In this piece, we take a longue durée view of macroeconomics to situate their work within the context of political economy. In many ways, the field has come full circle from the days of John Maynard Keynes and Michal Kalecki (henceforth KK)

Economists are products of their times. While KK wrote against the backdrop of the Great Depression, the deepest and longest economic crisis faced by capitalism (Chart 1a), this year's Nobel laureates wrote in the aftermath of the unprecedented inflation of the 1970s (see Chart 1b).

These are two watershed moments in both the history of capitalism and the field of macroeconomics. The former brought the Keynesian revolution (though a misnomer, as Kalecki had an equal part in it), while the latter are part of a counterrevolution to reestablish pre-Keynesian orthodoxy in many ways.

Ideas matter a great deal. The arguments and policy flowing out of the KK framework led to what is considered the golden age of capitalism (1945-1973), a period that recorded the highest sustained growth rates (compare the average growth rates across time in chart 2).

What creates a business cycle?

What is a business cycle? Like a ship navigating the ocean, a capitalist economy moves through ebbs and flows in economic activity. Just as a ship cruises smoothly when the waters are calm, an economy has an underlying long-term trend rate of growth. Both the cycle and the underlying trend rate of growth have been the subject of intense debates in economics. There are two broad poles in this debate – with some variations within each: heterodox and orthodox approaches.

Heterodox approaches hold that demand influences both the cycle and the trend, while orthodox approaches believe demand plays a role in the cycle but not the trend, albeit for different reasons. The Nobel laureates work within the latter tradition, while KK did within the former. Why should the readers bother about these esoteric questions? Because our livelihoods, jobs, cost of living, and much else depend on which side is steering the ship.

Consider the orthodox approach. Before KK, it was believed that in the long run, economies move along full-employment paths with cycles arising from external shocks, which did not require policy interventions from the State. These arguments, however, were built on ad hoc assumptions. In the 1980s, a newer version of this orthodox approach sought to build the framework from the bottom up, moving from micro-foundations to a macroeconomic model. This led to the development of real business cycle (RBC) theory, associated with economists Finn Kydland and Edward Prescott, who won the 2004 Nobel Prize in Economics. The economy functions along the full-employment path, with the trend determined by the growth of the labour force and its productivity (Graph 1(a)). For them, output and labour markets clear in the short run, so even the cyclical movements were caused by the supply side, thereby precluding the possibility of any State intervention.

Economists such as Hall and Woodford, while keeping the RBC framework intact, argued that economies can fall off the full-employment path if prices do not adjust fast enough to clear the markets. The argument they made was that not all firms change their prices at the same time; some do so in one period, while others in another. As a result, prices do not fully adjust between these periods. If household demand for goods is less than what firms collectively wish to supply (Graph 1(b)), prices may not fall enough to restore equilibrium. The economy then operates at lower levels of demand (recession). The opposite happens if demand is greater than supply (boom with signs of overheating).

If you consider a time period long enough (over a business cycle), on average, the prices would have adjusted fully, in which case demand also adjusts fully to what the firms would like to supply. Demand creates supply in the short run while supply determines the demand in the long run. It is obvious, therefore, that policy is required only for the short run and not the long run.

Demand and long-term growth

The KK tradition is markedly different from this. They argued that demand matters not just in determining the cyclical component of growth but also the underlying trend. Kalecki had famously said, "the long-run trend is but a slowly changing component of a chain of short-period situations; it has no independent entity". If the economy is underemployed through the short run, it remains so in the long run as well (see graph 2 (a)). And if policy changes the short-run equilibrium, it affects the trend rate of growth too.

But even more importantly, their analysis of the short term differs as well. Economies are stuck at below-capacity output or with unemployed workers not because prices and wages are rigid but because capital investment by the capitalists is not enough to employ all those who seek employment. Rigidity of investment, not prices, causes unemployment. In Keynes, prices are not even rigid, let alone being the cause of the business cycle. In Kalecki, they are, but that is not the cause of the shortage of demand. Unless the fall in prices could affect investment, it would have no impact on demand. Demand is vertical in prices (Graph 2(b)).

A fall in prices may in fact have a negative impact on investment through debt defaults, etc. All of this had a profound impact on both understanding the workings of a capitalist economy as well as policy prescriptions.

Non-neutrality of money

Having looked at their understanding of how capitalism functions, consider their take on policy, particularly monetary policy.

Before Keynes, it was believed that money could not affect the 'real' economy, i.e., it was neutral in its impact on output. It was believed that a larger pool of money would chase the same amount of goods, which simply leads to a rise in their prices. The role of monetary policy, therefore, was to stabilise prices. The New Keynesian Model (NKM) agrees that this is indeed the case in the long run; however, in the short run, since prices are sticky, a rise in the money supply increases real balances in the hands of households, who increase their consumption, thereby making money non-neutral. But this holds only in the short run. While money is non-neutral in the short run, the primary role of monetary policy nevertheless is to stabilise inflation. No wonder that this policy approach is called inflation targeting. The KK framework, on the other hand, did not believe that money leads to inflation. Given that the ebbs in activity were caused by a lack of adequate private investment, their policy recommendations foregrounded policies which increased the level of activity directly, i.e., through fiscal intervention by the State. If private investment is not coming through, public investment fills the gap.

As for monetary policy, it mostly played a second fiddle to fiscal policy in their framework. Monetary policy on its own may not work because it is an indirect route of increasing private investment by decreasing the cost of loans. KK believed that low investment is because the demand for the products the factories produce is low, so a mere fall in the cost of loans will not reverse the 'animal spirits' of the capitalists.

Class politics of inflation

All of this is not just a theoretical debate. While the Keynesian revolution improved the lot of the workers on the whole, the monetarist counter-revolution has made them the scapegoats in this fight against inflation, which we have written about in these columns earlier. It is not surprising that the wage shares were rising during the KK years and a reversal has taken place since the RBC counterrevolution took hold over the discipline (Chart 3). Economic frameworks and policy prescriptions, therefore, are not, and can never be, class agnostic.

(The authors are a part of the DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics)

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning and origin of the idiom "to live the life of Riley"? (K. R. Manohara, Chitragupta)
When you say that somebody is "living" or "leading the life of Riley", what you are implying is that he/she is leading a very comfortable life. He/she is leading the kind of life that all of us wish we had – a life where one doesn't have to work hard or spend sleepless nights worrying about making ends meet. When you lead the life of Riley, you lead a very "cushy" life.

While Prabha worked all day, Sunil stayed home living the life of Riley.

What is the origin of this expression? Well, no one is really sure as to who this Riley was. Some scholars argue that this Riley (originally spelt "Reilly") referred to the character that appeared in a song written by Pat Rooney in 1890. In the song, Riley says if he ever became the President of the US then "New York" would "swim in wine when the White House and Capitol are mine." It tells you something about the kind of President he would have made, doesn't it? Some others argue that it was an American poet by the name of James Whitcomb Riley who gave rise to this idiom. Apparently, Riley (1849-1916) wrote sentimental poems about young boys, which were very popular during his time. The poems told the stories of young boys lazing around during the summer without a care in the world – wandering about barefoot, swimming in the river, and fishing.

What is the meaning of "sixth sense"? (T. Srinivas, Siddipet)
Sometimes when you get up in the morning you have a feeling that you are going to have a really bad day. There may not be any logical explanation why you feel this way. You just have this strange feeling and, funnily enough, you end up having a perfectly lousy day. This intuitive feeling that you sometimes have that tells you that something good or bad is going to happen is your "sixth sense". We all have five senses – taste, hearing, sight, smell, and touch. This sixth sense cannot be explained by the other five senses; it is something that cannot be explained by logic. Here are a few examples.

Atul's sixth sense warned him not to trust his new lawyer.

Prem's sixth sense told him that something bad was going to happen.

The expression means the same thing as "gut reaction" or "gut feeling". Your gut feeling about something is your personal or intuitive feeling about something. For example,

Satish had a gut feeling that he was going to get some bad news.

What should a sign say? "No admission" or "No admittance"? (G.K.S. Kandasubramanian, Sivaganga)
Both are correct. When you find these signs on a door, what they imply is that you do not have the right to enter. Of the two, "admittance" is the more formal. It stresses on the physical act of entering the premises. "Admission", on the other hand, is far less formal and has several different meanings. For example, we talk about "admission to a club or university". Here the focus is not on the physical act of entering the university or the club, but in the general sense of participating with others. Admission gives you the right to join others and participate in an event/programme.

Published in The Hindu on April 9, 2002

Word of the day

Mendacity:
the tendency to be untruthful

Synonyms: lie, falsehood, fabrication

Usage: *The politician was known for his mendacity.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/mendacity

International Phonetic Alphabet: /mɛndæsəti/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

Many youth held as SIR protests rock capital

"We were detained, we were beaten up earlier also. By beating us, they cannot shut us up. Our protests will go on. Until Gyanesh Kumar resigns, we will remain on the roads. We will not back down," a protester said.

Around 800 metres away, Indian Youth Congress workers began a separate march from Patel Chowk Metro Station towards Jantar Mantar. Carrying party flags and placards, they demanded Mr. Kumar's resignation and raised slogans against the Union government.

"Modi*ji*, go back to the tea shop," read one of the placards.

The marchers initially sat outside Patel Chowk Metro Station amid a heavy security presence before proceeding along Ashoka Road. Police continued to warn against unauthorised processions, protests, and gatherings, citing Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita.

The march was stopped near the Parliament Street police station, where protesters were detained and pushed into buses. A few climbed on top of the vehicles and continued raising slogans as the police moved to clear the area.

At both locations, extensive barricading and the deployment of security personnel turned the demonstrations into tense standoffs, with protesters resisting attempts to disperse them and police detaining those who remained on the roads.

Traffic disrupted

The continuing demonstrations disrupted traffic in parts of the New Delhi district on Wednesday. Road closures, barricades, and restrictions imposed to facilitate security arrangements and control the marches led to congestion during the afternoon, leaving commuters navigating diversions and slow-moving traffic. The demonstrations came amid protests and detentions in the national capital since October 10, when the CJP called for a demonstration against SIR and Mr. Kumar.

Will take care of those deleted in Delhi rolls: SC

The application has asked the court to direct the EC to frame an appropriate mechanism for restoration/inclusion of deleted voters without forcing them to apply as first-time voters.

Form 6, prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules of 1960, requires every applicant to affirm that they are "applying for inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time".

During the enumeration phase of the SIR in Delhi, 47,56,722 electors were excluded from the draft electoral roll under the category of ASDD (Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate). For any person on the ASDD list, the only mechanism for filing a claim for having their name restored in the voter list is through Form 6.

"This creates a fundamental anomaly as all these people were previously enrolled on the voter list but are now required to submit Form 6 and make a declaration that they are seeking inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time, which is factually incorrect and wholly inapplicable to their circumstances," the application said.

Further, it said these persons would become vulnerable to punishment for giving a false declaration under Section 31 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, which provides for imprisonment for a term which may extend to one year or with fine or with both.

The petition also pointed out that the additional declaration form required to be submitted along with Form 6 was without the force of law and must be struck down.

India's trade deficit with China crosses $100 bn

The widening imbalance has remained a source of concern for New Delhi, with the deficit figuring in last month's talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS summit.

While India requires large amounts of intermediates from China for manufacturing, the continued reliance on finished goods, including large quantities of electronics and machinery, remains a concern.

India's major exports to China this year have included seafood products, naphtha, and printed circuit boards, which until recently India was buying in bulk from the neighbouring country.

India is also concerned by Chinese export controls in an increasing number of sectors, from fertilizers to rare earths. At last month's meeting in New Delhi, Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi "underlined the need to address each other's concerns, including structural trade imbalance and supply chain issues, and facilitation of meaningful and predictable market access", a statement from the Ministry of External Affairs said. Both leaders also "took note of the progress in people-to-people ties and underscored the need to further promote cultural exchanges, business linkages and greater mobility between the two countries," the statement said, following the normalisation in relations since the October 2024 meeting between the two leaders.

A statement from China's Foreign Ministry after the meeting said the "two sides should also address each other's economic and trade concerns in a balanced way and promote the sound and steady development of economic and trade relations."

Bihar boat that capsized in Ganga had a hole and was overloaded: police

Ill-fated boat was 'dilapidated and could carry around five passengers'; it had set sail after sunset, 'violating' the rules; show-cause notices sent to Circle Officer and Station House Officer of Raghopur

Amit Bhelari
RAGHOPUR (VAISHALI)

Family members mourning the death of a relative who drowned after a boat capsized in the Ganga in Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday. ANI

The boat, which capsized in the Ganga in Bihar's Vaishali district on Tuesday, killing 13 minors, was dilapidated with a hole in the deck and was overloaded, police said on Wednesday.

Vaishali police said the country-made boat could barely carry five people and had sailed after sunset, violating the rules. They said water had entered through the hole.

The Vaishali district administration issued show cause notices to the circle officer and station house officer of Raghopur. The Patna and Bhagalpur district authorities sounded alerts over plying of boats in the Ganga.

Vaishali District Magistrate, Varsha Singh, said, "Action will be taken against the boat owner, the operator, and everyone involved, including the officials responsible for monitoring the situation. It was a private boat."

"It is the responsibility of the circle officer and the station house officer to prevent such activities by remaining alert and utilising their administrative machinery," she added.

Authorities called off the search operation even as people at Rampur Shyamchand village in Raghopur mourned the deaths.

Union Minister Chirag Paswan, who met the families, said, "If negligence had happened at any level, action will be taken."

Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Bijendra Prasad Yadav and State Cooperative Minister Ram Kripal Yadav visited the incident site on the instructions of Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and spoke to the family members.

Ex gratia announced

Health Minister Nishant Kumar visited Nalanda Medical College and Hospital and met the injured.

Ms. Singh handed over cheques of ₹4 lakh, the ex gratia amount announced by the Chief Minister, to each family.

₹53,428 cr. cleared for social assistance scheme till 2030-31

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Govt. announces the renaming of NSAP as Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved an outlay of ₹53,428 crore for the continuation of the National Social Assistance Programme (NSAP) for five years, from 2026-27 to 2030-31. It has also renamed the scheme and removed the "Indira Gandhi" prefix from three sub-schemes covering old-age, widow and disability pensions.

The Cabinet also revised the eligibility criteria and assistance rates for disability pension beneficiaries.

The government statement spoke of "continuation of pension schemes for old age and widows and the family benefit scheme in its existing form". The decision to lock in the budget for the next five years has raised questions, with critics arguing that NSAP is already inadequate to meet current socio-economic realities. Unlike several other welfare schemes that use the 2011 Socio-Economic and Caste Census (SECC) data to identify beneficiaries, NSAP caps the beneficiary base for its three pension schemes at 3.09 crore.

"Realising Rights: A Handbook of Welfare in India", published by Azim Premji University, notes that since this ceiling is "neither defined by administrative capacity nor the actual number of eligible rights holders, eligibility as determined in the guidelines does not translate into an entitlement in practice".

Rajendran Narayanan, Associate Professor at Azim Premji University said the decision overlooked the need for pension outlays to keep pace with demographic changes and inflation. "The decision appears to assume that the number of beneficiaries will remain static. Even for the existing beneficiary base, a back-of-the-envelope calculation using a 5% inflation rate shows that ₹55,698 crore would be required," he said.

The government also said that NSAP will be renamed the Pradhan Mantri Samajik Sahayata Yojana.

Canadian Minister highlights scope for closer ties with India

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Anita Anand

India-Canada relations have "enormous potential" amidst an uncertain global scenario, Canada's Foreign Minister Anita Anand said here on Wednesday. Ms. Anand met Prime Minister Narendra Modi and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar as the two countries reviewed a wide range of issues, including a trade pact and the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine.

"Nearly 80 years of diplomatic ties have been enriched by generations of families, students and entrepreneurs who have brought our countries closer," said Ms. Anand on X.

"Canada and India have enormous potential to shape a more prosperous future, together," she said.

Ms. Anand and Mr. Jaishankar participated in a panel discussion titled "Middle Power Moment" along with former British Prime Minister Rishi Sunak and former Australian Prime Minister Kevin Rudd on Wednesday.

Assess all destruction in the Aravalis before next report: activists to panel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The SC constituted the HPC to independently review the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravali. FILE PHOTO

The Aravalli Virasat Jan Abhiyaan (AVJA), a coalition of environmentalists and activists, on Wednesday urged the Supreme Court-appointed High-Powered Committee's (HPC) to assess "all instances of destruction" on the ground and conduct comprehensive, in-person public hearings across all remaining Aravali districts before submitting its next report to the court.

Neelam Ahluwalia, co-founder of the AVJA, said the HPC recent interactions with tribal communities in north Gujarat and two districts in south Rajasthan were a "very positive step" for people living in the Aravali range.

Earlier this year, the top court constituted the HPC to independently review the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravali hill range.

"Rural communities in the districts of Mahendergarh, Charkhi Dadri and Bhiwani in south Haryana, which are severely affected by mining and stone-crushing activities, as well as those in Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Kotputli, Karauli and other districts in Rajasthan, demand that the same intensive consultation process be carried out in their areas as well," Ms. Ahluwalia said.

"The people living in the Girjan river basin, the only river basin in north Rajasthan, are waiting to talk to the Aravali committee about the threats facing their lifeline. So are hundreds of other people from villages across the Aravali belt, which were not mentioned as Aravali districts in the Ministry of Environment's October 2025 report to the Supreme Court," she added.

In a statement, the AVJA said mining and ancillary operations had "wiped out" the Aravali range in two districts of south Haryana, while waste burning and landfills were "poisoning" the ecosystem in Udaipur and Gurugram.

Army reviews quality, safety of rations for personnel

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Indian Army on Wednesday reviewed its food specifications to improve the quality, safety and nutritional value of rations supplied to troops, with a focus on food preservation, packaging, and suitability for deployment in challenging operational and climatic conditions.

The 142nd Technical Standardisation Committee Meeting on Foodstuffs was held under the aegis of the Quarter Master General's Branch here.

The committee examined advancements in food technology, preservation and packaging, nutritional value, palatability and shelf life. Particular attention was paid to ensuring that rations can withstand demanding transportation, handling and storage conditions, including air-dropping and man-pack carriage.

Rajnath calls for deeper India-ASEAN defence ties

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and DG MP-IDSA Ambassador Sujan R. Chinoy during the ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum. ANI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Wednesday called for deeper defence and technological cooperation between India and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), pitching for joint research, co-production of military equipment and enhanced maritime security to address emerging regional challenges.

Addressing the maiden ASEAN-India Defence Think Tank Forum at the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses in New Delhi, Mr. Singh said India sought an Indo-Pacific where countries, irrespective of their size, could make independent choices, protect their interests and pursue development peacefully.

He called for mutual trust, respect for sovereignty, adherence to international law and keeping channels of dialogue open to address conventional and emerging security threats. "India believes that security is strengthened when countries build capacity together, respect international law and maintain trust through dialogue," he said.

Mr. Singh said India's Act East policy, along with its SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region) and MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions) visions, aligned with ASEAN-led mechanisms central to New Delhi's Indo-Pacific approach.

Highlighting the shared maritime interests of India and Southeast Asian nations, he said cooperation in maritime domain awareness, interoperability and underwater surveillance was essential to maintaining a stable, rules-based maritime order. Designating 2026 as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation offered an opportunity to translate common interests into practical outcomes, he added.

Court makes arrest protection given to journalist 'absolute'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Abhishek Upadhyay had authored reports on the alleged theft of donations from the Ram Temple

The Supreme Court on Wednesday made absolute the interim protection granted to independent journalist Abhishek Upadhyay from coercive action in a road rage case, as well as any subsequent first information reports (FIR).

Mr. Upadhyay had authored investigative online stories on the alleged misappropriation and theft of donations at the Ayodhya Ram Temple.

A Bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi also quashed an Uttar Pradesh Police notice issued to social media platform X to provide Mr. Upadhyay's digital data, generated around three months prior to the road rage incident.

The court found the police version that the data was sought to trace/arrest the petitioner "somewhat in contradiction" with the contents of its notice to the platform.

The court said that any information received by the police pursuant to the notice would not be used against the journalist.

The "arrest of the petitioner shall remain stayed till further notice", the court said. It made absolute its interim orders of August 25 and September 7, which had protected him from arrest and directed him to cooperate with the investigation, respectively.

The Bench ordered that Mr. Upadhyay could challenge the road rage FIR on any grounds. The court has not commented on the merits of the case.

'DMK ready to provide legal aid to arrested CJP activists'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin has said the party is ready to provide legal assistance to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists who were arrested and remanded in judicial custody.

Quoting a post on X by Abhijeet Dipke, founder and convenor of the CJP, the former Chief Minister said, "How many protesters can this government detain? How many young voices can the BJP silence? The more young people they jail, the more ordinary citizens, with no political affiliation, will take to the streets and show them the true power of the people." He also included the hashtag #GyaneshKumarMustGo.

In his social media post, Mr. Dipke said Mr. Ranka and Mr. Das were remanded in five days' judicial custody for "unfurling the tricolour" at Jantar Mantar.

Addressing Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he said, "If you're so determined to crush dissent, have the courage to officially declare an Emergency instead of hiding behind these cowardly tactics."

CJP leaders jailed for entering Jantar Mantar

Police register FIRs against 14 CJP members, alleging trespass, obstruction of personnel on duty; Dipke accuses govt. of imposing 'unofficial Emergency'; peaceful protest is not a crime, says Rahul

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were remanded in judicial custody for five days on Wednesday, a day after they were detained along with 12 others for allegedly entering Jantar Mantar, which the Delhi Police denotified as a designated protest site on Monday.

The police registered two first information reports (FIRs) against them over allegations of trespass, disobedience of official orders, and obstruction of police personnel on duty. Ajinkya Shinde, who was also placed under preventive arrest, was released after furnishing a personal bond and surety of ₹5,000, with an undertaking to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months, according to a police statement.

The CJP members reached Jantar Mantar on Tuesday by passing through private premises. Police personnel deployed at the site attempted to stop them, but the group allegedly obstructed the personnel in the discharge of their official duties, the police said. Subsequently, Mr. Das, Mr. Ranka and Mr. Shinde were placed under preventive arrest over what the police described as repeated attempts to disturb public peace and violate the law. Their attempts to use social media to instigate others to engage in similar activities were also taken into consideration, the police said.

They were produced before a Special Executive Magistrate, where proceedings were initiated under Sections 126 and 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). Section 126 empowers an Executive Magistrate to initiate proceedings when there is reason to believe that a person may breach the peace, and to require an undertaking to maintain peace for a period of up to one year. Section 170 empowers the police to arrest a person without a warrant to prevent the commission of a cognisable offence when it cannot otherwise be prevented.

Reacting to the development, CJP founder Abhijit Dipke accused the Narendra Modi government of imposing an "unofficial Emergency", and questioned why party members had been sent to judicial custody over their protest at Jantar Mantar.

In judicial custody: CJP leaders Ajinkya Shinde, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka in New Delhi on Wednesday. REUTERS

"I want to tell Mr. Modi that if you want to impose an Emergency in the country, do it officially. Why are you running an unofficial emergency where people are sent to five days of detention just for waving the national flag at Jantar Mantar?" he said.

'Act of cowardice'

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, said on X, "Waving the Tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is not a crime. Jailing youth for it is an act of cowardice."

"Students. Youth. Journalists. The INDIA bloc. Different banners, one cause. All protests are one: citizens demanding their constitutional right. Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India. We will reclaim it," he said.

Youth organisations took out a protest against the jailing of the leaders.

Denotifying Jantar Mantar pushes dissent 'out of sight, out of mind', says plea in SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court may list for hearing on October 26 a petition challenging the denotification of the area near Jantar Mantar as a designated site of protest in the national capital.

Rendering Jantar Mantar inaccessible will push dissent "out of sight and out of mind", the plea said, noting that a protest carried out far from the earshot of ordinary citizens loses much of its practical impact.

The petition by Swaty Singh, appearing through advocate Akanksha Mehra, was successfully registered and numbered on Wednesday. It has arraigned the Union government and the Delhi Police Commissioner as respondents.

The "right to protest is not merely a right to assemble at a designated physical space", the petition said. "It is a right to communicate grievances, express dissent and draw the attention of the public authorities and society at large towards matters requiring redressal," it said.

The authorities have found three alternative sites, but the petition said they are located on the outskirts of the national capital, far away from the corridors of power, Parliament, Supreme Court, Ministries, and public offices of central Delhi.

Site of protest: Jantar Mantar site's proximity to the power centres makes it a highly visible landmark. PTI

Public accessibility

Ms. Singh said the local protest cannot be dismissed as an "inconsequential administrative consideration". The Jantar Mantar site's proximity to the power centres of the state, accessibility to the public, and visibility to the intended audience may directly affect the power of dissent, she added.

"Relocating protests to distant or outlying areas of Delhi, particularly where such relocation materially increases the burden of participation and distances demonstrators from the authorities to whom their grievances are addressed, may substantially diminish the communicative purpose of peaceful assembly," the petition noted.

Ms. Singh said that while the denotification order was imposed with immediate administrative effect, amidst the ongoing protest, the government has not issued the Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for protesters to access the three new venues.

"Thus, the standing order, on its face, alters the existing arrangement without itself setting out a complete mechanism governing access to the new venues," the plea said.

Delhi Metro network was 'fully functional' on Oct. 10, says DMRC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Over 85% of the network remained fully operational and functional for commuters, it said

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) and its chairperson filed separate affidavits in the Supreme Court on Wednesday, stating that the Metro network remained "fully functional" on October 10, recording 32 lakh passengers.

"There was zero reduction in the total volume of metro operation or the number of train trips," the DMRC said.

Though the DMRC admitted that commuter traffic was "slightly lower" than the typical 58 lakh passengers on a "normal" second Saturday, it attributed the drop to public caution amid protests rather than administrative paralysis. It said ordinary citizens were "compelled to forgo their usual day-to-day activities".

The day saw heavy security crackdowns in the capital against demonstrations demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Petitioners like CPI (M) general secretary M.A. Baby and advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi had argued that widespread barricading and station closures violated an October 9 order mandating proportionate movement restrictions.

Defending its actions, the DMRC said entry and exit regulations were limited to 45 of the network's 303 stations on October 10.

"Over 85% of the network (258 stations) remained fully operational, accessible, and functional for commuters," it said.

SC to hear Opposition's plea on SIR, CEC today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court will hear on Thursday a joint petition filed by Opposition leaders led by Rahul Gandhi seeking a full disclosure of "files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections" recorded by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi on the special intensive revision (SIR).

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi are presiding over the Bench.

Mr. Gandhi sought an interim direction to suspend the SIR pending consideration and adjudication of the issues raised in the petition in order to protect the rights of eligible electors and preserving the integrity of the electoral process. Petitions challenging the police crackdown on protesters are also listed before the Bench.

Questions raised over police's failure to make prohibitory orders public

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The detention of protesters across the national capital while demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged electoral irregularities has raised questions over the Delhi Police's failure to make publicly available Section 163 prohibitory orders that it says are in force.

The provision empowers an Executive Magistrate to issue written orders when "immediate prevention or a speedy remedy" is necessary to prevent danger to human life or safety, disturbance of public tranquillity, or other specified threats.

A Section 163 BNSS order accessed by *The Hindu*, issued on August 23 by Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Ajay Sharma, shows the restrictions are confined to the Parliament Street police sub-division and expressly exclude a specifically demarcated area on Jantar Mantar Road. The order, in force until October 21, prohibits assembly of five or more persons, public meetings, processions, slogan-shouting, and speeches, among other activities.

No clarity: Students being detained during a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Delhi Police sources refused to confirm to *The Hindu* whether separate Section 163 BNSS orders for the other sub-divisions of New Delhi district – Connaught Place, Chanakyapuri and Barakhamba Road – or for the Jantar Mantar area had been made publicly available. They said hoardings had been put up and announcements were being made in these areas informing people that prohibitory orders were in force.

Former Supreme Court judge Abhay S. Oka said making prohibitory orders publicly available was necessary to give effect to the statutory right under Section 163(5) of the BNSS, which allows an aggrieved person to seek their rescission or alteration.

"When sub-section (5) of Section 163 expressly gives liberty to any person aggrieved by prohibitory orders to apply for modification or cancellation, there is a statutory mandate that the orders be published in the public domain. They cannot be kept confidential," Mr. Oka said. He added that public announcements or hoardings merely stating that prohibitory orders were in force would not satisfy this requirement.

Delhi-based advocate Abhinav Sekhri said the lack of public access to such orders was not new.

"For our research [for a report], we got access to a lot of these orders through Right to Information responses," he said. He pointed to the practice of reissuing "cyclostyled" orders as soon as their two-month statutory limit expired.

(With inputs from Vijaita Singh and Lavpreet Kaur)

Cong. slams Shah over 'infiltrators' remark

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday asked Union Minister Amit Shah to disclose how many alleged infiltrators had been detected, deleted from electoral rolls, and deported following the special intensive revision.

It accused the Centre of invoking the infiltration issue to divert attention from its allegations of large-scale disenfranchisement. Mr. Shah had accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi of wanting to get infiltrators registered as voters.

"How many *ghuspaithiye* (infiltrators) were detected? How many *ghuspaithiye* were deleted? How many *ghuspaithiye* were deported," Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said.

He asked whether Mr. Shah was suggesting that the nearly 14 crore people allegedly deprived of their rights were infiltrators.

In battle of cultural narratives, Rahul blends Puranic lore and pop culture idioms

NEWS ANALYSIS

Anuj Kumar

One of the key takeaways from Rahul Gandhi's press conference on Monday was his use of *Shivji ki Baraat* to counter the BJP's narrative of top-down command and control with the Opposition's fluid, decentralised style of protest.

Shivji Ki Baraat refers to the highly unusual wedding procession of Lord Shiva as he travelled to marry Goddess Parvati. This event is central to Hindu texts like the Shiva Purana and Tulsidas's *Ramcharitmanas*. By embedding Puranic iconography into a press conference about institutional accountability, Mr. Gandhi challenged the BJP's monopoly on religious symbolism.

It is said Lord Shiva's wedding procession was an unprecedented gathering that brought together entities who were otherwise bitter enemies or social outcasts. With the INDIA alliance partners led by Yadav heirs (Akhilesh and Tejaswi) of Mandal politics on one side and the emerging face of Left politics, Neha Bora, on the other, Mr. Gandhi attempted to translate the Opposition's fight into a multi-polar collective where there is no singular 'leader' on a pedestal.

Counter imagery

The BJP leadership quickly moved to counter the imagery, aggressively reframing the metaphor to fit their established political play book. Top Ministers counter-attacked by invoking polarising terms, calling the alliance a "*Huddangiyo ki Jamaat*" (a congregation of anarchists). Despite the push-back, political observers note that Mr. Gandhi's shift to present internal contradictions as Shaivite imagery of cosmic dissidence is giving the Opposition momentum as the BJP's imagination of a moral kingdom of Ram Rajya develops cracks.

By stating that the movement is "*Tandav*, Lord Shiva's dance" and there is "no need for a plan", Mr. Gandhi subverted the BJP's frequent criticism of the Opposition being "disorganised" or "chaotic", recasting their unpredictable moves as an organic, divine, and unstoppable force.

When Mr Gandhi said, "Anyone can join *Shivji ki baraat*... any living creature (*jeev*) can come, we will not stop them," he perhaps implicitly acknowledged the highly unconventional alliance of diverse political forces, ranging from the unyielding street resistance of Left-wing student groups to the fiercely independent Cockroach Janta Party. He addressed the image of a Khichdi (hodgepodge) coalition with no ideological unity and a common goal for the *baraat*: protecting the Constitution and democratic institutions against perceived over-centralisation.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi helps party chief Mallikarjun Kharge put on a Batman mask during a march in New Delhi. REUTERS

Mr. Gandhi also contrasted the fluidity of the protest with a more rigid political structure, historically which he described as having a designated "king", and an "operator", and where the public followed behind the chariot, suggesting that the public has moved on from the era of Rath Yatras.

While Mr. Gandhi has used the Lord Shiva's symbols inside Parliament, such as showing the *Abhaya Mudra* or posters of deities, to talk about fearlessness, this press conference was different because the metaphor materialised into real-time action on the streets and prime-time television within minutes.

Digital creators responded with Instagram reels of Neha Bora's temple run from R.K. Ashram Marg to Connaught Place with the popular background song, *Jab Zid Par Aa Gayi Parvati* (When Parvati stood her ground) from Hanuman Ansh. The song has been a rage, but by shifting the context, it has come to signify fierce feminine resistance to authority.

Over the years, Faiz Ahmad Faiz's *Hum Dekhenge* has been the default soundtrack of the progressive Leftist movement, but this Navaratri, social media is abuzz with the popular devotional number, *Sabse Bada Tera Naam O Sheronwali* (Suhag), with visuals of women protesters being detained.

Batman connection

At the same time, the Congress IT cell is working on casting Mr. Gandhi as Batman. It started with an "Ask me anything" session on Instagram in August, where a user asked Mr. Gandhi if he was Batman. When Mr. Gandhi was filmed scaling high yellow police barricades, the party's social media team spliced this footage with cinematic clips of Batman overlooking Gotham City, cementing the imagery.

During the march, a supporter passed a Batman mask through the crowd to the bus carrying senior Opposition leaders. Mr. Gandhi posed with the mask and helped Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge try it on as well.

The ruling party accused the Opposition of turning serious debate into a theatrical pop culture stunt, with Minister Jayant Chaudhary posting "Delhi isn't Gotham, and we don't need a dark superhero and Robin" on X.

A young Congress worker said that Gotham City people also believed they did not need a superhero. On a deeper, mythological level, he said, the imagery of Lord Shiva and Batman shows striking parallels.

By deploying both symbols simultaneously during the protests, the party tapped into a shared psychological image of the "righteous outsider" fighting a "compromised institutional framework" to protect ordinary citizens.

INBRIEF

4 Indian airlines cancel flights to Saudi Arabia till October 17

IndiGo, Air India Express, Air India, and Akasa Air on Tuesday announced cancelling flights connecting Saudi Arabian cities in view of the evolving situation in the Gulf country. IndiGo said that flights to and from Riyadh, Jeddah, Dammam and Madinah stand cancelled until October 17. While announcing cancellation of flights to and from Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah till October 17, Air India said it was closely monitoring and assessing the developments in the region. The airline said it was offering a full refund on cancellation for the affected passengers. Meanwhile, Akasa Air said it has extended the suspension of all flights to and from Riyadh and Jeddah until October 17. PTI

Power bank model banned on flights after fire incident

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) has prohibited MOBIKINS MK-PB-04 power bank on all flights to, from and within India. This comes after a power bank on an IndiGo flight from Chandigarh to Chennai exploded inside the overhead bin on October 11, forcing the flight to divert to Hyderabad, where emergency evacuation was carried out. In an airworthiness information circular (AIC) dated September 29, 2026, the DGCA directed airlines and passengers to ensure that the specified power bank is not carried on board aircraft, either as passenger baggage or as cargo. The prohibition covers both checked-in and cabin baggage. The circular cites potential safety risks associated with the device.

SC mandates insurance on offline railway tickets too

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court has issued a mandatory directive that tickets sold across counters at every railway station nationwide must include travel insurance coverage identical to online bookings. A Bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and R. Mahadevan directed the railway authorities to put the order into effect from October 27, 2026.

The order warned that failure to implement this mechanism would place direct liability squarely on the Railway Board. "At present, only people purchasing tickets online are provided the benefit of insurance coverage upon payment of a nominal additional amount. The court had granted sufficient time to the authorities to devise a mechanism extending such coverage to persons belonging to the lowest strata of society, who, in most cases, purchase their tickets at the railway reservation counters," the court observed, pointing out that the Railways had made no progress on providing insurance cover to all passengers.

The direction was based on a writ petition filed in the aftermath of the June 2023 Odisha train accident.

No order yet on extra 50 days of work for FRA title holders

Adivasis were entitled to additional work under MGNREGA; VB-G RAM G Act, which guarantees 125 days of employment per household in a year, has no tier for beneficiaries of Forest Rights Act

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Uncertainty continues for Adivasi households holding Forest Rights Act (FRA) titles, who were entitled under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) to an additional 50 days of work over and above the 100-day annual guarantee under the UPA-era law. The new rural employment programme, the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act (VB-G RAM G), which was rolled out on July 1, is yet to issue a notification clarifying the status of this entitlement.

In a reply dated October 6 to an application under the Right to Information Act filed by Chakkradhar Buddha of the National Campaign for People's Right to Information (NCPRI), the Rural Development Ministry said that "no separate order, circular or guideline prescribing any additional wage employment entitlement for FRA title holders under VB-G RAM G has been issued as on date".

The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025, guarantees 125 days of wage employment per rural household in a financial year. It has no separate tier for FRA title holders. Section 5(4) states that the Centre or a State government may provide work beyond the guaranteed days within the limits of its economic capacity. The provision is discretionary and names no specific group. Section 7 allows the Centre, on a State's recommendation, to grant relaxations during natural calamities, including enhanced wage-employment provisioning.

In the absence of a notification, uncertainty continues over work opportunities for Adivasi households holding FRA titles. FILE PHOTO

In the absence of such a notification, uncertainty continues over whether Adivasi households holding FRA titles will receive only 125 days of guaranteed employment, on a par with other beneficiaries across the country, or 175 days, including the additional 50 days of employment available to them under MGNREGA.

Sources in the Ministry said the government would shortly be issuing a notification approving an additional 50 days of work.

"As there are six more months still available in the financial year, FRA beneficiaries can easily avail of the additional 50 days anytime during this period after completing 125 days," a senior Ministry official said.

Under MGNREGA, the additional entitlement began only in January 2014. An additional 50 days of guaranteed work had first been introduced for drought-prone areas in 2012. Even during the UPA regime, it took at least two years of deliberations within the government before the additional guaranteed work was approved.

The implementation of this additional entitlement has also remained patchy. Andhra Pradesh is the only State that performed well.

Data available with the Union Rural Development Ministry for 2025-26 reveal that under MGNREGA, only 15% of the 14 lakh households eligible for 150 days of work availed themselves of the benefit. Odisha had the highest number of registered households at 3,72,089, of which 71,696 availed themselves of the additional days.

Chhattisgarh had 3,20,651 registered households and 36,716 beneficiaries; Madhya Pradesh had 2,21,674 registered households and 29,065 beneficiaries; Andhra Pradesh had 1,70,851 registered households and 36,008 beneficiaries; Tripura had 1,08,532 registered households and 22,251 beneficiaries; and Maharashtra had 96,559 registered households and 8,063 beneficiaries. These six States account for 12.9 lakh of the registered households.

Railway staff to get bonus equivalent to 78 days' wages

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved payment of productivity-linked bonus (PLB) of 78 days totalling ₹2,009.61 crore to 11,40,770 railway employees.

Union Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said that the bonus was approved in recognition of "the excellent performance by the Railway staff".

Mr. Vaishnaw said payment of PLB to eligible railway employees is made each year before the Durga Puja and Dasara holidays.

"This year also, PLB amount equivalent to 78 days' wages is being paid to about 11.4 lakh non-gazetted Railway employees. The payment of PLB acts as an incentive to motivate the railway employees for working towards improvement in the performance of the Railways," Mr. Vaishnaw said.

The maximum amount payable per eligible railway employee is ₹17,951 for 78 days. The amount will be paid to various categories of Railway staff, such as Track Maintainers, Loco Pilots, Train Managers (Guards), Station Masters, Supervisors, Technicians, and other Group 'C staff'.

BJP women's wing asks for NCW action on Cong. MP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A high-level BJP Mahila Morcha delegation on Wednesday met National Commission for Women (NCW) Chairperson Vijaya Rahatkar and submitted a memorandum seeking action in the alleged sexual harassment case involving Congress MP and former JNU professor Angomcha Bimol Akoijam.

The delegation was led by Mahila Morcha incharge Daggubati Purandeswari and BJP Mahila Morcha national president Roop Kumari Chaudhary.

Ms. Chaudhary said the delegation had urged the NCW Chairperson to take cognisance of the matter. She also questioned the Congress party's "silence" on the issue.

Bauxite mining proposal in Odisha's Balda hills threatens future of rare ground gecko

Divya Gandhi
BENGALURU

In the crevices of boulders and beneath the rustle of leaf litter in the hills of the Eastern Ghats in Odisha and Andhra Pradesh lives a tiny population of the strikingly-patterned Jeypore ground gecko, which was presumed extinct for 130 years until it was rediscovered in 2010.

Just four individuals of this endangered species have been documented in the past year in Odisha's Balda hills, worryingly, within the site of a proposed bauxite mining project by an Adani-linked group.

The nocturnal gecko, some 3.6 inches long, with a comparatively large head, and a yellow-orange body, was originally documented in 1878 by the British naturalist Richard Henry Beddome. More than a century later, in 2010, herpetologists Ishan Agarwal and Aniruddha Datta-Roy rediscovered a specimen in Odisha's Koraput district.

Facing oblivion: The Jeypore ground gecko was presumed extinct for 130 years until it was rediscovered in 2010. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Later, there were more sightings: one in 2025, and three this year, including one this month. The gecko's behaviour, habits and lifecycle continue to elude scientists.

What is known, however, is that its habitat is fast shrinking. In fact, the habitat where it was first sighted in the 1870s, Potangi in Odisha, has already been lost to bauxite mining by the National Aluminium Company Limited (NALCO), where the animal is believed to be now extinct.

And today, the spectre of Adani's opencast bauxite mine proposal, covering 147 hectares of forest in the Balda hills, within the Nageswari reserve forest, threatens the future of this vulnerable species.

Adivasi uprising

The bauxite mining project has also been the site of much contention among resident Adivasis of the Nageswari reserve forest, who have protested the proposal for the past two years. The Bondo and Porja Adivasis, whose ancestral land this is, lodged a complaint against the Adani-subsidiary Kalinga Alumina Ltd. in February, but to no avail.

"The communities have also applied for forest rights over the hill, which the government has refused to recognise," naturalist Yuvan Aves told *The Hindu*. "There was a demonstration earlier this month too, and when the Adani group flew drones to scope the area, the Adivasi people stopped the exercise, asserting that this is their ancestral land."

Mr. Agarwal said that the gecko is "an ecologically and biogeographically significant species having split from its closest relatives over 20 million years ago." This is a relatively range-restricted species that is only found in high-elevation (900-1,400 metres) forests in the Eastern Ghats. "Anything that threatens their habitat is the major risk. Coffee [though we don't understand to what extent], hydel, mining are all potential threats," he told *The Hindu*.

ED seizes assets worth ₹2,032 cr. of Reliance Power

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has seized assets worth ₹2,032.81 crore belonging to Reliance Power Limited in India under the Foreign Exchange Management Act, the agency said on Wednesday.

The assets include the bank balances of Reliance Power Ltd., and its shareholding in Sasan Power Ltd. Their cumulative value is equivalent to that of foreign exchange held outside India, allegedly in contravention of the Act, according to the ED.

"Investigation was initiated on the basis of information received from the Securities and Exchange Board of India, pertaining to write-offs/provisions aggregating ₹2,101.46 crore made by Reliance Power Ltd. in its books of account. These write-offs were related to overseas investments and advances made to companies in the British Virgin Islands and the Cayman Islands," the ED said.

Meanwhile, Reliance Power Ltd. disputed the allegations, saying it would take all appropriate steps to safeguard its interests, as well as the interests of all its shareholders.

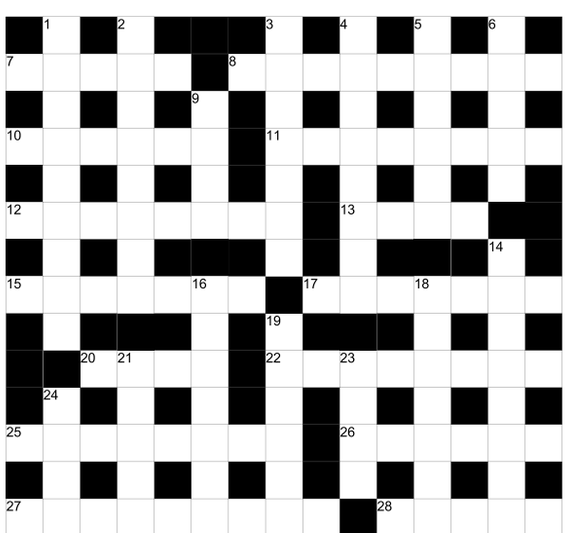
In March, the agency had conducted searches in the same matter. "Investigation has revealed that Reliance Natural Resources Ltd (since merged with Reliance Power Ltd.) raised $300 million through Foreign Currency Convertible Bonds in 2006," it said.

TH CROSSWORD + 14924

(set by Mythical)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



ACROSS

7. Tolerate burn (5)
8. Fighting with others leads individuals nowhere good primarily (9)
10. Some excitement all around? It could make one sick (6)
11. Ill-treats player's family members (8)
12. Attack popular victor when ace returns (8)
13. Be different occasionally! That's good in France (4)
15. Injured kitten ultimately recovered, healed (7)
17. Jogs memory of confused nursemaid after a uniform goes missing (7)
20. Lying about research centre on island somewhere in Indonesia (4)
22. Say, man from Zagreb ordered raincoat (8)
25. Mentioned favour after leader left with communist (8)
26. Bond with judge having lunch (6)
27. A most harsh setter offering sweetener (9)
28. Government control discussed (5)

DOWN

1. Renowned expert to fund books (9)
2. Tense agreement (8)
3. Quietly object to host (7)
4. This group row affected seam bowlers (8)
5. Likely seen going around Presidential Palace (6)
6. Foolish sign painter crossing out every other letter (5)
9. Bill given top quality fruit (4)
14. Notice vehicle near gate needing repair? Good! (9)
16. Resettle girl in Sharjah, perhaps (8)
18. Broke thin reed casually (2,3,3)
19. A scoundrel essentially surveying my school? (7)
21. Rings sound artist in recess (6)
23. Heartily dislike obscenity (4)
24. Basically, brutish evildoer always showing temper (5)

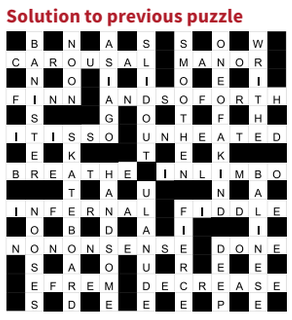
SUDOKU

	7	6						
5			1					
2	8	1				9	5	
	2	8	4	6				
	6			1			2	
				9	7	1	6	
	4	5				3	8	9
					6			7
						2	4	

No.SS7032 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	7	1	6	8	2	3	4	9
9	4	3	7	5	1	6	8	2
6	8	2	4	3	9	7	5	1
2	9	8	1	4	6	5	7	3
3	5	7	2	9	8	1	6	4
1	6	4	5	7	3	2	9	8
7	2	9	3	6	4	8	1	5
8	3	6	9	1	5	4	2	7
4	1	5	8	2	7	9	3	6

FAITH

Rejection of Vidura's advice

Dhritarashtra was aware that because of his envy, Duryodhana resorted to cruel ways to suppress the Pandavas, said Kidambi Narayanan in a discourse. He knew that Yudhishthira was being invited to play a game of dice when Sakuni was bent on being dishonest. He didn't lift a finger to stop Dushasana, when he pulled Draupadi's saree, with a view to shaming her in court. Because he knew that his sons were unjust, Dhritarashtra was afraid of public reaction. He was also afraid that the sins of his sons would catch up with them. So, he often sought the advice of Vidura, who was known to be level-headed, righteous and knowledgeable in the dharma sastras. Vidura never tired of answering the king's request for help. Every time he was sent for and asked to offer words of counsel, he did so without hesitation. He told Dhritarashtra how his sons should behave, and what his duties as a king were. When the Pandavas and Draupadi left for the forest, Dhritarashtra was agitated fearing that his subjects might revolt. He sent for Vidura, and sought his advice.

Vidura pointed out to Dhritarashtra how unjust his sons had been and that the only way forward was for Dushasana to apologise to Bhima in the very court in which Draupadi had been humiliated. He also must seek Draupadi's forgiveness, said Vidura. As always, Dhritarashtra was unwilling to accept Vidura's advice. He accused Vidura of being partial to the Pandavas, and of having only their welfare in mind. He felt that Vidura's advice was one-sided, and that if he followed what Vidura advocated it would be unfair to his sons. So he told Vidura to leave the court if he chose.

INBRIEF

Govt. to roll out BS-VII norms for new cars from April 2029

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is planning to roll out stricter BS-VII emission standards for new cars and SUVs from April 1, 2029, according to a draft gazette notification. The ministry said in an October 12 draft notification that it will implement all new norms in three phases spanning 6 years from April 2029 to April 2035. PTI

Jio Platforms to launch 'India's biggest ever' ₹30,213-cr. IPO

Jio Platforms Ltd. will launch a ₹30,213-crore initial public offering (IPO), making it India's biggest ever, surpassing Hyundai Motor India's ₹27,859-crore issue. The price band has been fixed at ₹1,065-₹1,119 per equity share, with a face value of ₹10. Investors can bid for a minimum of 12 shares and in multiples of 12 thereafter. The IPO will open for subscription on October 21, 2026, and close on Friday, October 23.

Tata Trusts row: Noel, Neville move courts with caveats

Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata and his son Neville have filed caveats in city courts in the row surrounding Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh, sources said on Wednesday. The caveats filed in the Bombay High Court and also in the Mumbai City Civil Court will ensure that they are heard before the passing of any orders. Both the father and son moved the courts with their caveats on October 7, as per official records. PTI

Cabinet okays IDBI Bank sale to Fairfax for ₹52,878 cr.

Largest FDI deal in the financial sector in India's history; with the sale, the government's stake in the bank will decline to 15% and the Life Insurance Corporation's stake will come down to 19%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved the 'strategic restructuring' of IDBI Bank, with Fairfax set to acquire a stake in the lender for ₹52,878 crore, the Centre announced. With this, the government's stake in the bank will fall to 15% and Life Insurance Corporation's (LIC) stake will come down to 19%.

The government termed the deal a strategic restructuring rather than strategic disinvestment, adding that it would be the largest foreign direct investment in the financial sector in India's history. The government currently holds 45.5% of IDBI Bank, while LIC holds 49.2%.

IDBI Bank, having suffered from poor financial health for years, had been put under a Prompt Corrective Action (PCA) framework in 2017.

In January 2019, LIC took over controlling stake in the bank by infusing ₹21,624 crore into it and being allotted preferential shares in return.

As a result, the government's stake in the bank fell below 51% and the RBI classified it as a private bank since then.

Ailment history: IDBI Bank, which suffered from poor financial health, was put under Prompt Corrective Action in 2017. REUTERS

"It was against this backdrop that the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved strategic restructuring of the IDBI Bank Ltd., and in compliance thereof, it was decided that an aggregate 60.72% of the equity stake in the IDBI Bank Ltd be sold to a strategic buyer, of which, the GoI share would be 30.48% and the LIC share would be 30.24%, leaving a residual shareholding of 15% with the GoI and 19% with the LIC," the government said.

It further said that the winning bidder, out of two parties that finally qualified for bidding, was Canada-headquartered Fairfax Financial Holdings with a bid fixed at ₹81 per share.

Sources in the Ministry of Finance said this strategic restructuring does not change anything for the regulation of the banks or its customer-facing duties.

The bank has seen a significant turnaround in its financial health since it became a private bank. Its gross non-performing asset ratio fell from 31.8% in September 2018 to 2.3% as of March 2026. Its capital adequacy ratio rebounded from 6.22% in 2018 to 26.65% in March 2026. It recorded a net profit of ₹9,513 crore in FY26.

BoB tanks 3.5% as NMC founder sues it for $15 bn

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Bank of Baroda (BoB) shares fell 3.47% to ₹229.35 on the BSE on Wednesday after reports that B.R. Shetty, founder of the failed UAE-based NMC Healthcare, had filed a $15-billion damages suit against the bank and 25 others.

The bank said it had not been served with any such suit. Mr. Shetty, 84, has approached the Bombay High Court, alleging that the defendants acted "as an instrument in the siphoning of funds" that led to the collapse of his business empire. The suit names BoB, 10 current and former bank officers, former NMC executives Prasanth and Promoth Manghat, their family members and associates, and two domestic entities.

The suit seeks $5 billion each in direct and consequential damages jointly and severally against the defendants, besides $5 billion exclusively from BoB for loss of reputation and goodwill, along with 18% annual interest.

BoB said it was pursuing recovery of about ₹2,800 crore from Mr. Shetty and had obtained decrees against him in the UAE and DIFC Courts.

The bank added that a similar suit filed by Mr. Shetty in New York was dismissed in July 2024.

Centre to unveil national power data sharing framework

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Pankaj Agarwal

The government is set to roll out the National Electricity Data Sharing Framework in October to facilitate structured and secure data sharing in the power sector, Pankaj Agarwal, Secretary at the Union Power Ministry, said on Wednesday.

A national-level data governance committee, comprising government officials and industry representatives, will also be constituted to ensure a coordinated approach. The committee will be chaired by the Central Electricity Authority (CEA) Chairperson.

"After consultations with stakeholders, we have prepared the National Electricity Data Sharing framework and would want to assure that we would be launching this in October itself," Mr. Agarwal said. The Power Ministry had floated the draft framework for stakeholder consultation in June.

It lays down broad principles for structured, secure and transparent data sharing, while ensuring non-discriminatory access and protecting critical information infrastructure.

The voluntary framework is intended to help utilities establish common data structures and provide clarity on what information can be shared, enabling startups and other industry players to use large datasets for analysis and decision-making, he told reporters on the sidelines of the Central Electricity Authority's Brainstorming Conclave on the use of artificial intelligence in the sector.

Providing clarity

"The whole idea is to give clarity, rather a starting point to utilities about data sharing – what kind of data they can share, what should be the data structure. If you want the industry, [potentially] start-ups, to utilise the large volume of data sets – then they have to be consistent, similar in structure, so that they can be gainfully leveraged for giving various decision options," Mr. Agarwal said.

Separately, Jitin Prasada, Minister of State for Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), said the government would roll out a policy for data centres, positioning India as a potential destination for hyperscale facilities.

Hyundai Pune unit to get ₹4,000 cr. more

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Hyundai Motor India Ltd. (HMIL) will invest an additional ₹4,000 crore in it's Pune plant by 2030 taking the total to ₹11,000 crore.

The plant's current annual installed capacity of 1,70,000 units will rise in phases to 3,20,000 units by 2030, MD & CEO Tarun Garg said. The firm said it would raise localisation from 83% to 92%.

The plant, the firm's second after Chennai, was opened by Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis.

Euisun Chung, executive chair - Hyundai Motor Group HMG, Jaehoon Chang, vice chair - HMG, José Muñoz, president & CEO - Hyundai Motor Company (HMC) were present.

HMIL also celebrated the achievement of cumulative exports of 4 million passenger vehicles from India since 1999, underscoring its contribution towards establishing India as a global automotive manufacturing and export hub.

Devendra Fadnavis at the Pune plant inauguration.

Mr. Euisun Chung, said, "India is one of Hyundai's most important and strategic markets globally. The inauguration of the Pune plant reflects our long-term commitment to India's growth."

Food, fuel nudge wholesale inflation in Sept. to 11.4%

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Wholesale price inflation rose to 11.4% in September, a record-breaking high during the 2.5 years for which there is data for the new series of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) and a 49-month-high as per the much longer old series on pricier food and fuel.

The new series of the WPI has 2022-23 as base year and so the data goes back till only April 2024. The older series, with base year of 2011-12, has a much longer historical database.

"The non-food manufactured goods (core WPI) segment accounted for more than half of the 147 bps uptick in the headline inflation print in September relative to August 2026, reflecting the impact of the pass-through of input cost pressures," Rahul Agrawal, principal economist at ICRA said.

Inflation in fuel and power rose to 25.85% in September.

Food sharply up

Inflation in the food articles component of the WPI came in at 8.1% in September 2026, up sharply from 5.7% in the previous month. However, this was also on a low base as prices in this component had contracted 6.8% in September last year.

The non-food primary articles segment also saw elevated inflation levels of 10.3% in September though this was the lowest in four months. Inflation in manufactured goods stood at a series-high of 9.8%, up from 8.4% in August 2026.

"The increase in wholesale inflation across food articles, fuel and power, and manufactured products highlights the need for businesses to closely monitor input costs and pricing conditions," Anil Gupta, president, of the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry said.

Inflation in fuel and power rose to 25.85% in September though this was the highest in only three months with the pace of price rise having been higher in May and June.

SEBI targets 4 lakh accredited investors via expanded AIF

Gowri Lakshmi
MUMBAI

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is likely to issue a circular shortly to expand the framework for alternative investment funds (AIFs), including provisions to recognise assets with high growth potential, said Sandip Pradhan, whole-time member of the capital markets regulator.

"The revised framework is evolving, we already had a board meeting and very soon we will be coming out with a circular that we are also adding one more aspect, that is the assets of high growth or movement in the security market," Mr. Pradhan said at the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Alternative Investments Summit here.

SEBI will be shortly coming out with a circular on revised AIF.

The inclusion is expected to expand the pool of accredited investors in the AIF industry to four lakh from the current 1 lakh.

AIFs are privately-pooled investment vehicles that raise capital from institutional investors and high-net-worth individuals to invest in alternative asset classes, including unlisted securities and other non-traditional investments. Given exposure to complex and potentially illiquid assets, they carry higher risks and are subject to a regulatory framework distinct from that governing retail investment products.

SEBI's August 2026 consultation paper proposes easing the eligibility criteria for accredited investors. Under Proposal 6, individuals with at least ₹5 crore and companies with at least ₹20 crore invested in securities could qualify, with electronic consolidated account statements (eCAS) or broker statements accepted as proof.

Panel to study issues of sugarcane farmers

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The panel will also examine the demand for revision of the ex-mill Minimum Selling Price of sugar

The Centre set up a four-member panel under former NITI Aayog Member Ramesh Chand to examine issues raised by sugarcane farmers and recommend "appropriate measures" for addressing these. Representatives of sugarcane farmers from Karnataka and Maharashtra met Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Union Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution Pralhad Joshi demanding the Centre raise support price for sugarcane.

A release issued by the Union Food Ministry said the panel would examine the demand taking into account cultivation costs and other factors. "It will also examine the demand for revision of the ex-mill Minimum Selling Price (MSP) of sugar in the context of sugar output cost, market realisation and the financial viability of sugar mills.

Other key areas of examination would include existing mechanisms for testing and reporting sugar recovery, steps to ensure transparent verification of recovery and prevailing sugarcane weighment practices at sugar mills.

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
OMC ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LTD. Mining Happiness

CORRIGENDUM

The **National E-auction Notice (19.10.2026 – 219th & 220th E-auction) of Iron Ore CLO & Iron Ore Fines** published in the "Pragativadi, The Hindu and The New Indian Express" dtd.13.10.2026 **has been rescheduled to be held on dt. 21.10.2026 from 11.00 AM to 2.00 PM.**

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Chief General Manager (S&M)

30001/124/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0095

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED
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CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
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CORRIGENDUM

The **National E-auction Notice on dt.19.10.2026 of Manganese Ore** published in the "Pragativadi, The Hindu and The New Indian Express" on dtd.13.10.2026 **has been rescheduled to be held on dt.21.10.2026 from 11.00 AM to 2.00 PM.**

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. **www.mstcecommerce.com**

Chief General Manager (S&M)

30001/125/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0096

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - e-Procurement Notice
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER,
CENTRAL MINOR IRRIGATION CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR
Phone-0674-2540559 ; Mail ID : cmic.bbsr@gmail.com;
No.1844 /CMIC Date : 12.10.2026

CANCELLATION OF TENDER

Cancellation Notice of Bid Identification No- ACE - CMIC-2 of 2026-27

The e-procurement Notice No-ACE — CMIC-02 of 2026-27 of work ID No-2026-CEMIB_141741_1, invited by the Additional Chief Engineer, Central Minor Irrigation Circle, Bhubaneswar vide letter no 1714 dated- 21.09.2026 is hereby Cancelled due to Technical Error.

Further details can be seen from the e-procurement market place http.//tendersodisha.gov.in .

Additional Chief Engineer,
Central M.I.Circle, Bhubaneswar.

32001/1041/2627 OIPR-32001/32047/1/26-27/0005

जवाहरलाल स्नातकोत्तर आयुर्विज्ञान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान
JAWAHARLAL INSTITUTE OF POSTGRADUATE MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH
(स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के अधीन राष्ट्रीय महत्व का संस्थान)
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वेबसाइट / Website: www.jipmer.edu.in ई—मेल / Email: jipmer.deputation@gmail.com दूरभाष / Phone: 0413-2296022

No. JP/ADMN-1/REC03(1)/1/2026 Dated: 15.10.2026

The Director, JIPMER, Puducherry invites applications from eligible officers of the Central / State / Union Territory Governments / Universities / Central Statutory / Autonomous Bodies / Public Sector Undertakings / Research and Development Organizations for the post of **Financial Advisor** (on deputation basis), as under:

Sl. No	Name of the post	Pay Matrix (as per 7th CPC)	Vacancy
1	**Financial Advisor**	Level-12 (₹78,800 – 2,09,200)	1

The format of the application and other details regarding pay scale, age, qualification, experience and other conditions of eligibility for the above post are available on the JIPMER website **"www.jipmer.edu.in".** The last date for receipt of filled-in applications is **16.11.2026 till 4.30 P.M.**

DIRECTOR

JERUSALEM

Netanyahu says he is not seeking to attack Iran before Israel election

AP

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said on Wednesday that he was not in favour of a pre-emptive strike against Iran before Israel's October 27 election but also warned Tehran and its proxies against striking Israel. "It is not convenient for us, it's no good," Netanyahu said in an interview on Israel's Army Radio. REUTERS

WASHINGTON

Russian diesel deal 'not for us', but for world markets, says Trump

REUTERS

Facing criticism over the diesel deal with Russia, U.S. President Donald Trump said the fuel from Moscow's refineries was meant to stabilise the global market, which has been hit by high prices. "That's a diesel deal. Not for us. That's being released into the world. That's not being released to us," he said on Tuesday. PTI

MIKHMAS

Israeli settlers set fire to mosque, graffiti outside walls in West Bank

REUTERS

Israeli settlers set fire to a mosque and graffitied its outside walls on Wednesday in the occupied West Bank village of Mikhmas, sources and the Israeli military said. Rouhi Fattouh, president of the Palestinian National Council, described the attack as "a barbaric act and a dangerous escalation in settler terrorism". AFP

WASHINGTON

U.S. judge backs *CNN*, *MS Now*, *Politico* access to White House

AFP

A federal judge blocked on Tuesday the White House from banning *CNN*, *MS Now* and *Politico* journalists, following U.S. President Donald Trump's decision to ban the news outlets last month. District Judge Timothy Kelly ruled that the Trump administration must grant the journalists access to the White House. AFP

Houthis vow more strikes on Saudi airports, oil sites after Aramco hit

An attack on Aramco's Dhahran headquarters reportedly caused a blaze spreading across several floors; the group says its strikes on 'legitimate targets' are a retaliation for Saudi attacks on Yemen and the kingdom's support for Yemeni govt. forces

Reuters
RIYADH/DUBAI

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) vowed on Wednesday to press on with attacks on airports and oil facilities in Saudi Arabia, a day after a strike that sources said caused extensive damage to the headquarters of oil giant Saudi Aramco.

The Houthis said the threatened locations were legitimate targets and described their attacks as retaliation for Saudi strikes on Yemen, threatening to escalate a conflict reignited by the U.S.-Iran confrontation in the Gulf.

Critical strike: The headquarters of Saudi Aramco in Dhahran, Saudi Arabia, before it was attacked on Tuesday night. REUTERS

Saudi Arabia has faced widening Houthi strikes over the past week, including an attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh on Saturday that killed 13 people.

Tuesday night's attack on Saudi Aramco's base in the eastern city of Dhahran caused a fire that spread across several floors, three people with knowledge of the matter told *Reuters*. The Saudi Energy Ministry had said the strike caused a limited fire.

Operations at Aramco were continuing normally, with employees working from home, according to two of the sources.

The escalating conflict has dealt a blow to Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman's ambitious plans to transform and diversify the Saudi economy and reduce its reliance on oil.

The Houthis say they have been retaliating for the kingdom's backing of Yemeni government forces in the Yemen war that restarted last month.

The Saudi-led coalition said it had intercepted a ballistic missile fired by the Houthis towards Riyadh on Wednesday, and several loud booms were heard in the Saudi capital.

Saudi authorities earlier issued an alert for a possible aerial threat in Riyadh on Wednesday before the warning was lifted, a witness said.

In their statement on Wednesday, the Houthis said they had launched ballistic missiles, cruise missiles and drones at the Saudi Aramco facilities in Dhahran, Riyadh airport and an Aramco refinery in Riyadh.

Ukraine accuses U.S. of aiding Russia amid strikes

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

Ukrainian firefighters extinguish a blaze at the site of a Russian missile strike at an apartment building in Kyiv on Wednesday. AFP

Ukraine on Wednesday accused the United States of helping Russia, saying Washington failed to warn it of incoming missile strikes and slowed the Starlink system it relies on for its battlefield communications and frontline logistics.

U.S. President Donald Trump on Tuesday insisted Washington was still helping Ukraine, while a U.S. official said on Wednesday that its policy had "not changed". The EU also said there were "no indications" sharing had stopped.

Ballistic missiles have now struck the Ukrainian capital, Kyiv, for two nights running – before air raid sirens could sound in time to warn people to take cover in basements, bomb shelters or metro stations.

Energy facilities were targeted, cutting power to more than 600,000, despite Mr. Trump's surprise announcement of an "energy ceasefire" in the nearly five-year conflict.

"Russia has never before shown such ostentatious disrespect toward the United States," Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said.

Six people were killed and dozens more wounded in Kyiv on Wednesday, the authorities said, while significant damage to facilities and equipment knocked out power to swathes of the city.

UN wants Lebanon stability as UNIFIL mandate nears end

Agence France-Presse
BEIRUT

Jean-Pierre Lacroix

A visiting senior United Nations official on Wednesday reaffirmed the UN's commitment to stability in Lebanon as the mandate of its peacekeeping force in the country is set to expire.

Under-Secretary-General for Peace Operations Jean-Pierre Lacroix met officials as well as representatives of countries contributing to the UN Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL), which counts some 7,500 personnel from nearly 50 countries.

"I thanked them for their critical support to UNIFIL and reiterated the UN's strong commitment to supporting peace and stability in Lebanon," Mr. Lacroix said.

UNIFIL has served as a buffer between Israel and Lebanon since 1978.

Under U.S. pressure, the UN Security Council last year voted to end UNIFIL's mandate on December 31, 2026.

Iran says a ship sank after hitting a mine in Strait of Hormuz

Agence France-Presse
DUBAI

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said on Wednesday that a ship caught fire and sank in the Strait of Hormuz because of a mine, while British security firm Vanguard also reported a sinking.

"A container ship attempting to cross the Strait of Hormuz using an unauthorised and dangerous shipping lane struck a mine that exploded," said the navy of the Revolutionary Guards, the ideological arm of Iran's military.

Images released by the Guards show a plume of black smoke rising from a ship, while dozens of containers that have fallen into the sea float on the water. The Guards said the ship was carrying more than 2,500 containers.

According to Vanguard, the *GFS Pride*, a Singapore-flagged container ship, was struck by a projectile on Tuesday and sank. It was not clear if the two statements referred to the same ship. Vanguard reported three other ships struck on Tuesday, with two of them continuing on their way and the fate of the third unknown.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre reported on Wednesday that two container ships were struck on Tuesday by projectiles.

Saudi top court sets aside Sri Lankan migrant worker's death sentence

Meera Srinivasan
COLOMBO

The Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia on Wednesday set aside the death penalty awarded to a Sri Lankan migrant worker over a Facebook post that was deemed blasphemous.

"On 13 October 2026, the Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia set aside the judgment imposing the death penalty on Anojan Sivarasa. This follows sustained diplomatic and legal efforts by the Government of Sri Lanka," Sri Lanka's Deputy Foreign Minister Arun Hemachandra announced in a social media post, terming the development "a major relief" for the 24-year-old engineer hailing from the island's eastern Ampara district.

Sivarasa Anojan

According to senior lawyer and President's Counsel Upul Kumarapperuma, who was on the team sent to Riyadh by the Sri Lankan government, Anojan's death penalty was set aside by the Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia and referred to the lower court that originally heard the case. "The case is expected to be heard within two weeks, and a fresh sentence is likely," he told *The Hindu* on Wednesday.

In a social media post, President Anura Kumara Dissanayake said the development "brings immense relief to Anojan, his family, and all Sri Lankans who have followed his case with deep concern". The move "reflects the value of patient diplomacy, respect for the legal processes of a friendly nation, and the tireless work of those who stood by a Sri Lankan citizen abroad," he said, adding: "No Sri Lankan who leaves our shores in search of a livelihood should ever feel that they stand alone."

Anojan's Facebook comment, posted in June this year, was part of a heated exchange among social media users over a video of a Muslim man attacking a dog named Subramani, which had drawn media attention even as it accompanied Hindu pilgrims to the Kataragama temple, a famed shrine for the deity Skanda in southern Sri Lanka. Accused of "verbally insulting and offending Prophet Muhammad", Anojan – who subsequently posted a public apology – was sentenced to five years in prison initially. In September, the Saudi Court of Appeal in the Eastern Region awarded him a death sentence.

GREAT FEAT

Hope becomes first Windies batter with three tons in men's T20Is

NAGARA GOPAL

Shai Hope became the first West Indies batter with three hundreds in men's T20Is and the fifth player (after England's Phil Salt, Indians Sanju Samson & Tilak Varma, and Pakistan's Sahibzada Farhan) from a full member nation to do so. Incidentally, each of Hope's T20I centuries have been identical scores of 102 not out.

'SELECTION' TALK

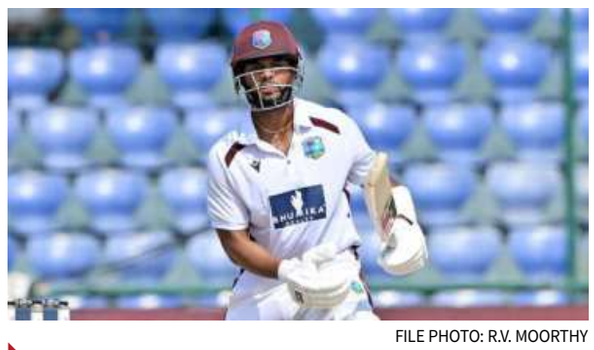
Parthiv doesn't apply, Ojha set to be full-time chairman

FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

Parthiv Patel, tipped to replace Ajit Agarkar as the West Zone representative on the BCCI senior men's selection committee, has not applied for the position, paving the way for Pragyan Ojha to continue as chairman. "The situation could change if the deadline is extended or he changes his mind," a BCCI source said.

A BREAK

Hope rested for West Indies' Test tour of Bangladesh



FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

West Indies squad for the two-Test series against Bangladesh: Roston Chase (Capt.), Jomel Warrican, Joshua Bishop, John Campbell, Tagenarine Chanderpaul, Joshua Da Silva, Justin Greaves, Kavem Hodge, Amir Jangoo, Shamar Joseph, Brandon King, Keemo Paul, Kemar Roach, Jayden Seales, Kevin Wickham.

IPL BUZZ

Natarajan returns to SRH, Zeeshan joins DC after player trade

FILE PHOTOS: R.V. MOORTHY & K.V.S. GIRI

Left-arm pacer T. Natarajan returned to Sunrisers Hyderabad while leg-spinner Zeeshan Ansari moved to Delhi Capitals in a player trade between the two IPL franchises on Wednesday. Natarajan will join the 2016 IPL champions for a revised fee of ₹five crore. Zeeshan moves to Delhi Capitals at his existing fee of ₹40 lakh.

Hope and Paul sizzle as West Indies trumps India

The skipper smashes his second century of the series to power the visiting team to 247 before the seamer derails the host's chase with a five-for; the blistering start by Samson not enough

Leading from the front: Hope scored the lion's share of West Indies' runs. NAGARA GOPAL

WI IN INDIA

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

It arrived dressed as a stranger, this refreshed pitch at the Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium, with the promise of a different story. India, squinting into the unknown, chose to chase. But the night peeled back the disguise soon enough, and beneath it lay that same old batting paradise.

Shai Hope's sensational unbeaten century lit the fuse for West Indies' 24-run win over India on Wednesday, dragging the series level at 2-2.

Jewel Andrew, having taken the pitch's measure, got to work for the Windies, raining down on Arshdeep Singh with two boundaries and a six that sailed high over mid-wicket.

Mayank Yadav's pace and bounce backfired, costing him 11 extras.

The visitor tore past 50 in just 15 balls. After Andrew fell to Axar Patel, Shai Hope and Shimron Hetmyer ensured the respite was brief. The Windies registered 79 in the Power-Play, the joint-highest score in this phase (with New Zealand in Thiruvananthapuram earlier this year) against India in T20Is.

The team 100 came in just 42 balls with India reduced to a hapless spectator.

Hope then found a cautious partner in Rovman Powell, who then burst free to help plunder Axar for 22 runs in an over.

Sherfane Rutherford then joined Hope to stitch together a 91-run stand off just 43 balls, Hope raising his arms to celebrate a ton for the second time in the T20I leg.

Sanju Samson loves Hyderabad and his affection shone bright as he clobbered his way to his joint-fastest T20I fifty off 20 balls, with a daunting 248-run chase before him.

Hope turned to executioner of choice Keemo Paul, who came good not once but twice, first striking Samson off the ledger before sending Ishan Kishan back a few deliveries later.

Abhishek Sharma, who regularly renders his partners obsolete, found himself floundering for rhythm.

As the Sunrisers Hyderabad star dealt with his demons, Shreyas Iyer decided to turn aggressor, injecting life back into the packed stands here at Uppal until an athletic effort from Andrew brought an abrupt end.

Just when Abhishek began to find the fence, left-arm spinner Gudakesh Motie struck to remove him and Naman Dhir in consecutive balls. The ask: 116 runs from 48 balls.

Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar's 32-ball 72 stand lifted hopes high but Paul led the charge with a fifer to dampen any hopes of a win.

Arshdeep retiring hurt was merely the final twist of the knife, hastening a defeat that India tried, in vain, to avoid.

SCOREBOARD

WEST INDIES

Shai Hope (not out) 102 *(50b, 4x4, 9x6)*, Jewel Andrew lbw b Axar 21 *(16b, 2x4, 1x6)*, Shimron Hetmyer c & b Prince 33 *(12b, 4x4, 2x6)*, Rovman Powell c Samson b Arshdeep 24 *(17b, 2x4, 1x6)*, Sherfane Rutherford (not out) 49 *(26b, 4x4, 3x6)*; Extras (lb-4, nb-1, w-13): 18; Total (for three wkts. in 20 overs): 247.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-52 (Andrew, 4.2 overs), 2-110 (Hetmyer, 8.2), 3-156 (Powell, 12.5).

INDIA BOWLING

Mayank 4-0-52-0, Arshdeep 4-0-52-1, Prince 4-0-36-1, Axar 4-0-45-1, Dhir 1-0-19-0, Nitish 3-0-39-0

INDIA

Sanju Samson c Hetmyer b Paul 56 *(23b, 6x4, 4x6)*, Abhishek Sharma c Springer b Motie 29 *(24b, 3x4, 1x6)*, Ishan Kishan c Andrew b Paul 6 *(3b, 1x6)*, Shreyas Iyer c Andrew b Springer 16 *(11b, 2x4)*, Tilak Varma c Powell b Shepherd 43 *(25b, 2x4, 3x6)*, Naman Dhir st. Hope b Motie 0 *(1b)*, Nitish Kumar c Powell b Paul 41 *(20b, 1x4, 4x6)*, Axar Patel c Rutherford b Paul 3 *(5b)*, Prince Yadav b Paul 0 *(1b)*, Arshdeep Singh retd. hurt 5 *(4b, 1x4)*, Mayank Yadav (not out) 0 *(1b)*; Extras (b-4, lb-3, nb-1, w-16): 24; Total (in 19.3 overs): 223.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-60 (Samson, 4.1), 2-67 (Kishan, 4.4), 3-97 (Shreyas, 8.2), 4-130 (Abhishek, 11.3), 5-130 (Dhir, 11.4), 6-200 (Tilak, 16.6), 7-212 (Nitish, 18.2), 8-212 (Prince, 18.3), 9-213 (Axar, 18.5).

WEST INDIES BOWLING

Chase 4-0-43-0, Shamar 2.3-0-47-0, Shepherd 3-0-32-1, Paul 4-0-41-5, Springer 4-0-40-1, Motie 2-0-13-2.

Toss: India; **PoM:** Hope.

West Indies won by 24 runs to level series 2-2.

Fifth and final T20I: October 17, Bengaluru, 7 p.m.

Too hot to handle: Paul ran riot with the ball to seal the win and keep the series alive. NAGARA GOPAL

The bowlers are trying to catch up: Santner

S. Shrivathsan

It is not often that an exceptionally skilled cricketer like Mitchell Santner hopes and prays for a certain setting instead of banking on his box of tricks.

But such has been the ferocity of India's T20 batting that the New Zealand white-ball captain wished for surfaces with some assistance for the bowlers in the forthcoming five-match home series.

"We know how good India is. It has power all the way through, as we have seen against the West Indies with high scores and on flat pitches. Hopefully, the pitches are not too flat here because we know what India can do in small grounds," Santner said during a virtual interaction on Wednesday.

"But if that is the case, we have to find a way to neutralise a powerful attack. We have to turn up, see what is in front of us and adapt as quickly as we can." The left-arm tweaker, who is a master of subtle variations, spelt out possible tactics to keep the batters in check, but it is easier said than done.

"The only way to stop a team like India is by taking wickets throughout [the innings]. It will be good to take wickets in the Power-Play even if we go for a few runs. We need to combat the explosive nature of the batters with plans. In the middle overs, we must see if we can go for six singles [in an over] and apply pressure on them," Santner added.

Santner.
FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

The 34-year-old stressed that the bowlers were left helpless in the shortest format in this day and age. "The batters have adapted faster while the bowlers are trying to catch up. But with the boundary sizes and flat pitches, there is not much we can do."

Santner, however, is not one to shy away from a challenge.

(Watch India tour of New Zealand live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV starting October 22).

Lot of areas to improve in T20s, says Smriti

ZIM WOMEN IN INDIA

Press Trust of India
RAIPUR

Newly appointed India captain Smriti Mandhana on Wednesday said her team will look to make the most of the six T20Is ahead of the inaugural edition of the Women's Champions Trophy early next year.

Smriti is set to lead India in her first assignment as full-time captain when the hosts take on Zimbabwe in a three-match T20I series starting here on Friday, followed by three ODIs.

"The first bilateral (series) with Zimbabwe, I think, it is very exciting. It is our first time playing against them," said Smriti.

"Sometimes, playing with Zimbabwe and all the Associate nations, it feels like you can learn a lot from them as well because they enjoy playing their cricket."

Smriti said there were a lot of areas of improvement for the Indian team in the shortest format. "We have won the World Cup in the last one-and-a-half-years but there are a few things which we needed to work in the T20 format especially," she said.

"But I would say our strength has been the players who have come in. They've done extremely well."

New era: Smriti is excited about the first-ever series against Zimbabwe. X@BCCIWOMEN

Knights, Marathas continue to excel

APL

Sports Bureau
HYDERABAD

Kakatiya Knights and Mighty Marathas remained on top of the table with 10 points after registering wins over Rajputana Royals and Chola Chiefs in the Archery Premier League Season 2 at People's Plaza on Wednesday.

Yodhas in third spot

In the opening match of the day, Prithivraj Yodhas downed Chero Archers to move into third place with eight points.

Three sudden-death tie-breakers were needed to separate Yodhas and Archers when they met the previous time. In the reverse fixture, however, the former made light work of the latter. Yodhas were led by the 16-year-old recurve archer Gatha Anandrao Khadake, who shot 58 out of a possible 60, and Asian Games compound medallist Ganesh Thirumuru (59). While Yodhas arrested their own mini-slump, Archers slumped to their third straight defeat.

Pulling strings: Gatha was the architect of Yodhas' facile win.
ARCHERY PREMIER LEAGUE

In the day's final contest, Chiefs' woeful run of form continued as they stayed rooted to the bottom with just one win in seven matches, suffering a fifth successive loss.

Five straight wins

In contrast, Marathas, who had started the season with two reverses, have now won five on the bounce.

The scores:

Prithviraj Yodhas bt Chero Archers 5-1 (75-75, 77-75, 77-74).

Kakatiya Knights bt Rajputana Royals 6-2 (74-73, 79-78, 74-75, 76-74).

Mighty Marathas bt Chola Chiefs 6-0 (77-76, 75-72, 78-75).

Bouli's brace helps Punjab edge Odisha

ISL

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

Raphael Messi Bouli enjoyed a dream debut for Punjab FC in the Indian Super League on Wednesday, giving his new club a 2-1 win over Odisha FC at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

The 34-year-old, who was a free agent after playing for Jamshedpur last season, remarkably scored in the first and final minute of the game.

All of 39 seconds in, the host opened the scoring through the striker from Cameroon.

With Muhammad Uvais sending in a lovely cross from the left – the pass was perfectly weighted along the turf to carve open the Odisha defence – Bouli had to simply tap the ball into the back of the net.

Punjab had a few other half-chances in the opening exchanges, but Odisha found its footing thereafter. The visitor's equaliser came in the 15th minute. Having been awarded a corner, Lalthathanga Khawlhring exhibited his set-piece prowess by finding an unmarked Thoiba Singh Moirangthem. The 23-year-old from Manipur headed the ball powerfully past Punjab goalkeeper Arshdeep Singh.

Punjab gained the upper hand after the interval. In the 56th minute, Muhammad Suhail did extremely well to run into space on the left flank and cross with the outside of his right boot. The pass picked out Alfred Moya, but the Spaniard's first-time shot sailed well over the crossbar.

Just as the contest seemed set to end in a stalemate, Bouli pounced on a cross from substitute Bishu Sharma on the right wing to seal the deal in the dying seconds of stoppage time.

The result: Punjab FC 2 (Raphael Messi Bouli 1, 90+5) bt Odisha FC 1 (Thoiba Singh Moirangthem 15).

INBRIEF

Harsh packs off Lakshya; Monodip stuns Paranjay

Harsh Marwaha stunned second seed Lakshya Chukka 6-2, 6-4 in a third round boys' under-16 match of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship in New Delhi on Wednesday. Monodip Dey, the 12th seed, knocked out third-seeded Paranjay Siwach 6-4, 6-4.

Other results (third round): Under-16: Boys: Ribhav Saroha bt Gyansh Manchanda 6-2, 6-4; Yaj Malik bt Kaustubh Singh 6-4, 6-1; Kushagra Arora bt Jeevith Sathish 6-2, 6-0; Vivaan Mirdha bt V. Gunampally 6-3, 6-1.
Girls: Pooja Nagaraj bt T. Sathesh 7-5, 6-1; Aaradhya Meena bt I. Kannan 6-0, 6-2; Akshita Antil bt Vrandika Rajput 7-5, 5-7, 6-1; Ranjhana Sangram bt A. Brahadeeswaran 6-0, 6-1.
Under-14: Boys: Aarav Chhallani bt Jegan Senthil 6-1, 6-2; Puneeth Manohar bt Devansh Kamboj 6-3, 6-3; Nibras Hussain bt Manav Patel 6-3, 6-3; Sparsh Patil bt Aditya Kamat 6-4, 6-1.
Girls: Rishita Yadav bt Sarena Gahlot 6-4, 7-6(3); Sidhhi Pandey bt Tanya Bhatnagar 6-1, 6-1; Zoha Qureshi bt Aaral Vashishta 6-1, 6-1; Aaradhana Tehlan bt P. Vattaprambil 7-5, 6-2.

Sindhu, Lakshya exit in first round; Srikanth, Tanvi win

P.V. Sindhu and Lakshya Sen made early exits while K. Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma advanced to the second round of the Denmark Open badminton in Odense on Tuesday.

The results (first round): Women: Yvonne Li bt P.V. Sindhu 13-21, 25-23, 21-19; Tanvi Sharma bt Natsuki Nidaira 21-17, 16-21, 21-19; Han Qianxi bt Unnati Hooda 23-21, 16-21, 21-16.
Men: Chou Tien Chen bt Lakshya Sen 21-18, 13-21, 21-15; K. Srikanth bt Arnaud Merkle 22-20, 21-19; Alwi Farhan bt Ayush Shetty 21-11, 13-21, 21-10.
Doubles: He Jiting & Ren Xiangyu bt Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty 12-21, 21-15, 21-19.

Ankur, Diya reign supreme in National ranking table tennis

Ankur Bhattacharjee and Diya Chitale lifted the men's and women's titles of the National ranking table tennis tournament, which concluded in Panchkula, Haryana.

The results: Men: Final: Ankur Bhattacharjee (Har) bt Raegan Albuquerque (Mah) 11-8, 3-11, 6-11, 11-8, 11-9, 6-11, 11-5. **Semifinals:** Ankur bt Jeet Chandra (RSPB) 13-11, 8-11, 11-7, 12-10, 11-6; Raegan bt Manav Thakkar (PSPB) 5-11, 11-5, 11-9, 8-11, 12-10, 11-8. **Women: Final:** Diya Chitale (RBI) bt Syndrela Das (WB) 11-6, 11-8, 11-7, 6-11, 9-11, 8-11, 11-9. **Semifinals:** Syndrela bt Sutirtha Mukherjee (RSPB) 9-11, 7-11, 11-4, 11-4, 12-10, 9-11, 11-6; Diya bt Swastika Ghosh (PSPB) 11-4, 8-11, 11-6, 11-9, 11-9.

BCCI steps in to halt forfeitures by Arunachal

The BCCI has stepped in to prevent Arunachal Pradesh from forfeiting further matches this season by organising selection trials for the State's men's and women's teams across age groups and at the senior level. BCCI Apex Council member M. Khairul Jamal Majumdar will convene the selection process, which will be overseen by an independent panel.

LIVE TELECAST

Golf: India Championships, day 1, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 11.30 a.m.
Archery Premier League: Sony LIV app, 7.30 p.m.

Bengal coasts past Delhi by nine wickets

Set 89 to win in the last session, the host coasts past the tally thanks to Abhimanyu Easwaran and Ankur Paul's stand; its spinners earlier combine to pick up seven wickets

RANJI TROPHY

Y.B. Sarangi
KALYANI

Bengal relied on its spinners' combined yield of seven wickets and its openers' brisk chase to record a hard-earned nine-wicket win over Delhi and grab six points in its Ranji Trophy opener at the Bengal Cricket Academy ground here on Wednesday.

Re-starting its second innings at 101 for three, Delhi rode on skipper Ayush Badoni's brilliant 85 (134b, 10x4) to post 277 and set Bengal 89 to win in the last session. The home team crossed the line in 15.3 overs.

Following his five-wicket haul, Badoni led Delhi's fight with his bat. He and his overnight left-handed partner Anuj Rawat (39, 76b, 7x4) drove and swept well to consolidate with a vital 95-run partnership on a slow pitch.

Off-spinner Aamir Gani used the rough to provide the breakthrough as Rawat was bowled around his legs while trying a reverse sweep.

Retired hurt overnight, Yash Dhull added 45 with Badoni as Delhi erased the deficit.

Part-timer Sumanta Gupta's off-break ball jumped to hit Dhull's pad and brushed his gloves on its way to first slip at the stroke of lunch.

Ecstatic: Bengal's Sumanta celebrates after taking the wicket of Delhi's Dhull. CAB MEDIA

Delhi lost three quick wickets after the break. Badoni's dismissal, with left-arm spinner Pradipta Pramanik finding his outside edge from over the wicket, followed by the fall of Dev Lakra and Hrithik Shokeen to Gani and Pramanik respectively, gave the host hope.

The visitor's tail-enders frustrated Bengal for 20 overs before the inevitable.

Bengal openers Abhimanyu Easwaran (34 n.o., 40b, 2x4) and Ankur Paul (38, 41b, 3x4) then collected 64 runs at a healthy rate. While the captain rotated the strike, the diminutive debutant executed big hits, including a stunning straight six off Divij Mehra, to deflate the pressure. When Paul holed out, the task was a mere formality for Bengal.

"Gupta has a different trajectory. I introduced him to exploit the rough," said Abhimanyu, while praising Paul's innings.

The scores: Delhi — 1st innings: 240.
Bengal — 1st innings: 429.
Delhi — 2nd innings: Sarthak Ranjan b Akash 3, Sanat Sangwan b Pramanik 25, Yash Dhull c Abhimanyu b Sumanta 22, Ayush Doseja c sub b Mukesh 19, Ayush Badoni c Abhimanyu b Pramanik 85, Anuj Rawat b Gani 39, Dev Lakra st Porel b Gani 13, Hrithik Shokeen b Pramanik 8, Divij Mehra c Porel b Shami 21, Navdeep Saini (not out) 20, Simarjeet Singh b Sumanta 11; Extras (b-6, lb-3, w-1, nb-1): 11; Total (in 106.2 overs): 277.
Fall of wickets: 1-15, 2-51, 3-59, 4-154, 5-199, 6-213, 7-225, 8-225, 9-256.
Bengal bowling: Shami 18-7-29-1, Akash 16-5-29-1, Mukesh 12-4-34-1, Gani 24-4-84-2, Pramanik 33-11-72-3, Sumanta 3.2-0-20-2.
Bengal — 2nd innings: Abhimanyu Easwaran (not out) 34, Ankur Paul c Lakra b Shokeen 38, Sudip Gharami (not out) 16: Extras (w-1): 1; Total (for one wkt. in 15.3 overs): 89.
Fall of wicket: 1-64.
Delhi bowling: Badoni 2-0-11-0, Mehra 4-0-18-0, Shokeen 4-0-27-1, Simarjeet 2-0-18-0, Saini 3-0-13-0, Ranjan 0.3-0-2-0.

RANJI TROPHY SCORES — ROUND ONE, FOURTH & FINAL DAY

Productive spell: Andhra's Lalith scalped five in Karnataka's second innings. K.V.S. GIRI

Elite: Group A: At Panaji: Baroda 472/8 decl. bt Goa 199 & 138 in 68 overs (Shivendra Bhujbal 46, Abhinav Tejrana 47, Mahesh Pithiya 4/66, Bhargav Bhatt 5/32). **Points: Goa 0(0), Baroda 7(7).**
At Srinagar: Madhya Pradesh 196 & 249/6 decl. in 80 overs (Shubham Sharma 106 n.o.) drew with Jammu & Kashmir 120 & 88/7 in 34 overs. **J&K 1(1), MP 3(3).**
At Nagpur: Vidarbha 428 & 175/3 decl. in 36 overs (Aman Mokhade 65, Dhruv Shorey 69 n.o.) bt Pondicherry 313 & 130 in 41.1 overs (Prasad Pawar 48, Harsh Dubey 4/29). **Vidarbha 6(6), Pondicherry 0(0).**
Group B: At Vijayawada: Karnataka 274 & 337/9 decl. in 103 overs (Manvanth Kumar 44, Karun Nair 155 n.o., Lalith Mohan 5/117) drew with Andhra 418 & 104/4 in 44 overs. **Andhra 3(3), Karnataka 1(1).**
At New Chandigarh: Assam 373 & 157/6 in 61 overs (Denish Das 45) drew with Punjab 478/6 decl. in 127 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 103, Harnoor Singh 54, Salil Arora 110, Emanjot Singh Chahal 114 n.o.). **Punjab 3(3), Assam 1(1).**
At Rajkot: Saurashtra 392 & 229/1 in 67 overs (Harvik Desai 68, Chirag Jani 127 n.o.) drew with Chhattisgarh 312. **Saurashtra 3(3), Chhattisgarh 1(1).**
Group C: At Jamshedpur: Jharkhand 587 drew with Kerala 395 in 127.5 overs (Abhishek P. Nair 126, Rohan Kunnummal 44, Salman Nizar 43, Aditya Sarvate 95, Manishi Singh 4/92, Utkarsh Singh 4/69) & 62/2 in 19.3 overs. **Jharkhand 3(3), Kerala 1(1).**
At Kalyani: Delhi 240 & 277 in 106.2 overs (Ayush Badoni 85) lost to Bengal 429 & 89/1 in 15.3 overs. **Bengal 6(6), Delhi 0(0).**
At Ahmedabad: Odisha 324 & 161 in 46.1 overs (Sandeep Pattnaik 65, Ninad Rathva 53, Siddharth Desai 5/36) lost to Gujarat 439 & 47/0 in 9.3 overs. **Gujarat 7(7), Odisha 0(0).**
At New Delhi: Maharashtra 333 & 141 in 56 overs (Ankit Bawne 48, Rajvardhan Hangargekar 43, Arjun Sharma 5/58) bt Services 227 & 120 in 63.3 overs (Vicky Ostwal 5/50). **Maharashtra 6(6), Services 0(0).**
Group D: At Lahli: Himachal Pradesh 253 & 113 lost to Haryana 296 & 74/3 in 18.1 overs. **Haryana 6(6), HP 0(0).**
At Mumbai (Brabourne Stadium): Railways 278 & 272/4 in 86 overs (Suraj Ahuja 53, Vivek Singh 58, Eshaan Goyal 53, Bhargav Merai 51) drew with Uttarakhand 470. **Railways 1(1), Uttarakhand 3(3).**
At Jaipur: Rajasthan 363 & 192/6 decl. in 70.1 overs (Mahipal Lomror 84, Kartik Sharma 42) drew with Tamil Nadu 274 & 73/0 in 23 overs (N. Jagadeesan 42 n.o.). **Rajasthan 3(3), TN 1(1).**
Plate: At Rangpo: Sikkim 245 & 291/7 in 96.1 overs (Parth Palawat 66, Gurinder Singh 100 n.o.) drew with Meghalaya 395. **Sikkim 1(1), Meghalaya 3(3).**
At Nadiad: Mizoram 183 & 295 lost to Manipur 251 & 228/7 in 71.2 overs (Johnson Singh 51, Jotin Pheiroijam 105 n.o.). **Mizoram 0(0), Manipur 6(6).**

Sai Sudharsan gathering info before the tour down under

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
JAIPUR

Sai Sudharsan said on Wednesday that the National selectors had asked him to play in the Ranji Trophy as part of his preparation for India's upcoming tour of New Zealand.

Having been on India-A duty in Puducherry, he arrived here "at 10.40 p.m." on the eve of Tamil Nadu's Ranji Trophy opener against Rajasthan (October 10).

"There was a day's break between games in Puducherry. On that day (October 10), our manager told me that the selectors had asked me to play the Ranji Trophy.

"After the first day's play here, I spoke with Pragyan Ojha (interim chief National selector). He said it would be good for the upcoming New Zealand series – for preparation and all. That was the clarity from their side."

Sai Sudharsan.
S. PRASANNA VENKATESAN

He has been "watching a lot of old videos" of India's Tests in New Zealand to understand the conditions and how best to bat there.

"I have gathered a little information. It will be a bit windy, and there will be good bounce. It will be almost similar to England, but there will be a bit more lateral movement.

Grabbing knowledge

"Sachin *paaji* has scored there, so I watched his batting. I watched Dravid sir's batting. I try to grab knowledge from that and execute whatever is possible for me," he said.

On missing the Test series in Sri Lanka because of a toe stress fracture, the 24-year-old said: "I wasn't disappointed because I believe everything good is ahead of us. The last few injuries have been freakish, but because of them, I've probably gotten better with my habits and have a better understanding of how to take care of my body... how much I bat and things like that".

Assam weathers Punjab's push for an outright win

Abhishek Saini
NEW CHANDIGARH

Punjab went all in for an outright win but had to settle for three points on the final day of its Ranji Trophy round-one match against Assam at the New PCA Stadium here on Wednesday.

Overnight batters Emanjot Singh Chahal (114 n.o., 137b, 10x4, 4x6) and Salil Arora (110, 152b, 10x4, 3x6) needed less than a session to restore parity and take a first-innings lead.

The charge was in full throttle from the fourth over of the day, when Salil hopped out to Mohit Thakur and drilled him through covers. Salil reserved his best for pacer Dipjyoti Saikia, creaming two drives through covers and mid-off.

Mohit was targeted again by the pair. Salil lofted him inside-out for a boundary and with a late-cut Emanjot got Punjab level with Assam at 373 runs.

Their onslaught on the cusp of lunch ensured Punjab's haul from the first session had ballooned to 191 runs. With a lead worth 105 runs, Punjab inserted Assam for a second innings and got a late whiff of a win.

Assam could save its solitary point courtesy of Amlanjyoti Das, who stood in support of Sarupam Purkayashta (18 n.o., 68b, 3x4) for the final 30 minutes and dashed Punjab's hopes.

The scores: Assam — 1st innings: 373.
Punjab — 1st innings: Vihaan Malhotra lbw b Mukhtar 103, Harnoor Pannu c Ghadigaonkar b Purkayastha 54, Uday Saharan lbw b Purkayastha 30, Jashanpreet Sidhu lbw b Amlanjyoti 22, Ramandeep Singh run out 17, Salil Arora c Deka b Mukhtar 110, Emanjot Chahal (not out) 114, Harjas Tandon (not out) 12; Extras (b-1, lb-7, w-1, nb-7): 16; Total (decl. for six wkts. in 127 overs): 478.

Fall of wickets: 1-137, 2-195, 3-195, 4-226, 5-237, 6-437.

Assam bowling: Mukhtar 34-7-128-2, Dipjyoti 15-2-93-0, Amlanjyoti 29-2-77-1, Purkayastha 20-3-64-2, Mohit 29-2-108-0.

Assam — 2nd innings: Nibir Deka c Harnoor b Umesh 5, Rishav Das b Harpreet 22, Rajveer Singh b Umesh 0, Denish Das c Salil b Harjas 45, Sibsankar Roy c Salil b Harpreet 32, Sumit Ghadigaonkar lbw b Gurnoor 13, Sarupam Purkayastha (not out) 18, Mukhtar Hussain (retd hurt) 4, Amlanjyoti Das (not out) 15; Extras (lb-2, nb-1): 3; Total (for six wkts in 61 overs): 157

Fall of wickets: 1-7, 2-16, 3-36, 4-93, 5-106, 6-132.

Punjab bowling: Gurnoor 11-0-38-1, Umesh 9-3-11-2, Harpreet 17-7-44-2, Emanjot 12-3-25-0, Harjas 10-0-34-1, Uday 1-0-1-0, Vihaan 1-0-2-0.

BFI's internal battle intensifies

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

In a retaliatory move, Boxing Federation of India (BFI) president Ajay Singh has suspended secretary general Pramod Kumar, who earlier moved a no-confidence motion against the federation chief, on various grounds.

In a letter issued on Tuesday, Ajay said several enquiries are pending against Pramod, who was earlier served a show-cause notice, "with respect to various acts and financial decisions taken by him."

In response, Pramod suspended Ajay on Wednesday.

India's skill and Australia's expertise — charting a joint gameplan

Lavanya L
CHENNAI

At Khel Connect, a symposium organised by the Australia India Institute (AII) and funded by the Australian Government Department of Education, educators, sporting administrators and industry leaders from both countries met over two days this week to discuss closer collaboration in high performance, community engagement and commercial expertise.

"This symposium is really about bringing two forces together by pairing Australia's deep expertise with India's scale, ambition and talent," AII CEO Lisa Singh said.

"There is growth in sports consumption tech as well. India can greatly contribute there," Anupam Goswami, league commissioner of Pro Kabaddi League, added.

Rob Aughey, Head of Discipline, Exercise and Sports Science at Federation University, called for short, targeted 'coach the coach' programmes.

"Three-year courses are impractical because rapid advances – especially in sports technology – make the training obsolete by the time participants finish," Aughey, whose research collaborators include FIFA, said.

Olympian Hakimuddin Habibulla, who swam for India at the 2000 Sydney Games, highlighted a major gap in coaching fundamentals.

"Coaches assume players already know the basics, and high stakes leave little room to teach foundational re-learning –breaking the transition from grass-roots to elite levels," he added.

Enriching experience: The participants and panellists at the symposium held at IIT Madras.

Aadhithya Chakravarthy, Head of Performance at FC Madras, shed light on decision errors in a data-driven world.

"Academies often evaluate players based on current ability rather than long-term potential, frequently discarding late bloomers for early maturers. Long-term patience is crucial," he explained.

"High-performance systems don't humanise athletes, making community sport its necessary counterpart. Consequently, our focus is making sports permissionless," Nandan Kamath, managing trustee of GoSports Foundation, advocated.

Rekha Dey, Partner at Tanjun Associate LLP, called for greater livelihood options to make sports viable to pursue at a community level, something Arun Vasu, president of the Indian and Asian Surfing Federation, corroborated.

Prof. Mahesh V Panchagnula, founder and head of the IIT Madras Center of Excellence on Sports Science and Analytics, placed the onus on schools to make sports a graded subject to help foster a more holistic culture that could turn profitable.

Meanwhile, Vik Singh, Trade and Investment Commissioner for Austrade in South Asia, said exchange relationships between the two countries need to move on from being one-sided.

With India hosting the 2030 Commonwealth Games and bidding for the 2036 Summer Games, major event capability and innovation took centre stage.

Dr. Sheila Nguyen, former Head of Sustainability for the 2023 FIFA Women's World Cup, cautioned against drawing on community resources without a plan to leave a legacy.

"We are distracted by ticket sales, broadcast numbers, and money spent. We need to broaden our perspective on hosting big events.

"They are more than nation-building exercises; they are also community-building exercises.

"If infrastructure improves, it can improve all the services around that facility and force people to upgrade, but it needs to be done with intention," she said.

Hat-trick hero: Tresoldi scores from the spot for Brugge's first against Inter. AFP

Arsenal, Barcelona cruise; Atletico stumps United

The Premier League champion blanks Lille while the LaLiga victor beats Galatasaray; minnows Vikings hold Bayern in a six-goal thriller; Club Brugge claims a superb away win against Inter

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Atletico Madrid beat Manchester United 2-0 in the UEFA Champions League on Tuesday, while Bayern Munich was held 3-3 in Norway by underdogs Viking Stavanger.

Elsewhere, last season's beaten finalist Arsenal eased to victory over Lille while Barcelona came from behind to beat Galatasaray but Inter Milan lost a seven-goal thriller at home to Club Brugge.

Atletico took the lead inside the opening minute through Pablo Barrios. Ademola Lookman got Atletico's second in the 79th minute, just after United defender Leny Yoro was sent off.

Viking appeared to be heading for a famous win over Bayern when it led 2-0 at half-time in Stavanger before a Harry Kane double pulled the Bavarians level.

Luis Diaz then converted as the match turned completely on its head, but Bayern's Michael Olise was sent off for two yellows within seconds allowing Viking to snatch a memorable draw with Herman Haugen headed strike.

Arsenal was too strong for Lille as it won 3-0 with goals by Jurrien Timber, Eberechi Eze and Bukayo Saka, in the space of eight second-half minutes.

Barcelona, one of the favourites to win the competition, maintained its 100 per cent record this season with a 4-1 win over Galatasaray away.

Club Brugge claimed a remarkable 4-3 win away to Inter at San Siro.

In other games, Villarreal came from behind to beat Napoli 3-1 while RB Leipzig beat PSV Eindhoven 1-0. Sporting of Portugal won 2-0 away to Lens, and it was a night to remember for Sabah as it downed Slavia Prague.

The results: Lens 0 lost to Sporting 2 (Suarez 22, Doumbia 74); Sabah 2 (Parris 49, Mickels 88) bt Slavia Prague 0.

Arsenal 3 (Timber 64, Eze 67, Saka 71) bt Lille 0; Atletico Madrid 2 (Barrios 1, Lookman 79) bt Manchester United 0.

Galatasaray 1 (Batrakov 28) lost to Barcelona 4 (Cancelo 43, Lopez 50, Gordon 53, Adeyemi 65); Inter Milan 3 (Martínez 44, 81, Bonny 90+3) lost to Club Brugge 4 (Tresoldi 30-pen, 63, 74, Vermant 87).

RB Leipzig 1 (Gruda 75) bt PSV Eindhoven 0; Viking 3 (Stensness 2, Christiansen 38, Haugen 90) drew with Bayern Munich 3 (Kane 54-pen, 60, Díaz 71); Villarreal 3 (Mikautadze 23, Mourino 26, Oluwaseyi 86) bt Napoli 1 (Rrahmani 8).

How Jyothi turned her disappointment into a gold for India

ARCHERY

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Seasoned compound archer Jyothi Surekha on Wednesday said her early exit from the individual event at the Asian Games was "very unexpected", admitting she had little chance after a weak start against 14-year-old Kang Yeonseo.

Jyothi, who had entered the Aichi-Nagoya Games as the defending champion after winning the women's individual compound gold at the 2023 Hangzhou edition, was stunned by the young Korean archer, who shot a perfect score of 150 in the pre-quarterfinals.

"I tried from my side in the individual event but the thing is the opponent shot so well 150/150 so I had no chance because I started a bit weak in the first round. I tried whatever I could, I did. It was very unexpected," Jyothi said in an online interaction.

The 30-year-old, however, put the disappointment behind her quickly and helped India win the women's team gold.

"But I thought I still have the team event and I will give my hundred percent in that," she said.

India enjoyed an impressive archery campaign at the Games, topping the medal standings with nine medals, including five gold, two silver and two bronze.

While compound archery continued to be a major source of medals for India, the recurve archers also made a significant contribution, including winning the country's first-ever individual recurve gold.

Bouncing back: Jyothi showed tremendous mental fortitude to win the Asian Games team gold. REUTERS

> Overall the campaign was good. India repeated the same performance from last time which was three years ago. To be able to match that same performance is a good thing
> JYOTHI

"Overall the campaign was good. India repeated the same performance from last time which was three years ago. To be able to match that same performance is a good thing," Jyothi said.

"The recurve team did very well, individual also Kumkum (Mohod) won gold for the first time so it was a great campaign," she added. Neeraj Chauhan defeated top seed compatriot Dhiraj Bommadevara to claim the men's individual recurve bronze.

Neeraj said he focused on his shooting rather than on his opponent during the medal contest.

"I didn't think what will happen. I focused on my shooting. In the first round I had double 10 so I thought if I can continue to do this, I can (win). I didn't think who my opponent was, I just kept shooting," he said.

Neeraj also spoke about the advice he received from Dhiraj.

"Dhiraj bhaiya always says just enjoy the situation and the moment. Because what is there today won't be there tomorrow and vice versa," he said.

NTPC has been supporting archery through the Archery Association of India since 2018.

WA president Coe upbeat about 2029 Worlds

Agence France-Presse
NAIROBI

Kenya hosting the 2029 World championships will help combat the endemic doping problem among its athletes, World Athletics president Sebastian Coe said on a visit here on Wednesday.

The east African nation is a global athletics powerhouse, particularly in long-distance and middle-distance running, but has seen a surge in doping cases in recent years.

Around 140 Kenyan athletes have been suspended, including a positive test announced as recently as Tuesday by monitoring body Athletics Integrity Unit.

"The championships will help us in that quest" for a cleaner Kenyan athletics scene, Coe told on the sidelines of a press conference. Is there more work to be done? Yes. Will these championships lend more focus to that? Absolutely," he said.

The AIU is "very clear in their reports to me that progress is being made" in Kenya, he said, adding the country had come a "long way".

Kenya has won the right to host the World Championships in Africa for the first time. At last year's edition in Tokyo, Kenya finished second overall behind the United States, taking home 11 medals.

Coe said that having spoken with Kenya's previous and current leader, integrity in Kenyan athletics is seen as a "key national imperative".

Kusal Mendis finds form, helps Lanka avoid a whitewash

Associated Press
RAWALPINDI

Kusal Mendis bounced back from two sub-par performances to hit an unbeaten half-century and Sri Lanka denied Pakistan a clean sweep in their T20 series with an eight-wicket win in Rawalpindi on Tuesday. The captain, who made one and nine in the previous two defeats, scored 87 not out off 48 balls and carried Sri Lanka to 172 for two in 17.1 overs as the visitors showed improvement in all the three facets of the game.

Pakistan skipper Sahibzada Farhan had earlier scored 76 off 47 balls to take the home team to 168 for eight after Kusal won his third straight toss.

Pakistan won the first game by four wickets and then inflicted a crushing 82-run defeat in the second game by scoring its second highest T20 score of 215.

The scores: Pakistan 168/8 in 20 overs (Farhan 78, Nuwan Tushara 2/38, Dasun Shanaka 3/21) lost to Sri Lanka 172/2 in 17.1 overs (Sineth Jayawardene 38, Kusal Mendis 87 n.o., Kamindu Mendis 40 n.o.).

Toss: Sri Lanka.

PoM: Kusal Mendis.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
MARINE DEPARTMENT
No.MD/ACCTS/WK/R-12/2026/1217, Date : 25/09/2026
Name of the Work: Hiring of 3rd Battery Operated Electric Tug of 60T Bollard Pull (Green Tug Transition Programme) including Manning, Operation, and Maintenance for a Period of 15 years at Paradip Port Authority & Extendable by 02 more years. **(This 3rd tug under GTTP is in addition to the 1st GTTP tug & the 2nd GTTP tug. The 1st GTTP tug vide e-RFP No. MD/ACCTS/WK/R-20/2025/506, dt.15/04/2025 as amended vide e-RFP No. MD/ACCTS/WK/R-20/2025/828, dt.26/06/2025 is subject to the outcome of WP(C).33656/2025 & WP(C).33659/2025 and same is not being proceeded with in view of interim orders passed by Hon'ble High Court of Orissa).**
Estimated cost put to tender for hire charges of one year only: **Rs.20,02,02,500/- excluding GST.** Last date & time of submission of tender through on-line bidding is **17:00 Hours on dt.10/11/2026.** Date & time for opening of Technical Bid is **10:30 hours on dt.11/11/2026.** For further details, please log on to the Website: **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.**
Deputy Conservator, PPA
PPA/PR/32/2026-2027, dt.13/10/2026

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
Office of the Chief Engineer **T ENDER NOTICE**
ADV No.40/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.99 to 100 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026 -27 dt: 13- 10-2026
NAME OF WORK:(1) Facility Management Services for housekeeping, sanitation and maintenance of Sripatham Block at Tirupati for the years 2026-29 (3 years), **Open Tender Type, Time for completion 36 months (2)** Facility Management Services for housekeeping, sanitation and maintenance of Achyutham Block at Tirupati for the years 2026-29 (3 years), **Open Tender Type, Time for completion 36 months.**
NOTE: For full details, log on to the Website https://www.tirumala.org.
TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.220) Date:14-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
Office of the Chief Engineer **TENDER NOTICE**
ADV No.39/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.101 /SE-I& NIT No.82/SE-III/TTD/ 2026-27 dt:13-10-2026
Name of work:(1) Construction of additional floor to the existing building (i.e. 3rd floor) North and East side wing at SV High School, TTD, Tirupati, Amount Rs.547.60 Lakhs, Time for completion 18 months **(2)** Operation and maintenance of Dairy/ Ghee plant at S.V. Gosamrakshana, Shala, T.T.D., Tirupati to process raw milk in to various milk products for 5 years. (6th call). Open Tender Type, Time for completion 60 months.
Note: For full details, log on to the Website https://www.tirumala.org.
TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv,No,218) Date:14-10-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

bida **भिवाड़ी इंटिग्रेटेड विकास प्राधिकरण**
एच-5, मगनलाल कॉलोनी, भिवाड़ी, अलवर, दूरभाष :- 01493-230819
ई-मेल :- bida.bhiwadi@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक :- बीड़ा/अभि./3225/26 दिनांक :- 09/10/2026
Notice Inviting Bid
Bid for "Integrated development of 45mtr wide master plan road with service road, green belt, footpath, drain and parking near saidpur bhiwadi.", is invited from interested Bidders up to 02.00 PM date 30.10.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & http://sppp.raj.nic.in** of the state; and **https://bida.rajasthan.gov.in** departmental website. **UBN : BDA2627WLOB00066**
राज.संवाद/सी/26/11879 **अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, बीडा, भिवाडी**

कार्यालय नगर परिषद, फलोदी जिला–फलौदी (राज0)
क्रमांक / न0प0फ0 / 2026–27 / 6032 दिनांक :–10.10.2026
–: ई–निविदा सूचना :–
नगर परिषद फलोदी द्वारा परिषद क्षेत्र में 1 कार्य हेतु सक्षम एवं राजकीय विभागों में नियमानुसार उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में दिनांक 02.11.2026 को 12:00 PM बजे तक ई–प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया से वेबसाईट **https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** पर ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है, निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी व वेब साईट **https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in,** व **https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in** पर देखी व डाउनलोड की जा सकती है ।
Tender ID :- 2026_DLB_603754_1
UBN No. :- DLB2627SLOB21873
राज.संवाद / सी / 26 / 11819 आयुक्त
नगर परिषद,फलोदी

CPCL
Chennai Petroleum Corporation Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise & a group Company of IndianOil)
[CIN – L40101TN1965GOI005389]
Regd. Office: No.536, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai – 600 018
NOTICE
Shri Karthikeyan.N, PR No.803407 SEA-VIII-P&U II&III, CPCL who has remained unauthorisedly absent from duty since 24.05.2026 is hereby informed that disciplinary proceedings are pending against him. He is directed to **report for duty and appear before the Inquiring Authority on 22.10.2026 at 09.00 hrs. at CPCL Refinery, Manali,** in connection with the disciplinary inquiry. If he fails to report for duty, submit a written defence, or appear before the Inquiring Authority on the said date, the disciplinary inquiry will be conducted and concluded ex-parte in accordance with the applicable rules. This is the final opportunity to participate in the proceedings.
A.S. Rajkumar
Chief General Manager (Technical)
Disciplinary Authority
Date: 15.10.2026
Place: Chennai

TAMIL NADU CO-OPERATIVE SUGAR FEDERATION LTD.,
'AAVIN' ILLAM, 1st FLOOR, 3-A, PASUMPON MUTHURAMALINGANAR SALAI, NANDANAM, CHENNAI - 600 035. Phone: 044-24330083, 24344177
E-mail: tamilnaducoopsugarfederation@gmail.com
G.S.T.No.33AABAT0660R1Z8
E-Procurement Tender Notice
The following materials are required for fixing Rate Contract basis for 2026-27 season to all Cooperative and Public Sector Sugar Mills in Tamil Nadu.
Online bids are invited for
(1) **50 Kg Brown colour Polypropylene(PP) bags with inner liner**
(2) **50 Kg 'A' Type Sugar Gunny bags with inner liner**
(3) **Burnt Lime Powder**
(4) **Heavy Chemicals**
(5) **Co-gen Plant Chemicals**
For all other details including detailed NIT (Notice Inviting Tender) visit the E-tender portal website **https://tntenders.gov.in.**
The opening of the Part-I will be held on **29.10.2026 at 11.30 AM** onwards.
Place : Chennai 600 035
Date : 14 .10.2026 DIPR/3141/TENDER/2026 **Administrator**

सेन्ट्रल माईन प्लानिंग एण्ड डिजाईन इन्स्टीट्यूट लिमिटेड
CENTRAL MINE PLANNING & DESIGN INSTITUTE LIMITED
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Ltd.)
Gondwana Place, Kanke Road, Ranchi-834008, Jharkhand, India
NOTICE
"All the tenders issued by CIL and its Subsidiaries for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on websites of Coal India Ltd**. www.coalindia.in/** respective Subsidiary Company (CMPDI, **www.cmpdi.co.in**), CIL e-procurement portal **https://coalindiatenders.nic.in** and Central Public Procurement Portal **https://eprocure.gov.in.** In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal **https://gem.gov.in."**

VISAKHAPATNAM PORT AUTHORITY
VISAKHAPATNAM
E-Tender Call Notice: 2026_VPT_291637_1, Dt. 22.09.2026.
On behalf of the Members of Board of VPA, E-Tender is invited in Single Stage two steps system from the experienced bidders meeting the pre-qualifying criteria for the work mentioned below through online bidding on the Website http://www.etenders.gov.in
SUB: UP GRADATION OF THE EXISTING 80 BEDDED GOLDEN JUBILEE HOSPITAL TO A 300 BEDDED MULTI-DISCIPLINARY SUPER SPECIALITY HOSPITAL AT VISAKHAPATNAM PORT ON DESIGN, BUILT, FINANCE, OPERATE AND TRANSFER (DBFOT) BASIS" – **Last Date for bid submission: 05.11.2026.**
SECRETARY

MALKAJGIRI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PROJECTS, MMC, HYDERABAD.
Tender Notice No.12/SE (Projects)/MMC/2026-27 (Re-Call), **Dt:14.10.2026.**
NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

Item No.	Name of Work
1.	"Project management Consultancy Services for Proof checking, construction supervision, Quality Assurance, Quality Control & Quality Audit for the work of "Construction of RK Puram ROB Deposit work" under Engineering Procurement Construction(EPC)/Turnkey Basis"

Events	Date & Timings
Start Date	15.10.2026 03.00 PM
Pre-Bid Meeting	23.10.2026 at 03.00 PM Location: O/o Chief Engineer (Projects), MMC 1st Floor, Head Office, Tarnaka, Hyderabad.
Last Date & Time for receipt of Bids	26.10.2026 @ 03.00 PM
Technical Bid Opening	26.10.2026 After 03.30 PM
Price Bid Opening	27.10.2026 @ 04.00 PM

Address of the officer concerned **Smt. K.Rohini, SE (Projects), 9959442013.** Superintending Engineer (Projects), Malkajgiri Municipal Corporation, 1st Floor, HMDA Complex, Tarnaka, Hyderabad. Further details can be seen at 'e' Procurement **https://tender.telangana.gov.in.**
Sd/- Superintending Engineer(I/C) (Projects), MMC.
DIPR R.O.No.11945-PP/CL/ADVT/2026-27 Dt. 14.10.2026

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MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.
NOTICE INVITING TENDER CPD/58
Corrigendum-I -2026-27
Tenders are invited through e-Tendering in SRM Two Bid system from the registered vendors for Supply of following:

Tender No. & Description of Material	Estimated Amount (in Rs. Lakhs) / Tender Fee (in Rs.) Excluding GST	Due Date & Time (Hrs.) for Submission & Opening of Tender
SP/T-0512/1026 RFx 5000001610 (1st Call) for Procurement of 220kV (14 No.), 132kV (10 No.) and 100kV (02) Voltage Class Power Transformers/ICT (Total 26 No.) along with New Uninhibited High Grade Mineral Insulating Oil for Enhancement of Transformation Capacity under Amravati; Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar; Karad; Nashik, Pune & Vashi Zones of MSETCL.	23277.59 25,000.00	02.11.2026 Upto 17.00 Hrs 02.11.2026 17.15 Hrs
CORRIGENDUM NO.1 Dt.12.10.2026	Corrigendum due to change in Quantity in the Tender published on SRM Portal viz. **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/** and MSETCL website viz**. www.mahatransco.in.**	

Contact Person: Office of the Executive Engineer (Gr-V), CPA, C.O. MSETCL, 1st Floor, Prakashgad Building, Bandra (E), Mumbai. **Tel. No.:** 022-69852717/2740 **Email id:** cecpa@mahatransco.in, secpa@mahatransco.in, eegrp5@mahatransco.in, eepc@mahatransco.in. For further details visit our website **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/.** Any further amendments/clarifications will be published on the MSETCL website **www.mahatransco.in** & **https://srmetender.mahatransco.in/**. Bidders are therefore requested to check these websites for further updates.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (P&C)

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NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
CPC-66/2026-27	Engineering, Supply, Installation and Testing & Commissioning works for Construction of 220kV DC Transmission line from Existing 220/132/33kV GSS, Balasore to Proposed 400/220kV GSS at Baisinga (220kV UG cable protion only) on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:00 PM.**	**Rs. 90,00,43,027/-**
CPC-73/2026-27	Engineering, Supply, Installation and Testing & Commissioning works for Construction of 220kV DC Line through UG cable from 400/220/132/33kV GSS Mendhasal to 220/33kV GSS Infocity-II with two number of 220kV GIS Bay extension at each end i.e. at Mendhasal GSS and Infocity-II GSS on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. **Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:00 PM.**	**Rs. 1,68,91,09,023/-**
CPC-75/2026-27	Procurement of Structure Materials & HDG Nut & bolts for (1) Balance materials for RTSS Dhutra & RTSS Garposh works and (2) Conversion of the above lines from 2 Phase to 3 Phase under deposit work of M/s SE Railway and (3) NH Diversion in RTSS Dhutra transmission coridorr under deposit work of NH Diversion, Jharsuguda.	**Rs. 6,37,04,296/-**

Complete set of bidding documents are available at **www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL** and **www.optcl.co.in.**
/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha **HIPR-66/2026-27**

A click for posterity: Pranavi, who idolises McIlroy, lived her dream at the Delhi Golf Club on Wednesday. INSTAGRAM@PRANAVI_URS

Pranavi gets to meet 'ultimate hero' McIlroy

GOLF

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

For Asian Games gold medallist Pranavi Urs, meeting her idol Rory McIlroy was a dream come true.

The 23-year-old got to spend time with the six-time Major champion at the Delhi Golf Club here on Wednesday, exchanging notes on the highs and lows of competing at the highest level.

Grew up watching him

"Rory has been my idol for as long as I can remember. I grew up watching him more than I watched Tiger (Woods). I like Tiger as well, but Rory is my ultimate hero," Pranavi told *The Hindu*.

The two spent time together on the putting green before walking a couple of holes. "I told him about what I felt when I made the triple bogey in the final round, and he told me about what happened to him at one of the Tour Championships. We spoke about how he felt playing his first Masters. It was quite motivating," Pranavi said.

McIlroy, meanwhile, was impressed by the Indian's resilience in winning gold at Japan.

Amazing achievement

"It is an amazing achievement to win the Asian Games. The resilience and character she showed to go and win after having that early triple bogey... it was a delight to meet her.

"She is a wonderful young woman. She said she was nervous, but it didn't seem like she was. It was great to spend some time with her," McIlroy said.

McIlroy, Fleetwood and Rai headline star-studded field

Fox, Rose, Reed and Willett among the other leading contenders for the top prize; Saptak, Khalin, Veer and Shubhankar spearhead the home challenge in the blue riband event of Indian golf

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

A galaxy of golf's biggest names will descend on the picturesque Delhi Golf Club for the second edition of the DP World India Championship, which tees off here on Thursday.

With a prize purse of $4 million, the tournament has attracted three reigning Major champions, alongside several other big names. The 2026 Masters champion Rory McIlroy is undoubtedly the biggest draw, with PGA Championship winner Aaron Rai and Ryan Fox, who won The Open Championship, among the other leading contenders.

Justin Rose (2013 U.S. Open), Danny Willett (2016 Masters), Patrick Reed (2018 Masters) and Shane Lowry (2019 Open Championship) further bolster the star-studded field.

Plenty at stake

With the season nearing its conclusion, there is plenty at stake beyond the tournament title. This week's performance could prove decisive in the Race to Dubai, where Reed, Eugenio Chacarra and McIlroy are locked in a three-way battle. The storied DGC presents a distinctive challenge. At a time when courses are increasingly designed to accommodate long-hitters, the DGC demands a different approach. Its relatively short layout, narrow fairways, dense tree cover and thick rough place a premium on accuracy and course management.

Tee-off time: Defending champion Fleetwood will face a stern test from McIlroy. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

> It's a Ryder Cup year next year. I want to make that team. I want to contribute. I want to earn more points for Europe. I still want to do well there
> **RORY MCILROY**

> Last year, if you missed the fairways, you could hit it towards the green and then figure it out. This year, if you hit it in the rough, you're just hacking it out
> **FLEETWOOD**

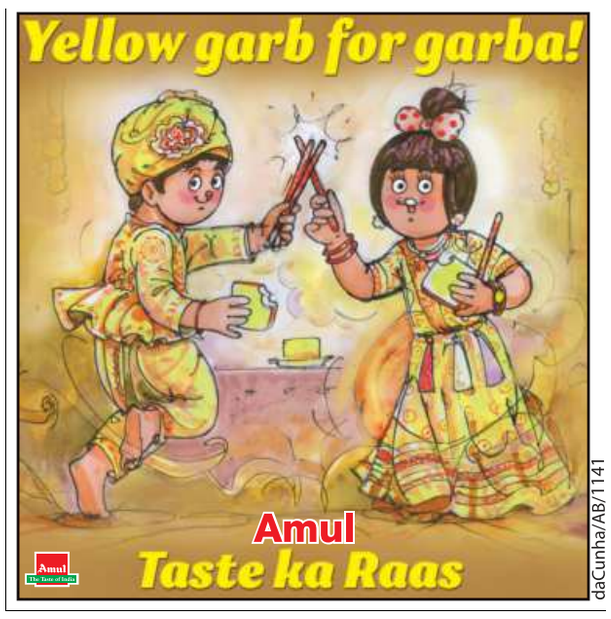
Big-hitting offers little advantage here, so much so that several players are expected to leave their drivers in the hotel.

Defending champion Tommy Fleetwood noted that the rough has grown thicker this year, adding another layer of difficulty.

"Last year, if you missed the fairways, you could hit it towards the green and then figure it out. But this year, if you hit it in the rough, you're just hacking it out," Fleetwood said.

The home challenge will be spearheaded by DP World PGTI Order of Merit leaders Saptak Talwar, Khalin Joshi and Veer Ahlawat. Shubhankar Sharma, meanwhile, arrives on the back of a victory at the Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship a few days ago.

The blue riband event of Indian golf promises a compelling blend of world-class talent and serious test of skill.



McIlroy speaks of desire to win Race to Dubai

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

Six-time Major champion Rory McIlroy has backed the DP World Tour's decision to bar players who sign up for LIV Golf from competing in its events from next year.

"The DP World Tour (known earlier as European Tour) are well within their rights to change the rules and regulations. This is the way to protect their business and to make the tour as strong as possible," McIlroy said here on the eve of the DP World India Championship.

In a statement to the BBC, DP World Tour chief executive Guy Kinnings said, "Players need to make a choice" – an ultimatum to those contemplating their future in the rival league, which is now facing financial turmoil.

A vocal critic of LIV Golf, McIlroy added, "The DP World Tour have made a good decision. The golf landscape has now got to the point where guys are going to have to make a decision on what is important to them and what they really want to do."

One of the modern greats of the game, the Northern Irishman may have achieved almost everything there is to achieve on the golf course, but his hunger for success remains undiminished.

McIlroy spoke of his desire to win the Race to Dubai - the season-long competition to crown the European Tour's leading player - for a record eighth time. He is currently third in the standings, with only a handful of tournaments remaining.

"At this stage of my career, it's always nice to get to this part of the season and have a chance to win the Race to Dubai. Eugenio (Chacarra) jumped me last week in Spain. Patrick (Reed) isn't playing so well, so this is a good opportunity to cut into that lead this week to try and win my eighth Race to Dubai".

THE HINDU
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Indicative information regarding Stray vacancy Round of Online Counselling for admission in All India Seats in M.B.B.S. & B.D.S. courses

PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 14.09.2026 regarding the NEET-UG Schedule-2026 State Counselling, the Board will organise Stray Vacancy Round of Online Counselling for vacant All India seats in M.B.B.S. & B.D.S. Courses in Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Palamu; Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Seraikela-Kharsawan; Sido Kanhu Medical College & Hospital, Dumka; Birsa Institute of Medical Sciences & Research Khunti (for M.B.B.S.) and Vananchal Dental College and Hospital, Garhwa under Babu Dinesh Singh University, Garhwa & Awadh Dental College & Hospital, Jamshedpur (for B.D.S.) of Jharkhand State as per the Updated Schedule Notification which can be seen on the MCC Website.

Detailed information in this regard has been uploaded under "Important Notice" column at **Board's website http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in.**

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(Controller of Examination)

PR 391778 (Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board) 26-27 (D)

ENTERPRISE CONNECT

A Business Initiative

PNB Brings Financial Ecosystem Together at Inaugural Sustainable Finance Leadership Summit 2026

Punjab National Bank hosted the inaugural Sustainable Finance Leadership Summit 2026, alongside the 3rd PCAF India Accelerator Session, at its Corporate Office in Dwarka, New Delhi. The Summit brought together senior representatives from regulatory bodies, banks, development finance institutions, corporates and sustainability organisations to deliberate on the critical role of finance in advancing India's transition towards a sustainable and resilient economy. The Summit marked a significant milestone in PNB's sustainability journey, providing a collaborative platform for exchanging insights, sharing best practices and exploring actionable approaches to sustainable finance. Discussions centred on climate risk, responsible banking, financed emissions, nature-related risks and the integration of sustainability considerations into financial decision-making. The inaugural session featured an address by Ms. Mousumi Majumdar, GCRO, PNB, who also presented PNB's sustainability journey and future roadmap Dr. Balakrishna Pisupati, Country Head – India, United Nations Environment Programme, shared insights on sustainable finance, while Shri Saket Kumar, DGM and Head, Sustainable Finance Group, Reserve Bank of India, delivered a special address on "Climate Risk and Sustainable Finance – Regulatory View." A key highlight of the Summit was a leadership panel discussion on "What's Next for Sustainable Finance in India?" The panel brought together diverse perspectives from banking, development finance, industry, renewable energy and sustainability. Deliberations focused on opportunities and challenges in scaling sustainable finance, strengthening the role of financial institutions in supporting India's transition and fostering greater collaboration among stakeholders

Shri Alok Tiwari, IRSE, Entrusted with Additional Charge of Managing Director, DFCCIL

He has been entrusted with the additional charge of the post of Managing Director, Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL), in addition to his existing responsibilities. He assumed charge on 5th October 2026. Shri Tiwari was warmly welcomed at the DFCCIL Corporate Office by Shri Shobhit Bhatnagar, Director/OP&BD; Shri Anurag Sharma, Director/Infrastructure; Shri Pawan K. Rai, Director/Project Planning; and Shri B. Mugunthan, Director/Finance, along with other senior officials of DFCCIL. During his career, Shri Tiwari has held several key positions, including Chief Administrative Officer, South East Central Railway; Principal Chief Safety Officer, South Western Railway; Divisional Railway Manager, Guntakal; and Chief Project Manager-cum-Group General Manager, RVNL. His diverse experience encompasses technical planning, major infrastructure projects, safety management, freight operations and organisational administration.

U.P. Police bags best display award at trade show

The Uttar Pradesh Police pavilion won the 'Best Display Award' for the third consecutive year at the U.P. International Trade Show, held in Greater Noida from September 25 to 29, according to a police release. Located in Hall No. 4, the pavilion showcased public safety initiatives, modern policing technology and the force's history. It attracted several lakh visitors, the release said. Hansraj Vishwakarma presented the award to Rajesh Kumar Yadav, Superintendent of Police, Cyber Crime, and Karuna Shankar Singh, in charge of the UP 112 media cell. Vinod Kumar Singh, Director-General of Police (CID, Cyber Crime and UP 112), who proposed the exhibition's concept, thanked the participating units and personnel for their contribution.

India's Creative Economy Takes Centre Stage at JIIT Online Orientation with Dr. L. Murugan

Jaypee Institute of Information Technology (JIIT) welcomed its online learners at Deeksharambh 2026. An orientation programme held today at its Sector 62 campus. The event was organised by the Centre for Digital and Online Education (CDOE), JIIT and was attended by Dr. L. Murugan, Union Minister of State for Information & Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs, Government of India, as Chief Guest, along with other industry leaders. The Institute was represented by Dr. Rajive Kumar, Vice Chancellor, and Dr. S. C. Saxena, Pro Chancellor. The gathering was also graced by the esteemed Directors, Deans, Heads of Departments, Faculty members and students of JIIT and JIIT Online across the B.Tech, M.Tech, BBA, MBA, BCA and MCA programmes. Speaking on India's creative economy and its prospect for the world, Dr. Murugan described it as a major growth frontier for young professionals. He said the government aims to scale the sector to $100 billion by 2030, and that the animation, gaming and visual effects (AVGC) sector alone will need nearly 2 million skilled professionals. Dr. Murugan said "Government Of India is planning the roadmap to 2047 for the youth of the country, the future belongs to youth. Shri S. C. Saxena Ji said: "While much of your learning journey happens online, this could be one of the most memorable days of your journey with JIIT."

NBCC Floats Tenders Worth more than ₹9,600 Crore for Revival of 16 Stalled Supertech Projects

Move marks a major step towards execution and provides renewed hope to thousands of affected homebuyers NBCC (India) Limited has taken a major step towards the revival of 16 stalled residential projects of Supertech Limited by floating 25 tenders aggregating ₹9,620.33 crore for construction and related works across the project portfolio. The tendering process marks a significant transition from the resolution and planning stage to on-ground execution, providing renewed confidence to thousands of homebuyers awaiting completion of their homes. The 16 projects, spread across Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Uttarakhand and Karnataka, comprise nearly 50,000 stalled housing units. NBCC was appointed as the Project Management Consultant (PMC) for completion of these projects by the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) in December 2024. The Hon'ble Supreme Court, in February 2026, upheld NBCC's mandate, providing the necessary legal certainty for implementation of the completion plan. With the commencement of the tendering process for the Supertech projects, NBCC is reinforcing its role as a trusted public-sector implementation agency for completion of distressed real-estate projects. The initiative is expected to help unlock stalled assets, restore homebuyer confidence and facilitate the eventual delivery of homes that have remained incomplete for several years.

Dr. Siba Prasad Mohanty, MD, HURL, Honoured with 'Best MD of the Year' Award at Odisha Startup Summit 2026

He was honoured with the prestigious "Best MD of the Year" Award at the Odisha Startup Summit 2026, where he participated as a Distinguished Guest. Addressing the gathering, Dr. Mohanty highlighted the role of innovation, entrepreneurship and industry collaboration in driving economic transformation, generating employment and advancing India's vision of self-reliance. The recognition marks a proud moment for HURL, celebrating leadership that inspires progress, innovation and organisational excellence.

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M.C.O.P. NO. 301/2025
Mohammed
... Petitioner
-Vs-
The Proprietor
M/s. Kamal Commercial Vehicles Pvt Ltd,
OPP. G.P.O Kamal & Co, Jaipur,
Rajasthan - 302001.
... Respondent
NOTICE
Please take notice last 05.01.2021 that the vehicle belongs to you bearing chase No. VP3109521 E3600000, involved in accident in the above case in MCOP No. 301/2025 and posted for your presence in person or through your counsel on 29.10.2026 at 10.00 A.M. If you fail to do so the matter will be decided exparte.
A.DEVARAJ,
Advocate
Vellore - 632006, Vellore District, T.N.

PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME
I, TEJ Pratap Kumar, s/o Shri Parmatma Sah, r/o A–105, C–3, Nangli Vihar Extension, Gali No. 17, Baprola, West Delhi, Delhi – 110043, have changed my name from Tej Pratap Kumar to Prakash Kumar.
I, Pawan Kumar Agrawal, son of Ram Kishun Agrawal, resident of Rishi Bhoomi, Risia, Risia Bazar, Bahraich, Uttar Pradesh – 271875, hereby inform the general public that I was previously known as Pawan Agrawal and am now known as Pawan Kumar Agrawal.

PUBLIC NOTICE
PUBLIC NOTICE
Be it known to all concerned that my client, Ms. Shanti Devi, D/o Late Sh. Mohinder Kumar, resident of Flat No. 14B, First Floor, Block BG-3, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi, is seeking a certified copy of the possession letter/ possession handing-over and taking-over document in respect of Flat No. 14B, First Floor, Block BG-3, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi, from the Delhi Development Authority (DDA).
The aforesaid property was originally allotted to Late Sh. Mohinder Kumar, and my client is pursuing the requisite formalities with the DDA in respect of the said property on the basis of the relevant succession and relinquishment documents.
Any person, institution or authority having any objection, claim, right, title or interest in respect of the aforesaid property, or having any information or record concerning the aforementioned possession letter, is hereby called upon to intimate the same in writing to the undersigned within 15 (fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice, along with supporting documents, if any.
In the event no objection or claim is received within the aforesaid period, my client shall proceed with the requisite formalities before the DDA in accordance with law.
Advocate Chandan Singh Bisht
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I would love to push myself to try and win another Major

The 13-time PGA Tour winner feels that it is an important time for the sport globally and India is key to its development, is willing to constantly tweak his game in order to stay relevant with the modern times

INTERVIEW

Justin Rose

Ashwin Achal
NEW DELHI

This is Justin Rose's second visit to India. The first was a good 22 years ago, when the English golfer played a skins game at DLF Golf and Country Club in Gurgaon. "That was back in the day before DLF became the DLF of now," Rose said.

Rose's own journey over the last decades has seen tremendous highs. A 13-time winner on the PGA Tour, Rose hit the peak in 2013 when he won the U.S. Open, his first and only Major title. In September 2018, Rose rose to the World No. 1 spot, becoming only the fourth English golfer to reach those great heights after Nick Faldo, Lee Westwood, and Luke Donald.

At 46, Rose has lost none of his competitive spirit. Now ranked 18th on the Official World Golf Ranking list, Rose has had a good year, winning the Farmers Insurance Open in February with a tournament-record score of 23-under par.

In April, Rose led the Masters by two shots in the final round, but back-to-back bogeys saw him finish tied for third. Now in New Delhi to compete in the DP World India Championship, Rose is keen to add to his trophy cabinet. A self-confessed fan of Indian food, Rose plans to enjoy a tasty Tandoori meal along the way.

The South Africa-born Englishman spoke on a range of topics at a press conference in Delhi Golf Club. Excerpts:

How important is it for an event like this to come to India, where there is so much interest in golf?

It is fantastic to be playing golf in this region. It's a country that is exploding in many, many ways, and I think that there is a commitment to golf here, with great sponsors and backers. This is an important time for golf to grow all around the world. What a field they have assembled here. Hopefully, that creates the interest that will help golf grow in this area.

You wanted to spend your 40th birthday in India, but it did not work out because of the COVID-19 restrictions. Tell us about your connection with India.

I have accumulated some Indian friends through the years. From what I've noticed, Indians are very proud of their country. Anybody who has any sort of influence here in India really wants to share it and show you the magic of India. I live in England, so of course I love Indian food. I'm not sure how authentic we make it in the U.K., but the national dish is chicken tikka masala. It is the most ordered dish in England. I am a big fan of Indian food.

What are your views on the course?

I can't tell you too much because I haven't been on the golf course yet. But I've spoken to my friend, Tommy Fleetwood, and guys who were here last year. It's a very unique golf course – very traditional and very old-school. There is no real need for distance off the tee. The driver stays in the bag. The DGC is a 250-yard, good second-shot type of golf course. Long and mid irons will be the most important part this week. Getting on the fairways and greens will be a huge premium.

What keeps the fire burning after so many years of competing at this top level?

That's a great question. Yes, I have been able to build a nice resume, but I've only achieved those high levels once. I would love to push myself to try and win another Major championship. But it's more than that. I want to play golf now for the memories. In order to build the memory bank, you have to keep putting yourself in the biggest situations in golf, whether that be down the stretch in Majors or on the first tee of Ryder Cups... I'm playing for those big moments.

The kids on the tour these days are so good. The strength and depth is so strong that I feel it's taking more discipline for me to stay relevant and continue to push myself to be a better player.

That is really the goal. Can I be better next year? I'm 47 next year. That shouldn't be possible, but I think it is possible. It is a personal battle, I suppose.

You came so close to winning the Masters this year but finished third. How do you recover and get back on the horse again?

This year, I turned up at Augusta with a sense that people were rooting for me because I have come so close to winning in the past. You can sense the sort of frustration of the crowd that you haven't been able to win, but you can't let that become part of your own story. I can only control my own performance and how I break down the golf course.

I've been incredibly close. I've had three runner-up finishes at the Masters. This year felt like a second-place finish, although it was a third. I feel like I played well enough to win the tournament, so my mindset would be to do nothing different.

The modern game has become increasingly driven by power and athleticism. How do you evolve as a player without losing the qualities that made you successful?

That's a really great question. I guess that's my job, especially this off-season. I have to try and figure out if there are some gains to be had, if I can push myself physically, and if there are some power and distance gains to be made. I also have to be realistic that pushing too hard at my age in certain areas comes with risks.

What has made me a great player through the years is being able to work my way around tough golf courses, plan my strategy, and, obviously, handle the mental side.

These are the things that I need to continue to do to stay strong. I am capable of driving the ball well enough to be incredibly competitive. My short game needs a little bit of work, but I know I have it in me. My putting has shown an uptrend in the last five or six years. If I can just piece it all together, I don't need to do much differently.

But yes, the game has shifted, no doubt. You see many college players coming out on tour now with 180-mile-an-hour ball speed. When I first arrived on tour, John Daly was the only one with 180-mile-an-hour ball speed. He was the outlier. Now it's the average. I fit somewhere below that average, but not by much. I need to compete by being consistent in everything.

You went on a Ryder Cup scouting trip. Talk to us about the process.

It was the first opportunity for (Team Europe captain) Luke Donald to get the group together. It was an important trip for players who haven't played the Ryder Cup before. It was good for rookies to be around the team and feel the energy of a Ryder Cup.

Luke talked a little bit about how he envisions the strategy and the plan for the next year or so. It was more of a boys' trip – casual golf, a nice dinner, and a little bit of discussion. It wasn't very intense.

You are a cricket fan. You played many pro-ams with Brian Lara. Will you use this week to play some cricket and meet a few cricketers?

I hope the energy of cricket comes through here in India. I know (former England cricketer) Kevin Pietersen quite well. We live in the same area back in England. I know he's also a big name and brand over here. I think he'll be around the golf tournament this week. If we can have some fun along the way, that will be great.

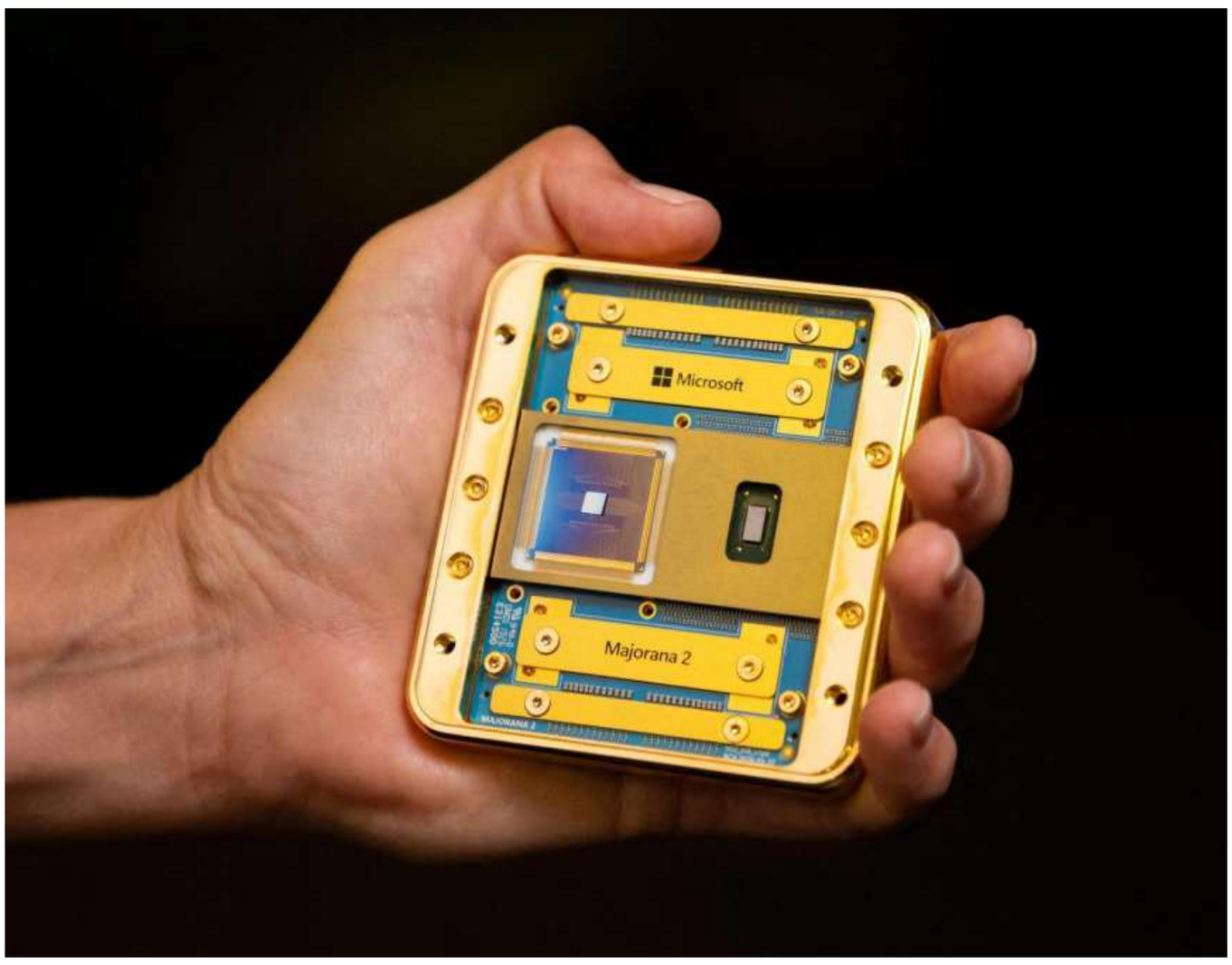
Perhaps you can get some batting practice...

Yes, sure, I can do some batting and maybe bowl my famous googly too (laughs).

Old doubts linger, yet new Microsoft quantum chip raises the stakes

Not everyone is convinced Microsoft learnt the bigger lesson from its experience with announcing the Majorana 1 chip; University of Pittsburgh professor Sergey Frolov has said Microsoft's previous record has left him unwilling to treat the new work as resting on a well-understood foundation

Vasudevan Mukunth



Microsoft's Majorana 2 quantum computing chip is seen in this undated handout photo. MICROSOFT/REUTERS

In February, the Microsoft Quantum research group announced a new kind of computer processor called Majorana 1. According to the tech giant, the processor contained the world's first topological qubits, built with a new material it called a 'topoconductor'. Majorana 1 contained eight qubits, with Microsoft Quantum saying it would in future hold a million.

The group published its paper in *Nature* the same day, and that stoked the early concerns about what Microsoft Quantum had actually demonstrated.

Foremost, the paper was considerably more circumspect than Microsoft's press release. The researchers had built devices made of indium-arsenide-aluminium and discussed a way to measure, in a 'single shot', the parity of an electronic state, i.e. whether the number of electrons was odd or even in the state, in the wire.

The team called this measurement a "necessary ingredient" for a highly sought after form of quantum computing.

However, there was a significant gap between the scopes of the paper and of the press release, prompting concerns in the scientific community that Microsoft was trying to lay claim to a commercially lucrative technology without first proving that it actually worked.

Zero modes

Quantum computing is a new, more powerful form of computing that scientists believe can solve some problems much better than conventional devices can. However, the quantum bits, or qubits, these machines are based on are notoriously fragile.

A qubit stores information in a quantum state, which can be disturbed by even the slightest interactions with stray heat or stray magnetic fields. Another technology called quantum error correction can compensate but not without imposing additional technological hurdles. Many leading quantum computers encode qubits in superconducting circuits, while others use atoms, ions or light. At least on paper, topological quantum computing shows another way.

In this domain, Microsoft Quantum has been trying to build a quantum computer with qubits based on particles called Majorana zero modes (MZMs). Technically, MZMs are 'emergent quasiparticles'. The physicists Sankar Das Sarma, Roman Lutchyn, and Jay Sau had predicted in 2010 that they would occur at the ends of specially engineered superconducting wires.

Two MZMs separated by some space constitute a particular quantum state, and whether that state is occupied or not can encode information, like 0 and 1. This way, each MZM pair stores information in both particles together.

This is less like one half being stored in each particle and more like both particles storing the information together: many small disturbances affecting only one end cannot destroy the information, yet both ends are required to access it. The space between the two MZMs of a pair is crucial to achieve this.

MZMs also follow some strange rules. For example, carrying out one exchange of MZMs and then another can create a different quantum state than performing the same exchange in the reverse order.

Airtight inference

But a big problem today is to ascertain if a device with the necessary superconducting wires and other parts also has MZMs. This is because there are many impostor states that are easier to create but which lack the MZMs' unusual properties. There is no way to directly spot an MZM with some kind of microscope and claim success. Instead, scientists and engineers have to measure the device's properties in different ways, and from that infer the presence of MZMs.

This inference has to be airtight, and the dispute in the Microsoft case is that its inference is not.

The matter is still on, in fact: on June 2 this year, Microsoft Quantum announced a new processor called Majorana 2 and uploaded a new preprint paper. Here, the team replaced aluminium with lead, whose superconducting state is harder to disrupt, to make the desired state more robust. It also switched to a gallium-antimonide substrate and redesigned the semiconductor stack to reduce disorder.

The upgrade was apparently dramatic: in Microsoft's telling, the topological gap – the energy needed to excite the system out of its protected state – had increased from around 30 microelectron-volts to 70 microelectron-volts. The parity switching time had also increased from a few milliseconds to around 20 seconds.

The group presented this as proof of topological quantum computing's promise because the new numbers were indicative of the encoded information being more robustly protected from disturbances. On the back of these reported advances, the company said it would build a scalable quantum computer by 2029 – a significantly shortened deadline considering how complex the technology still is.

Rebuttal and response

However, not everyone is convinced that Microsoft learnt the bigger lesson from last time. As University of Pittsburgh professor Sergey Frolov has said, Microsoft's previous record has left him unwilling to treat the new work as resting on a well-understood foundation.

MZMs are very difficult to create and detect. For example, researchers from TU-Delft in the Netherlands published a paper in *Nature* in 2018 claiming they had spotted MZMs. But it had to be retracted three years later after independent scientists found problems in the data analysis. In its 2025 paper, the Microsoft Quantum team used the topological gap protocol it had presented in a 2023 paper: a way to use electrical conductance data to identify combinations of magnetic field and gate voltage that are consistent with gapped MZMs. The team then used a technique called radio-frequency interferometry to check one region of the device, and where the team said the data had evidence of parity switching.

But at an American Physical Society meeting a month later, scientists remained sceptical. The Microsoft team had demonstrated one measurement on one wire in the paper and itself presented additional measurements of a different kind, but many physicists still had doubts.

Cornell University professor Eun-Ah Kim said the data was quite weak while Argonne National Laboratory physicist Kartiek Agarwal called the paper's claims premature, even if not deserving to be dismissed. Henry Legg, a lecturer at the University of St. Andrews in Scotland, in particular said the headline data came from a small number of measurements on one device. Then, on June 24 this year, *Nature* published a rebuttal by Dr. Legg alongside a response from Microsoft Quantum (physicist Chetan Nayak was the corresponding author). In his rebuttal, based on his own work over the last year, Dr. Legg contended that Microsoft's device itself may not have been qualified to host MZMs, that the underlying data of how electric currents move in the device appeared consistent with a gapless and highly disordered system, and that the topological gap protocol was sensitive, rather than agnostic, to how a researcher chose to analyse the system.

In response, Nayak et al. disputed Dr. Legg's logic and said its claims were based on the radio-frequency measurements, not the protocol.

Many physicists believe Microsoft's attempts are promising and commend its transparency with data. But many physicists also remain unconvinced that the qubits in Majorana 1 and Majorana 2 are working topological qubits.

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A Thai villager paddles a foam float past a flooded home in Ayutthaya on October 6. AFP

Thailand floods villages to save capital, economic hubs

Agence France-Presse

Stilt houses in villages north of Bangkok are no longer high enough to stay dry as authorities in Thailand deliberately flood riverside communities to spare the capital.

Inside the home of Kamonchanok Sathaphonamonwut, raised more than three metres above the ground in Ayutthaya province, her family of three sleeps on makeshift platforms and cannot use the waterlogged toilet.

Her village has been flooded six years in a row, pushing some to move away, while others have raised their houses higher. "Our area simply cannot cope with this much water anymore," the 34-year-old said, wading through her soaked home. But while authorities prioritise protecting Bangkok and other business hubs from floods, "when it comes to our residential communities, they neglect us", she said.

Thailand experiences flooding every year during the monsoon season, and scientists say human-made climate change has made heavy rain and floods more frequent and severe. After devastating floods in 2011, the government expanded embankments, water gates, and other infrastructure to direct water away from Bangkok, the historic city of Ayutthaya, and industrial zones along the Chao Phraya River, which flows through the capital. The defences have largely kept commercial centres safe, but residents of other areas have been left to fend for themselves. Around 20 km from Ayutthaya's centuries-old temple ruins, a UNESCO heritage site, residents say floods that once reached their knees now rise above their heads in some areas and can take several months to recede.

Office worker Kamonchanok has been forced to commute by boat, and hoist her household appliances and other belongings above the waterline. "All we can do is deal with the consequences," she said.

Thai irrigation department spokesperson Thanet Somboon said climate change, low-lying geography, and recently built embankments that altered the natural flow of the Chao Phraya have contributed to more severe flooding of downstream communities. "Even when water is released from the Chao Phraya Dam at the same rate as before, the impact is greater than it used to be," Mr. Thanet said. And after irrigation channels were completely full of diverted water, he said, authorities had "no choice but to discharge the remaining water downstream". But Mr. Thanet acknowledged that officials may need to review infrastructure to "ensure floodwater can be kept within the intended limits".

As flooding in hard-hit districts has become more severe, many who remain have paid to lift their stilt houses higher and keep their living space dry. Ms. Kamonchanok's family raised their home twice in the 1990s, the second time by 1.5 metres.

The government's flagship fix is a $780-million flood diversion canal, designed to carry 1,200 cubic metres of water – around half the volume of an Olympic-size swimming pool – per second around the bottleneck where the Chao Phraya narrows through Ayutthaya. It is expected to be completed by 2030.

Until then, Ms. Kamonchanok said her community was not even demanding an end to intentional flooding, but rather a cap on water levels and financial support for those whose homes sit below the flood line. "All we're asking for is to be able to live comfortably in our own homes," she said ."Why can't they give us that?"

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Movie names that are also scientific concepts

Please send in your answers to science@thehindu.co.in

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

In astrophysics, the _____ _____ is the boundary around a black hole beyond which not even light can escape to a distant observer. The film, released in 1997, stars Laurence Fishburne and investigates a spaceship that has mysteriously reappeared near Neptune. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 2

Name the effect that describes how extremely small differences in the initial conditions of a system — like water vapour levels, temperature, winds, etc. — can produce drastically different outcomes over time, like a cyclone taking shape or not. In the 2004 film of the same name, a young man is able to travel back in time in a strange way.

QUESTION 3

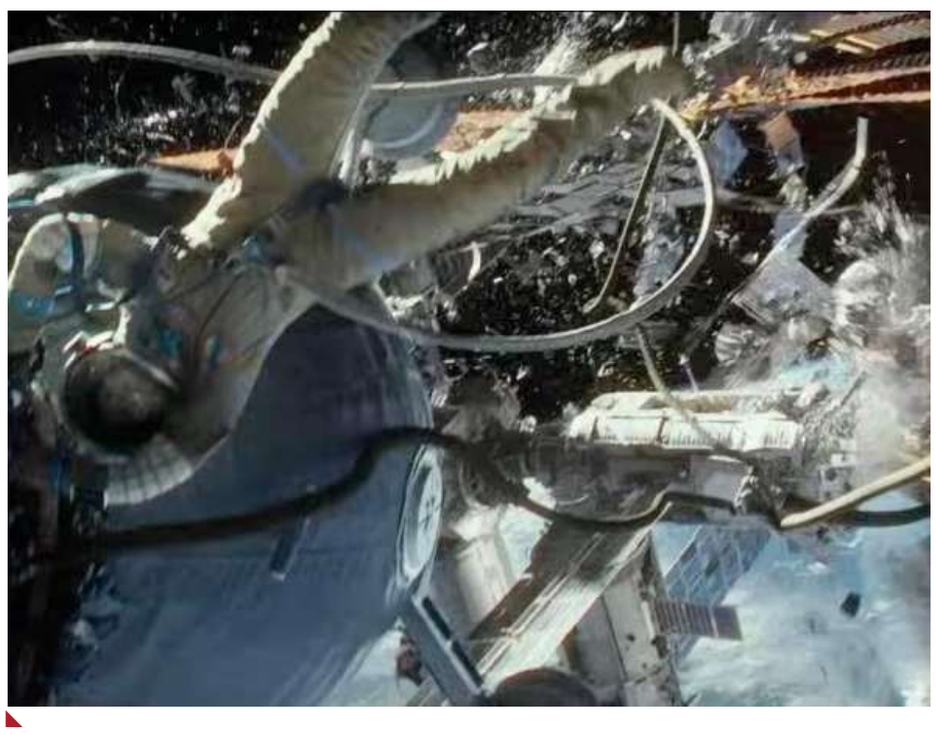
What is the form of energy transferred between two systems because of a temperature difference called? This transfer happens spontaneously and the form can exist only in transit. The 1995 film with this name is considered to be one of the best crime films of all time.

QUESTION 4

A _____ is an arrangement of numbers or other mathematical objects that allows mathematicians to understand systems of equations. They are central to quantum mechanics, computer graphics, and machine learning — just as the turn-of-the-century film of this name is considered a cornerstone of sci-fi filmmaking. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION #5

The 1958 Alfred Hitchcock classic X is centered on some characters' extreme fear of heights, accompanied by the titular condition. In reality, the condition makes a person feel like they are moving when they are not. Name X.



Visual: Name the film in which this nail-biting scene appears. Its director Alfonso Cuarón said he named the film for a physical entity that played a major role in its plot. WARNER BROS./YOUTUBE

Answers to October 13 questions:

1. American physicist who won the physics Nobel Prize twice – **Ans: John Bardeen**
2. Laureate who won the physics Nobel for inventing optical tweezers – **Ans: Arthur Ashkin**
3. Physicist born Maria Skłodowska who named an element after her homeland – **Ans: Marie Curie**
4. Concept for which Hinton and Hopfield won the 2024 Nobel – **Ans: Machine learning**
5. Superconducting device that shows macroscopic quantum tunnelling – **Ans: Josephson junction**

Visual: **IceCube Neutrino Observatory**

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For feedback and suggestions
for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'